

Characterization and Convergence of Markov Processes via Martingale Problems

A blueprint for formalization

August 24, 2026

Abstract

This manuscript collects, in a self-contained and formalization-oriented form, four results on martingale problems: (i) existence of a càdlàg modification of a solution (Ethier–Kurtz [3], Theorem 4.3.6); (ii) the fact that uniqueness of the one-dimensional distributions already implies uniqueness of the finite-dimensional distributions and the (strong) Markov property ([3], Theorem 4.4.2); (iii) duality as a tool for proving uniqueness ([3], Lemma 4.4.10, Theorem 4.4.11 and its corollaries); (iv) existence: four routes, of which two produce a solution out of nothing — an explicit construction of jump processes, and the correspondence with stochastic differential equations — while the fourth obtains solutions as weak limits of solutions of approximating martingale problems ([3], Lemma 4.5.1 and Remark 4.5.2), together with the strictly more general convergence theorem of Criens–Pfaffelhuber–Schmidt [2]. Each of (i)–(iii) is first proved in the abstract setting of [2], without any operator, and [3]’s statement is then recovered as a corollary; the abstract versions are new, since [2] prove no characterization results. Throughout, the time index is an abstract ordered set carrying a *clock*, the state space is graded from “measurable space” to “Polish”, and local martingale problems are treated wherever the statement permits it. Every statement is tagged with the weakest hypotheses on the index and on the state space that it uses, and Section 2.9 tabulates the result: the partially ordered index survives in (ii) for the Markov property but provably not for uniqueness, and in (iii) not at all; a merely measurable state space suffices for (ii) and (iii) throughout. Section 1 explains, and justifies, the choice of the underlying setting; Section 8 records the design decisions that are relevant for the Lean formalization.

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1 Scope, and the choice of the setting

1.1 The two candidate settings

There are two natural frameworks in which the results of this manuscript can be phrased.

(EK) The Ethier–Kurtz setting [3], Chapter 4. A martingale problem is attached to an *operator* $A \subset M(E) \times M(E)$ on a metric space E : a measurable E -valued process X solves the martingale problem for A if

$$f(X(t)) - \int_0^t g(X(s)) \, ds, \quad t \geq 0, \quad (1)$$

is a martingale for every $(f, g) \in A$. This is the setting in which *characterization* results are traditionally stated: uniqueness, the Markov property, duality, and the correspondence with semigroups and generators.

(A) The abstract setting. A martingale problem is attached to a *family* $\mathbb{X}$ of *real-valued test processes* on a filtered space carrying, as yet, no measure: a probability measure P solves the martingale problem $\text{MP}(\mathbb{X})$ if every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ is a P -martingale, and the local martingale problem if every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ is a P -local martingale. The state space is Polish and the path space is an arbitrary Polish subset of $E^{\mathbb{T}}$; no operator and no Markov structure are assumed.

It is worth being accurate about where this second setting comes from, since this manuscript leans on it heavily. It is not new with [2]. In essentially the form used here it is [4], Definition III.1.3, which attaches a martingale problem to a family of optional processes and does so with *local* martingales as the default rather than as a variant, and with the initial condition given on an initial σ -field rather than by an initial distribution. [2] rediscover it in the shape that suits weak convergence — canonical test processes, determining sets, P -continuity — and it is their formulation that Section 3 follows, but Remark 3.6 records what [4] already had and what is worth importing from them. [5], Chapter 32 works in the same spirit for diffusions, again with local martingales throughout.

What each setting is good for. The division of labour is not the one the first draft of this manuscript assumed, and the correction is the main structural finding here. Setting (A) is where *all four* target results are naturally proved — including the three that [2] do not state. Setting (EK) is where they are naturally *applied*: in practice one is handed an operator, not a family of test processes, and the hypotheses of Section 5.4 are the ones that can be checked on A directly. Section 1.2 sets out the resulting three-layer architecture.

1.2 Recommendation

We use a *hybrid*, organised in three layers. The reader should be warned that the balance between them shifted while this manuscript was written, and that the outcome is not the one the first draft anticipated.

- (1) **Definitional layer: (A).** “Solution of a martingale problem” is defined as in [2], Definition 3.2, relative to a family $\mathbb{X}$ of test processes, with a *local* variant available from the outset (Definition 3.2). This costs one line and is what makes local martingale problems and non-càdlàg path spaces expressible at all.
- (2) **Abstract working layer: also (A).** Each of the three characterization results is stated and proved in this setting, with no operator anywhere: Theorem 4.3 for the càdlàg modification, Theorems 5.9 and 5.11 for uniqueness and the (strong) Markov property, and Lemma 6.1 with Proposition 6.2 for duality.
- (3) **Markovian layer: (EK).** The martingale problem for an operator A is the special case $\mathbb{X} = \mathbb{X}_A(X)$ of (1) (Definition 3.5), and the four target results are recovered on it: Theorem 4.5, Theorem 5.28, Theorem 6.6 and Lemma 7.15. Each is a corollary of layer (2), and each proof is a verification of hypotheses rather than an argument.

Layer (2) is the substance of this manuscript, and it is the point on which the first draft was wrong. It assumed that uniqueness, the Markov property and duality are *intrinsically* statements about an operator A and its domain, and that (A) could therefore serve only as packaging. That is not so. Each of the three proofs, read carefully, uses of the operator only that it produces test processes of a particular shape, and each hypothesis it really needs can be stated directly:

- the càdlàg theorem needs a class Φ for which $f(X)$ splits into a martingale plus a time-regular remainder — Definition 4.2;
- uniqueness and the Markov property need the test family to be stable under the shift — Definition 5.5 — and nothing else, the whole proof reducing to one lemma applied four times (Lemma 5.8);
- duality needs only two increment representations of a function of two time variables (Lemma 6.1), and no probability at all.

Remarks 4.4, 5.12 and 6.4 record what each abstraction buys. Briefly: path-dependent and atomic compensators, which cannot be written with an operator $A \subset C_b(E) \times B(E)$ at all; the disappearance of the auxiliary filtration (4) from everything except Proposition 3.7; and a precise account of which time indices and which clocks each result admits (Section 2.9).

Two caveats keep this from being an argument for (A) alone.

- [2] contains none of the three. That paper is concerned exclusively with identifying weak limits; it proves no uniqueness statement, no Markov property and no path regularity statement. For the càdlàg theorem the omission is structural rather than accidental: their Setting 3.1 *presupposes* a Polish path space F and right continuous test processes, which is exactly what a regularization theorem has to produce. Layer (2) is therefore new here, not imported.
- Layer (3) is not decoration. The abstract hypotheses are the ones a proof needs; the operator is the one a user has. In applications one is handed A , and the value of Theorem 5.28 over Theorem 5.9 is that its hypotheses are checkable on A without first reconstructing $\mathbb{X}_A$, θ_r and a determining set.

For the fourth target result — existence by convergence, [3], Lemma 4.5.1 — the [2] formulation is a strict generalization (Theorem 7.21): it drops boundedness of f and g , replaces exact solutions of approximating martingale problems by *approximate* martingales, and replaces uniform boundedness by uniform integrability. Here [2] is used directly, and Theorem 7.18 isolates the abstract statement behind it, which needs neither càdlàg paths nor the Skorokhod topology and is proved here in full.

1.3 Generality: time index, Polish state space, local martingale problems

Four deliberate strengthenings relative to [3] are made.

Abstract time index. [3] and [2] index time by $[0, \infty)$. Here the index is an abstract set $\mathbb{T}$, and every statement is tagged with the weakest of the bundles (T0)–(T4) of Definition 2.1 that it needs; the compensator becomes a separate datum, a *clock* in the sense of Definition 2.2. Section 2.9 tabulates the result. There are two reasons for the effort. The first is that the classical formulation conflates a topological hypothesis on $\mathbb{T}$ with an algebraic one: Section 4 needs the former, Sections 5 and 6 the latter, and $[0, \infty)$ happens to supply both. The second is that Mathlib indexes `Filtration`, `Martingale` and `IsStoppingTime` by an arbitrary `[Preorder  $\iota$ ]`, so fixing $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ at the outset would mean working against the library rather than with it.

The gain is not merely cosmetic. Discrete time ($\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$, q counting measure) and processes with fixed times of discontinuity (q with atoms) become special cases rather

than analogues, and the partially ordered case survives in Section 3, in the Markov half of Section 5 and in the abstract convergence theorem. It fails in exactly two places, and for reasons worth knowing: the uniqueness induction needs the times to form a chain (Remark 5.10), and duality needs order intervals to be carried onto order intervals by reflection (Remark 6.4).

State space: measurable, not Polish, where possible. [3] and [2] take E Polish throughout. Here E is graded exactly as the time index is: (E0) a measurable space, (E1) standard Borel, (E2) separable metrizable, (E3) Polish (Definition 2.6). The grading is not decoration. Sections 3 and 6 and almost all of Section 5 run under (E0); regular conditional distributions, and hence (E1), are needed at exactly three places; the topology of E is used only in Sections 4 and 7. The payoff is concrete: martingale problems for distribution-valued processes, where $E = \mathcal{S}'(\mathbb{R}^d)$ is standard Borel but not metrizable, are covered by the first three sections with no new proof. See Remarks 2.7 and 2.8.

Where a topology is used, E is *not* assumed locally compact. On a general Polish space there is no space $C_c(E)$ and no one-point compactification argument, and the rôle of local compactness is taken over throughout by the *compact containment condition* (28) resp. (15). This is the essential mechanism, and it is worth isolating it as a definition (Definition 3.15) in the formalization.

Local martingale problems. Whether “martingale” may be weakened to “local martingale” differs from result to result, and it is important not to overclaim. The situation is:

- *Theorem 4.5 (càdlàg modification)*: must be stated for genuine martingales. Localization requires stopping times, stopping times require a right-continuous filtration and a progressively measurable process, and path regularity is precisely what is being proved. The argument is circular otherwise. See Remark 4.7.
- *Theorem 5.28 (uniqueness and Markov property)*: the proof conditions on events of positive probability and uses the martingale property under the conditioned measures; boundedness of f and g enters through the integrability needed for (21). A local version is available, but only after localization along stopping times that are *common* to all solutions; see Remark 5.30.
- *Theorem 6.6 (duality)*: is already stated for unbounded $f, g, h \in M(E_1 \times E_2)$, controlled by the integrability hypotheses (48)–(49). Nothing has to be changed.
- *Section 7.2 (jump processes)*: the local version is not an afterthought but the general case — with unbounded rates the process explodes, and the jump times are a localizing sequence by construction; see Remark 7.7.
- *Theorem 7.21 (convergence)*: concludes that the limit solves the *global* martingale problem. A local martingale problem is obtained in the limit by applying the theorem to a localized family of test processes; see Remark 7.22.

Section 5.2 carries out the local theory in the abstract setting, following [5], Theorems 32.10 and 32.11. Two hypotheses are needed and are isolated there: a localizing sequence that is a path functional common to all P , and covariance of that sequence under the shift. The point of isolating them is that the local martingale property is *not* linear in P , so that the two workhorse lemmas of Section 5.1 — mixture stability and the restart lemma — do not survive localization for free.

2 Preliminaries

Following the project plan, all material of [3], Chapters 1–3, may be cited. This section makes that interface explicit: it collects, in the form of numbered *Facts*, precisely those definitions and results of [3], Chapters 1–3 (together with a few items from the Appendixes of [3]) that are used later on. Nothing here is proved; the rôle of the section is to fix statements and to serve as the list of prerequisites for the formalization. Section 2.8 records where each item is used.

2.1 Notation

Let $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space; the topological assumptions on E are made bundle by bundle in Definition 2.6, and $\mathcal{B}(E)$ is written for $\mathcal{E}$ whenever E carries a topology. We write

- $M(E)$ for the real-valued Borel measurable functions on E ;
- $B(E) \subset M(E)$ for the bounded ones, with $\|f\| = \sup_{x \in E} |f(x)|$;
- $C(E)$ for the continuous functions, $C_b(E) = C(E) \cap B(E)$, and, for E locally compact, $\hat{C}(E)$ for the continuous functions vanishing at infinity;
- $\mathcal{P}(E)$ for the Borel probability measures on E and $V(E)$ for the finite signed Borel measures on E ;
- $D_E[0, \infty)$ for the space of càdlàg functions $[0, \infty) \rightarrow E$ and $C_E[0, \infty)$ for the continuous ones.

L always denotes a real Banach space with norm $\|\cdot\|$.

An *operator* is a subset $A \subset M(E) \times M(E)$; it need not be single-valued nor linear. Its domain is $\mathcal{D}(A) = \{f : (f, g) \in A \text{ for some } g\}$, its range is $\mathcal{R}(A) = \{g : (f, g) \in A \text{ for some } f\}$, and A_S denotes its linear span inside $M(E) \times M(E)$. For $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ we write $\lambda - A = \{(f, \lambda f - g) : (f, g) \in A\}$.

Throughout, references of the form “[3], Theorem 3.9.1” mean Chapter 3, Section 9, item 1 of [3].

2.2 The time index and the clock

[3] and [2] both index time by $\mathbb{R}_+$. Almost nothing in this manuscript needs that, and the parts that do need it need it for visibly different reasons: Section 4 needs a *topological* property of the index, Sections 5 and 6 an *algebraic* one. We therefore fix an abstract index $\mathbb{T}$ and record, for each statement, the weakest bundle of assumptions it uses. Two motives: it separates the topological from the algebraic hypotheses, which the classical formulation conflates; and it matches Mathlib, which indexes `Filtration`, `Martingale` and `IsStoppingTime` by an arbitrary `[Preorder ι]`, so that committing to $\mathbb{R}_+$ at the outset would mean working against the library.

Structure on the index

Definition 2.1. We use the following bundles of assumptions on $\mathbb{T}$.

- (T0) $\mathbb{T}$ is a preordered set with a least element 0.
- (T1) (T0), and $\mathbb{T}$ is a directed lattice: $s \wedge t$ and $s \vee t$ exist.
- (T1') (T1) in the concrete form of [3], Section 2.8: a metric lattice whose order intervals are separable from above.
- (T2a) (T0) and $\mathbb{T}$ is linearly ordered.
- (T2b) (T2a), $\mathbb{T}$ carries the order topology, admits a countable dense subset D , and has no isolated points from the right.

(T3) $\mathbb{T} = [0, \infty)$ or $\mathbb{T} = [0, T]$.

(T4) (T0) and $\mathbb{T}$ is a cancellative ordered commutative monoid: $r + \cdot$ is order preserving, and $t - s$ exists for $s \leq t$.

Three remarks on the design of Definition 2.1.

(T4) is independent of (T2a)–(T3). The monoid structure is what the shift $X(r + \cdot)$ needs; it presupposes no linear order. Keeping it separate makes visible that Sections 5 and 6 rest on an algebraic property of $\mathbb{T}$ whereas Sections 4 and 7 rest on a topological one.

Why (T2a) and (T2b) are separate. The uniqueness half of Theorem 5.9 and the whole of Section 6 need the order to be linear but use no topology at all; only Section 4 and the concrete convergence results need the topology. Bundling the two, as one is tempted to do, hides that.

(T1') is not used in this manuscript. It is listed because it is the only place where [3] themselves treat a general index set, and because it is easy to misremember what it is for; Remark 2.5 sets that out. But every statement here that involves a stopping time — the strong Markov property of Theorem 5.11, and the localized statements of Remarks 5.30, 4.7 and 7.22 — already assumes (T2b), hence a linear order, for which the lattice structure is automatic. (T1') would become relevant only for a strong Markov property on a genuinely directed index, and Remark 5.10 shows that such a statement is blocked earlier, on the uniqueness side.

The clock

The index set alone does not carry a martingale problem. The test processes of Definition 3.5 have the form $Y_t = f(X_t) - C_t^{f,g}$, and what distinguishes the compensator of a generator from an arbitrary adapted process is that it is additive in time and generated pointwise from g . That is what carries Proposition 3.7, and without a finite-dimensional characterization the phrase “martingale problem for the operator A ” has no content, since every process solves the martingale problem for *some* family of test processes, namely the family of its own martingales.

Definition 2.2 (Clock). A *clock* on $\mathbb{T}$ is a σ -field $\mathcal{T}$ on $\mathbb{T}$ for which the down-sets

$$\mathbb{T}_{\leq t} = \{u \in \mathbb{T} : u \leq t\}, \quad \mathbb{T}_{< t} = \mathbb{T}_{\leq t} \setminus \{u \in \mathbb{T} : t \leq u\}$$

are measurable for every t , together with a measure q on $(\mathbb{T}, \mathcal{T})$ such that $q(\mathbb{T}_{\leq t}) < \infty$ for every t . For $s \leq t$ we write

$$(s, t] := \mathbb{T}_{\leq t} \setminus \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}, \quad [s, t) := \mathbb{T}_{< t} \setminus \mathbb{T}_{< s}, \quad (2)$$

and call these the *optional* and the *predictable* interval. Both $t \mapsto \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ and $t \mapsto \mathbb{T}_{< t}$ are monotone, so both intervals are additive:

$$(s, u] = (s, t] \uplus (t, u], \quad [s, u) = [s, t) \uplus [t, u), \quad (s \leq t \leq u). \quad (3)$$

We write $\iota \in \{o, p\}$ for the choice of convention and $\langle s, t \rangle_\iota$ for $(s, t]$ resp. $[s, t)$.

The clock is *shift invariant* if $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T4) and $q(r + B) = q(B)$ for all $r \in \mathbb{T}$ and $B \in \mathcal{T}$; it is *reflective* if in addition $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T2a); and it is *atomless* if $q(\{u : t \leq u \leq t\}) = 0$ for every t , which is exactly the condition under which the two conventions coincide.

The additivity in (2) is not an assumption: it follows from transitivity of $\leq$, which is why a preorder suffices. This is the point at which a measure is genuinely needed rather than an additive interval function $q_{s,u} = q_{s,t} + q_{t,u}$: the proof of Proposition 3.7 uses Fubini in the form

$$E\left[\int_{(s,t]} g(X_u) q(du) \cdot Z\right] = \int_{(s,t]} E[g(X_u)Z] q(du),$$

and additivity along chains does not give that. On $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+^d$, for instance, chain additivity is strictly weaker than d -monotonicity, and only the latter produces a measure on boxes.

Example 2.3. (i) $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$, q Lebesgue measure: $\mathbb{T}_{\leq t} = [0, t]$ and $C_t = \int_0^t g(X_u) du$.

This is [3] and [2] throughout.

(ii) $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$, q counting measure: $C_n = \sum_{0 \leq k \leq n} g(X_k)$, discrete time.

(iii) $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$, q with atoms: processes with fixed times of discontinuity, the subject of [2], Section 5.3.

(iv) $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+^d$, q Lebesgue measure: $\mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ is the box $[0, t]$ and $C_t = \int_{[0,t]} g(X_u) du$, the multiparameter martingale problem.

All four are clocks in the sense of Definition 2.2; (i), (ii) and (iv) are shift invariant, and only (i) and (ii) are reflective.

Remark 2.4 (Optional or predictable: both). The compensator of Definition 3.5 is $C_t = \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_\iota} g(X_u) q(du)$, and the two choices of ι genuinely differ. For $\iota = o$ the compensator is right continuous; for $\iota = p$ it is predictable and left continuous. They agree exactly when the clock is atomless, in particular in Example 2.3(i) — which is why the choice is invisible in [3] and [2], and why neither source has to make it.

We carry both. The reason is that neither serves the whole manuscript: Theorem 4.3 holds only for $\iota = o$, because an atom of q at t must lie inside the compensator up to t for (R3) to hold, and it is that limit which makes the càdlàg process a *modification*; Proposition 6.2 holds only for $\iota = p$, because otherwise the chain identity telescopes to $\gamma(t, 0) - \gamma(0, t) \neq 0$ and discrete-time duality fails. Everything else — Sections 3 and 5, and Lemma 6.1 itself — is convention-agnostic, using only the additivity (3), which holds for both. Remark 6.3 states the trade-off precisely, and Section 2.9 records which ι each result needs.

Two special cases are worth keeping in view. For $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$ with counting measure, $\iota = p$ gives $C_n = \sum_{k \leq n} g(X_k)$, the Doob decomposition, with $A = P - I$; $\iota = o$ gives $C_n = \sum_{k < n} g(X_k)$ and the condition $Pf - f = Pg$. For $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ with Lebesgue measure the distinction is empty.

Remark 2.5 (Comparison with [3], Section 2.8). [3], Section 2.8 is the only part of [3] that works with a general index set, and it is worth recording exactly what it does, because three things about it are easy to get wrong.

(i) *What [3] assume.* Their index $\mathcal{I}$ is a *partially* ordered set — their (8.1)–(8.3) include antisymmetry — which is moreover a *metric lattice*: a metric space in which $u \wedge v$ and $u \vee v$ exist, are unique, and depend *continuously* on (u, v) . Separability from above of the intervals is a further hypothesis, imposed where it is needed (their Propositions 8.4, 8.5(c) and Theorem 8.7), not globally. Our (T0) is weaker on one point: we do not assume antisymmetry, because nothing below uses it and Mathlib’s **Preorder** does not have it.

(ii) *The lattice is needed for $\vee$, not for $\wedge$.* It is tempting to say that stopping times require $\tau_1 \wedge \tau_2$. The opposite is true. [3], Proposition 8.1(a) shows that $\max_{k \leq n} \tau_k$ is a stopping time — $\{\max_k \tau_k \leq u\} = \bigcap_k \{\tau_k \leq u\}$ — whereas their Remark 8.3 warns that $\tau \wedge a$ need not be one. The reason is that in a lattice $x \wedge y \leq u$ is strictly weaker than “ $x \leq u$ or $y \leq u$ ”: in $\mathbb{R}_+^2$ one has $(1, 0) \wedge (0, 1) = (0, 0) \leq (0, 0)$ with neither factor below $(0, 0)$. So

$\{\tau \wedge a \leq u\}$ is genuinely larger than $\{\tau \leq u\} \cup \{a \leq u\}$ and there is no reason for it to lie in $\mathcal{F}_u$. [3] therefore replace $\tau \wedge a$ by the truncation $\tau^a = \tau$ on $\{\tau \leq a\}$ and $\tau^a = a$ otherwise, their (8.10). Nor does $\mathcal{F}_\tau$ require infima: their (8.6) is the usual $\{A : A \cap \{\tau \leq u\} \in \mathcal{F}_u\}$, verbatim.

(iii) *What it is for.* [3] build Section 2.8 for their Chapter 6, and it is worth being precise about how it is used there. In their Theorem 6.3.4 the multiparameter index carries the *filtration* $\{\mathcal{F}_u : u \in \mathbb{R}_+^k\}$ and a nondecreasing family of $\mathbb{R}_+^k$ -valued stopping times $\tau(t)$; the processes themselves live in $\prod_k D_{E_k}[0, \infty)$, and so does the time-changed process $Z(t) = Y(\tau(t))$. That is, [3] never index a *process* by $\mathbb{R}_+^d$: the multiparameter index is a device inside a one-parameter theory, and what Section 2.8 delivers for it is optional sampling and nothing else. This is consistent with — indeed is indirect evidence for — Remark 5.10: there is no multiparameter uniqueness or Markov theorem in [3] to measure ours against, because there is none to be had.

(iv) *A conflation we avoid.* [3] declare “we assume throughout this section that $\mathcal{I}$ is a metric lattice” before defining filtration, stopping time, $\mathcal{F}_\tau$, adaptedness and, in their (8.15), the martingale property itself — none of which uses the lattice, and all of which are correct on a bare preorder. The lattice is first used in their Proposition 8.1. This is exactly the conflation that Definition 2.1 is meant to remove, and it is reassuring rather than surprising: the entire martingale layer of this manuscript rests on [3] (8.15) alone, which is stated for a partially ordered index.

Notation for processes

For an E -valued measurable process X on $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, P)$, indexed by $\mathbb{T}$, we write $\mathcal{F}_t^X = \sigma(X(s) : s \leq t)$ and, following [3], (4.3.2),

$$*\mathcal{F}_t^X = \mathcal{F}_t^X \vee \sigma\left(\int_{\langle 0, s \rangle_t} h(X(u)) q(du) : s \leq t, h \in B(E)\right). \quad (4)$$

If X is progressively measurable — in particular if $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T2b) and X is right continuous — then $*\mathcal{F}_t^X = \mathcal{F}_t^X$. Only (T0) and a clock are needed for (4) to make sense.

2.3 The state space

[3] and [2] take the state space E to be Polish throughout. As with the time index, almost nothing needs that, and the parts that do need it need it for visibly different reasons. We therefore separate them.

Definition 2.6. We use the following bundles of assumptions on the state space.

- (E0) $(E, \mathcal{E})$ is a measurable space.
- (E1) (E0), and $(E, \mathcal{E})$ is *standard Borel*: $\mathcal{E}$ is the Borel σ -field of some Polish topology on E , equivalently $(E, \mathcal{E})$ is Borel isomorphic to a Borel subset of a Polish space.
- (E2) (E1), and E carries a separable metrizable topology with $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{B}(E)$.
- (E3) E is Polish.

Thus (E3) $\Rightarrow$ (E2) $\Rightarrow$ (E1) $\Rightarrow$ (E0), and both gaps are inhabited: a Borel non- G_δ subset of $\mathbb{R}$ satisfies (E2) but not (E3), and the space $\mathcal{S}'(\mathbb{R}^d)$ of tempered distributions satisfies (E1) but not (E2), being a Lusin space and hence standard Borel while not metrizable.

Remark 2.7 (What each bundle is for). The four bundles correspond to four different uses, and Section 2.9 records which result makes which.

- (i) *(E0): nothing but measurability.* Sections 3 and 6, and the whole of Section 5.1 apart from Lemma 5.3, mention E only through $B(E)$ and $\mathcal{E}$. [2] already state their duality theorem for measurable E_1, E_2 ; the observation here is that uniqueness and the Markov property are of the same kind.
- (ii) *(E1): regular conditional distributions.* Exactly three items need them — Lemma 5.3, Fact 2.43, and the identification of a law on F by its finite-dimensional distributions. Each is a statement about the Borel structure, not about the topology, and standard Borel is what makes disintegration available.
- (iii) *(E2): separating classes and compact sets.* Section 4 needs a topology: the compact containment condition (28) refers to compact subsets of E , and the two hypotheses on $\mathcal{D}(A)$ refer to $C_b(E)$ separating points and separating measures.
- (iv) *(E3): weak convergence.* Only Section 7, and there only because $D_E[0, \infty)$ has to be Polish for Prohorov's theorem and the Skorokhod representation.

Remark 2.8 (The point of (E1)). The gap between (E1) and (E2) is not academic. Martingale problems for distribution-valued processes — the martingale problem formulation of an SPDE, with $E = \mathcal{S}'(\mathbb{R}^d)$ or $E = \mathcal{D}'(\mathbb{R}^d)$ — live on a state space that is standard Borel but not metrizable. Under (E0) and (E1), Sections 3, 5 and 6 apply to them verbatim, with no new proof. Sections 4 and 7 do not, and the repair is a genuine piece of work rather than a change of hypotheses: one needs a substitute for $D_E[0, \infty)$ and for tightness in it, which for nuclear duals is Mitoma's theorem. That is out of scope here, and is flagged rather than attempted.

2.4 From Chapter 1: operator semigroups

Definition 2.9 ([3], Section 1.1). A one-parameter family $\{T(t) : t \geq 0\}$ of bounded linear operators on L is a *semigroup* if $T(0) = I$ and $T(s+t) = T(s)T(t)$ for all $s, t \geq 0$. It is *strongly continuous* if $\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} T(t)f = f$ for every $f \in L$, and a *contraction semigroup* if $\|T(t)\| \leq 1$ for all $t \geq 0$.

A (possibly unbounded) *linear operator* A on L is a linear map whose domain $\mathcal{D}(A)$ is a subspace of L and whose range $\mathcal{R}(A)$ lies in L . The *(infinitesimal) generator* of a semigroup $\{T(t)\}$ on L is the linear operator A defined by

$$Af = \lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{t} (T(t)f - f), \quad (5)$$

with $\mathcal{D}(A)$ the set of $f \in L$ for which the limit exists.

Definition 2.10 ([3], Section 1.2). A linear operator A on L is *dissipative* if $\|\lambda f - Af\| \geq \lambda \|f\|$ for every $f \in \mathcal{D}(A)$ and $\lambda > 0$. For $A \subset L \times L$ linear, A is dissipative if $\|\lambda f - g\| \geq \lambda \|f\|$ for all $(f, g) \in A$ and $\lambda > 0$.

Definition 2.11 ([3], Section 1.5). Let L be a function space of the type considered in [3], Section 1.5 (for instance $L = B(E)$ with the sup norm). A semigroup $\{T(t)\}$ on L is *measurable* if $t \mapsto T(t)f$ is measurable for each $f \in L$. The *full generator* of a measurable contraction semigroup $\{T(t)\}$ on L is the multivalued operator

$$\hat{A} = \left\{ (f, g) \in L \times L : T(t)f - f = \int_0^t T(s)g \, ds \text{ for all } t \geq 0 \right\}. \quad (6)$$

Fact 2.12 ([3], Proposition 1.5.1). The full generator $\hat{A}$ of a measurable contraction semigroup $\{T(t)\}$ on L is linear and dissipative, and $(\lambda - \hat{A})^{-1}h = \int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda t} T(t)h dt$ for all $h \in \mathcal{R}(\lambda - \hat{A})$ and $\lambda > 0$.

Remark 2.13. Nothing further from [3], Chapter 1 is used below. In particular the Hille–Yosida theorem, cores, multivalued dissipative operators and the exponential formula ([3], Theorems 1.2.6 and 1.4.3, Propositions 1.3.1 and 1.3.3, Corollary 1.6.8) are *not* needed. They enter only through the semigroup-based uniqueness criteria [3], Theorem 4.4.1 and Corollary 4.4.4, which are deliberately not part of this manuscript: uniqueness is obtained here from Theorem 5.28 together with duality (Corollary 6.14), which requires no semigroup theory at all. Should those criteria be wanted later, this subsection is the place to extend.

2.5 From Chapter 2: stochastic processes and martingales

Definition 2.14 ([3], Section 2.1; (T0), except where noted). Let $\mathbb{T}$ carry a clock (Definition 2.2), with σ -field $\mathcal{T}$. An E -valued process X on $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, P)$ is *measurable* if $X : \mathbb{T} \times \Omega \rightarrow E$ is $\mathcal{T} \otimes \mathcal{F}$ -measurable. A *filtration* is an increasing family $(\mathcal{F}_t)_{t \in \mathbb{T}}$ of sub- σ -fields of $\mathcal{F}$. X is $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -*adapted* if $X(t)$ is $\mathcal{F}_t$ -measurable for each t , and $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -*progressive* if for each $t \in \mathbb{T}$ the restriction of X to $\mathbb{T}_{\leq t} \times \Omega$ is $(\mathcal{T} \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}) \otimes \mathcal{F}_t$ -measurable.

Y is a *version* of X if the two have the same finite-dimensional distributions; a *modification* of X if $P\{X(t) = Y(t)\} = 1$ for each $t \in \mathbb{T}$; and *indistinguishable* from X if $P\{X(t) = Y(t) \text{ for all } t \in \mathbb{T}\} = 1$.

A $\mathbb{T} \cup \{\infty\}$ -valued random variable τ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -*stopping time* if $\{\tau \leq t\} \in \mathcal{F}_t$ for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$, and then $\mathcal{F}_\tau = \{F \in \mathcal{F} : F \cap \{\tau \leq t\} \in \mathcal{F}_t \forall t \in \mathbb{T}\}$.

Under (T2b) one says in addition that $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ is *right continuous* if $\mathcal{F}_t = \mathcal{F}_{t+} = \bigcap_{s>t} \mathcal{F}_s$ for all t , and that X is *right continuous* if its paths are; every right continuous adapted process is then progressive. All of the above except this last paragraph needs only (T0), and is exactly [3] (8.1)–(8.6) of their Section 2.8; see Remark 2.5.

Fact 2.15 ([3], Propositions 2.1.2 and 2.1.4; (T2b)). Assume (T2b). If $\tau, \tau_1, \tau_2, \dots$ are $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping times and $c \in \mathbb{T}$, then $\tau_1 + c$, $\tau_1 \wedge c$, $\sup_n \tau_n$ and $\min_{k \leq n} \tau_k$ are $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping times; if $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ is right continuous, so are $\inf_n \tau_n$, $\liminf_n \tau_n$ and $\limsup_n \tau_n$. If X is $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -progressive and τ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping time, then $X(\tau)$ is $\mathcal{F}_\tau$ -measurable on $\{\tau < \infty\}$ and $X(\cdot \wedge \tau)$ is $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -progressive. The linear order is used throughout: on a merely directed index $\tau_1 \wedge \tau_2$ need not be a stopping time at all (Remark 2.5(ii)).

Definition 2.16 ([3], Section 2.2 and (8.15); (T0)). A real-valued $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -adapted process X with $E[|X(t)|] < \infty$ for all t is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -*martingale* if $E[X(t) \mid \mathcal{F}_s] = X(s)$ a.s. for all $s \leq t$ in $\mathbb{T}$, and an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -*submartingale* if $E[X(t) \mid \mathcal{F}_s] \geq X(s)$ a.s. This is [3] (8.15) verbatim, and it is the whole of what the martingale layer of this manuscript uses; it is also `MeasureTheory.Martingale` of Mathlib, which is stated for `[Preorder ι]`.

Fact 2.17 (Regularization along a dense set; [3], Lemma 2.2.8; (T2b)). Let (E, r) be a metric space, $F \subset \mathbb{T}$ dense, and $x : F \rightarrow E$. If $y(t) := \lim_{s \rightarrow t+, s \in F} x(s)$ exists for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$, then y is right continuous; if $y^-(t) := \lim_{s \rightarrow t-, s \in F} x(s)$ exists for every $t > 0$, then y^- is left continuous on $\mathbb{T} \setminus \{0\}$; and if both exist for every $t > 0$, then $y^-(t) = y(t-)$ for all $t > 0$. In particular y is càdlàg, and $y \in D_E[0, \infty)$ when $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T3).

Fact 2.18 (Submartingale regularization; [3], Proposition 2.2.9; (T2b)). Let X be a real-valued $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -submartingale and let $F \subset \mathbb{T}$ be countable and dense. Then there is Ω_0 with $P(\Omega_0) = 1$ such that for every $\omega \in \Omega_0$ the limits

$$Y(t, \omega) = \lim_{s \rightarrow t+, s \in F} X(s, \omega) \quad (t \in \mathbb{T}), \quad Y^-(t, \omega) = \lim_{s \rightarrow t-, s \in F} X(s, \omega) \quad (t > 0) \quad (7)$$

exist. Moreover $\Gamma = \{t : P\{Y(t) \neq Y(t-)\} > 0\}$ is countable, $P\{X(t) = Y(t)\} = 1$ for $t \notin \Gamma$, and setting $\tilde{X}(t) = Y(t)$ for $t \notin \Gamma$ and $\tilde{X}(t) = X(t)$ for $t \in \Gamma$ defines a modification of X almost all of whose sample paths have right and left limits at all $t \in \mathbb{T}$ and are right continuous at all $t \notin \Gamma$.

Fact 2.19 (Optional sampling; [3], Theorem 2.2.13, Remark 2.2.14, and Chapter 2, Problem 11; (T2b)). Let X be a right continuous $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -submartingale and let τ_1, τ_2 be $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping times. Then for each $T > 0$,

$$E[X(\tau_2 \wedge T) \mid \mathcal{F}_{\tau_1}] \geq X(\tau_1 \wedge \tau_2 \wedge T). \quad (8)$$

If in addition τ_2 is a.s. finite, $E[|X(\tau_2)|] < \infty$ and $\lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} E[|X(T)|\mathbf{1}_{\{\tau_2 > T\}}] = 0$, then $E[X(\tau_2) \mid \mathcal{F}_{\tau_1}] \geq X(\tau_1 \wedge \tau_2)$. Equality holds throughout if X is a martingale. In particular, a right continuous martingale with bounded increments satisfies the optional sampling identity at arbitrary a.s. finite stopping times.

Fact 2.20 (Doob's inequalities; [3], Corollary 2.2.17; (T2b)). Let X be a right continuous martingale. Then for $x > 0$, $T > 0$ and $\alpha > 1$,

$$P\left\{\sup_{t \leq T} |X(t)| \geq x\right\} \leq x^{-1} E[|X(T)|], \quad E\left[\sup_{t \leq T} |X(t)|^\alpha\right] \leq \left(\frac{\alpha}{\alpha-1}\right)^\alpha E[|X(T)|^\alpha]. \quad (9)$$

Definition 2.21 ([3], Section 2.3). A real-valued process X is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -local martingale if there exist $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping times $\tau_1 \leq \tau_2 \leq \dots$ with $\tau_n \rightarrow \infty$ a.s. such that $X^{\tau_n} = X(\cdot \wedge \tau_n)$ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -martingale for each n . The sequence (τ_n) is a *localizing sequence*. Local submartingales are defined analogously.

Fact 2.22 ([3], Proposition 2.3.1). If X is a right continuous $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -local martingale and τ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping time, then $X^\tau = X(\cdot \wedge \tau)$ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -local martingale.

2.6 From Chapter 3: weak convergence and the Skorokhod space

Everything in this subsection assumes (T3), $\mathbb{T} = [0, \infty)$, and is stated for it without further comment: the Skorokhod topology is defined through time changes $\lambda : [0, \infty) \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ (Definition 2.34) and has no counterpart on a general index. This is the one block of prerequisites that does not abstract, and Section 2.9 records which results inherit the restriction.

Throughout this subsection (S, d) is a metric space.

Definition 2.23 ([3], Section 3.3). $P_n \Rightarrow P$ in $\mathcal{P}(S)$ (*weak convergence*) if $\int f dP_n \rightarrow \int f dP$ for every $f \in C_b(S)$. S -valued random variables X_n converge in distribution to X , written $X_n \Rightarrow X$, if $PX_n^{-1} \Rightarrow PX^{-1}$.

Fact 2.24 (Portmanteau; [3], Theorem 3.3.1). For $\{P_n\} \subset \mathcal{P}(S)$ and $P \in \mathcal{P}(S)$, conditions (b)–(f) below are equivalent and are implied by (a); if S is separable, all six are equivalent.

- (a) $\rho(P_n, P) \rightarrow 0$, where ρ is the Prohorov metric;
- (b) $P_n \Rightarrow P$;
- (c) $\int f dP_n \rightarrow \int f dP$ for all uniformly continuous $f \in C_b(S)$;
- (d) $\liminf_n P_n(F) \leq P(F)$ for all closed $F \subset S$;
- (e) $\limsup_n P_n(G) \geq P(G)$ for all open $G \subset S$;
- (f) $P_n(A) \rightarrow P(A)$ for all P -continuity sets $A \subset S$, i.e. all $A \in \mathcal{B}(S)$ with $P(\partial A) = 0$.

Fact 2.25 (Continuous mapping theorem; [3], Corollary 3.1.9 and Corollary 3.3.3). Let (S, d) and (S', d') be separable metric spaces and $h : S \rightarrow S'$ Borel measurable. Let C_h be the set of points at which h is continuous. If $P_n \Rightarrow P$ and $P(C_h) = 1$, then $P_n h^{-1} \Rightarrow P h^{-1}$. Moreover, if $X_n \Rightarrow X$ and $d(X_n, Y_n) \rightarrow 0$ in probability, then $Y_n \Rightarrow X$.

Fact 2.26 ([3], Theorems 3.1.7 and 3.1.8). If S is separable, then $\mathcal{P}(S)$ is separable; if (S, d) is complete and separable, then so is $\mathcal{P}(S)$ with the Prohorov metric. Moreover (*Skorokhod representation*), if S is separable and $P_n \Rightarrow P$, there are S -valued random variables X_n, X on a common probability space with laws P_n, P and $X_n \rightarrow X$ a.s.

Fact 2.27 (Prohorov; [3], Lemma 3.2.1 and Theorem 3.2.2). Call $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{P}(S)$ *tight* if for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is a compact $K \subset S$ with $\inf_{P \in \mathcal{M}} P(K) \geq 1 - \varepsilon$. If (S, d) is complete and separable, then every $P \in \mathcal{P}(S)$ is tight, and $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{P}(S)$ is tight if and only if it is relatively compact.

Definition 2.28 ([3], Section 3.4 and Appendix 3). A sequence $\{f_n\} \subset B(S)$ *converges boundedly and pointwise* to $f \in B(S)$, written $\text{bp-lim}_n f_n = f$, if $\sup_n \|f_n\| < \infty$ and $f_n(x) \rightarrow f(x)$ for every $x \in S$. A set $M \subset B(S)$ is *bp-closed* if it is closed under bp-limits of sequences, and the *bp-closure* of M is the smallest bp-closed set containing it. The same terminology is used for subsets of $B(S) \times B(S)$, applying bp-lim in each coordinate.

Fact 2.29 ([3], Lemma 3.4.1, Proposition 3.4.2, and Appendix 3, Proposition 3.1). The bp-closure of a subspace of $B(S)$ is a subspace. $C_b(S)$ is bp-dense in $B(S)$, and if S is separable there is a sequence $\{f_n\}$ of nonnegative functions in $C_b(S)$ whose linear span is bp-dense in $B(S)$. Furthermore, for sequences in $B(S)$ bounded pointwise convergence coincides with convergence in the weak* topology induced by $V(S)$.

Definition 2.30 ([3], Section 3.4). $M \subset C_b(S)$ is *separating* if, for $P, Q \in \mathcal{P}(S)$, $\int f dP = \int f dQ$ for all $f \in M$ implies $P = Q$; it is *convergence determining* if, for $\{P_n\} \subset \mathcal{P}(S)$ and $P \in \mathcal{P}(S)$, $\int f dP_n \rightarrow \int f dP$ for all $f \in M$ implies $P_n \Rightarrow P$. M *separates points* if for $x \neq y$ there is $f \in M$ with $f(x) \neq f(y)$, and *strongly separates points* if for every $x \in S$ and $\delta > 0$ there are $h_1, \dots, h_k \in M$ with $\inf_{y: d(y, x) \geq \delta} \max_{i \leq k} |h_i(y) - h_i(x)| > 0$. Every convergence determining set is separating.

Fact 2.31 ([3], Proposition 3.4.4). If (S, d) is separable, then the set of uniformly continuous $f \in C_b(S)$ with bounded support is convergence determining. If S is in addition locally compact, then $C_c(S)$ is convergence determining.

Fact 2.32 (Stone–Weierstrass for separating classes; [3], Theorem 3.4.5). Let (S, d) be complete and separable and let $M \subset C_b(S)$ be an algebra. If M separates points, then M is separating. If M strongly separates points, then M is convergence determining.

Fact 2.33 ([3], Proposition 3.4.6 and Proposition 3.7.1). Let (S_k, d_k) , $k \geq 1$, be separable and $S = \prod_{k \geq 1} S_k$. If $M_k \subset C_b(S_k)$ are separating, then

$$M = \left\{ x \mapsto \prod_{k=1}^n f_k(x_k) : n \geq 1, f_k \in M_k \cup \{1\} \right\} \quad (10)$$

is separating on S ; if the (S_k, d_k) are complete and separable and the M_k are convergence determining, so is M . In particular the finite-dimensional distributions of a process determine its law. Moreover, for $\pi_t : D_E[0, \infty) \rightarrow E$, $\pi_t(x) = x(t)$, one has $\mathcal{B}(D_E[0, \infty)) = \sigma(\pi_t : t \geq 0) = \sigma(\pi_t : t \in D)$ for any dense $D \subset [0, \infty)$, provided E is separable; hence the finite-dimensional distributions of a process with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$ determine its law on $D_E[0, \infty)$.

Definition 2.34 ([3], Section 3.5). $D_E[0, \infty)$ is the space of right continuous $x : [0, \infty) \rightarrow E$ having left limits $x(t-)$ for all $t > 0$ (with $x(0-) = x(0)$). Let $q = r \wedge 1$, let Λ' be the set of strictly increasing continuous $\lambda : [0, \infty) \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ onto with $\lambda(0) = 0$, and let $\Lambda \subset \Lambda'$ be those λ which are Lipschitz with

$$\gamma(\lambda) = \text{ess sup}_{t \geq 0} |\log \lambda'(t)| = \sup_{s > t \geq 0} \left| \log \frac{\lambda(s) - \lambda(t)}{s - t} \right| < \infty. \quad (11)$$

The Skorokhod (J_1) metric on $D_E[0, \infty)$ is

$$d(x, y) = \inf_{\lambda \in \Lambda} \left[\gamma(\lambda) \vee \int_0^\infty e^{-u} d(x, y, \lambda, u) du \right], \quad (12)$$

where

$$d(x, y, \lambda, u) = \sup_{t \geq 0} q(x(t \wedge u), y(\lambda(t) \wedge u)). \quad (13)$$

Fact 2.35 ([3], Lemma 3.5.1 and Theorem 3.5.6). Every $x \in D_E[0, \infty)$ has at most countably many discontinuities. If E is separable, then $D_E[0, \infty)$ is separable; if (E, r) is complete, then $(D_E[0, \infty), d)$ is complete. In particular, $D_E[0, \infty)$ is Polish whenever E is Polish.

Fact 2.36 (Compact sets of $D_E[0, \infty)$; [3], Lemma 3.6.2 and Theorem 3.6.3). For $x \in D_E[0, \infty)$, $\delta > 0$ and $T > 0$ define the modulus

$$w'(x, \delta, T) = \inf_{\{t_i\}} \max_i \sup_{s, t \in [t_{i-1}, t_i)} r(x(s), x(t)), \quad (14)$$

the infimum being over all partitions $0 = t_0 < t_1 < \dots < t_n$ with $T \leq t_n$ and $\min_i(t_i - t_{i-1}) > \delta$. Then $w'(x, \delta, T) \rightarrow 0$ as $\delta \rightarrow 0$, $w'(\cdot, \delta, T)$ is Borel measurable, and, for (E, r) complete, the closure of $A \subset D_E[0, \infty)$ is compact if and only if

- (a) for every rational $t \geq 0$ there is a compact $\Gamma_t \subset E$ with $x(t) \in \Gamma_t$ for all $x \in A$, and
- (b) $\lim_{\delta \rightarrow 0} \sup_{x \in A} w'(x, \delta, T) = 0$ for each $T > 0$.

Fact 2.37 ([3], Lemma 3.7.7). If X has sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$, then $D(X) := \{t \geq 0 : P\{X(t) = X(t-)\} = 1\}$ has at most countable complement in $[0, \infty)$. In particular $D(X)$ is dense.

Fact 2.38 ([3], Theorem 3.7.8). Let E be separable and let X_n, X have sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$.

- (a) If $X_n \Rightarrow X$ in $D_E[0, \infty)$, then $(X_n(t_1), \dots, X_n(t_k)) \Rightarrow (X(t_1), \dots, X(t_k))$ for every finite $\{t_1, \dots, t_k\} \subset D(X)$.
- (b) If $\{X_n\}$ is relatively compact and there is a dense $D \subset [0, \infty)$ such that the convergence in (a) holds for every finite subset of D , then $X_n \Rightarrow X$ in $D_E[0, \infty)$.

Fact 2.39 (Relative compactness, I; [3], Theorem 3.9.1). Let (E, r) be complete and separable and let $\{X_n\}$ be a family of processes with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$ satisfying the compact containment condition: for every $\eta, T > 0$ there is a compact $\Gamma_{\eta, T} \subset E$ with

$$\inf_n P\{X_n(t) \in \Gamma_{\eta, T} \text{ for } 0 \leq t \leq T\} \geq 1 - \eta. \quad (15)$$

Let $H \subset C_b(E)$ be dense in the topology of uniform convergence on compact sets. Then $\{X_n\}$ is relatively compact if and only if $\{f \circ X_n\}$ is relatively compact in $D_{\mathbb{R}}[0, \infty)$ for each $f \in H$.

Fact 2.40 (Relative compactness, II; [3], Theorem 3.9.4). Let (E, r) be arbitrary and let X_n have sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$, adapted to filtrations $(\mathcal{F}_t^n)$. Let $\mathcal{L}_n$ be the Banach space of real-valued $(\mathcal{F}_t^n)$ -progressive processes with $\|Y\| = \sup_{t \geq 0} E[|Y(t)|] < \infty$ and put

$$\mathcal{A}_n = \left\{ (Y, Z) \in \mathcal{L}_n \times \mathcal{L}_n : Y(t) - \int_0^t Z(s) ds \text{ is an } (\mathcal{F}_t^n)\text{-martingale} \right\}. \quad (16)$$

Let $C_a \subset C_b(E)$ be a subalgebra and let D be the collection of $f \in C_b(E)$ such that for every $\varepsilon, T > 0$ there is $(Y_n, Z_n) \in \mathcal{A}_n$ with

$$\sup_n E \left[\sup_{t \in [0, T] \cap \mathbb{Q}} |Y_n(t) - f(X_n(t))| \right] < \varepsilon, \quad \sup_n E[\|Z_n\|_{p, T}] < \infty \text{ for some } p \in (1, \infty]. \quad (17)$$

If C_a is contained in the sup-norm closure of D , then $\{f \circ X_n\}$ is relatively compact for each $f \in C_a$; more generally $\{(f_1, \dots, f_k) \circ X_n\}$ is relatively compact in $D_{\mathbb{R}^k}[0, \infty)$ for all $f_1, \dots, f_k \in C_a$.

2.7 From the Appendixes of [3]

Fact 2.41 (Uniform integrability; [3], Appendix 2). A family $\{X_i\}$ of real-valued random variables is *uniformly integrable* if $\sup_i E[|X_i|] < \infty$ and for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is $\delta > 0$ such that $P(A) < \delta$ implies $|E[X_i \mathbf{1}_A]| < \varepsilon$ for all i . Equivalently, $\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \sup_i E[|X_i| - |X_i| \wedge N] = 0$; equivalently, there is an increasing convex φ on $[0, \infty)$ with $\varphi(x)/x \rightarrow \infty$ and $\sup_i E[\varphi(|X_i|)] < \infty$. If $X_n \Rightarrow X$ and $\{X_n\}$ is uniformly integrable, then $E[X_n] \rightarrow E[X]$.

Fact 2.42 (Monotone class theorem; [3], Appendix 4). Let H be a linear space of bounded real-valued functions on Ω containing the constants and closed under bounded monotone limits, and let $K \subset H$ be closed under multiplication. Then H contains every bounded $\sigma(K)$ -measurable function.

Fact 2.43 (Conditional determination by separating sets; [3], Chapter 3, Problem 7). Assume (E1) and (E2), let $\mathcal{G} \subset \mathcal{F}$ be a sub- σ -field, let $M \subset C_b(E)$ be separating, and let U, V be E -valued random variables with V $\mathcal{G}$ -measurable. If $E[f(U) \mid \mathcal{G}] = f(V)$ a.s. for every $f \in M$, then $P\{U = V\} = 1$.

Remark 2.44 ([3], Chapter 3, Problem 7 — a proof). This is stated as a *problem* in [3] and is used in the last step of Theorem 4.3, so we prove it. The point worth making is that the countability the argument needs comes from the *state space*, not from M : no countable subfamily of M is assumed, and none is available in general.

Step 1: M separating gives conditional equality in law. Let $G \in \mathcal{G}$ with $P(G) > 0$. For $f \in M$, the hypothesis gives $E[\mathbf{1}_G f(U)] = E[\mathbf{1}_G E[f(U) \mid \mathcal{G}]] = E[\mathbf{1}_G f(V)]$. The two probability measures

$$\nu_1(B) = \frac{P(\{U \in B\} \cap G)}{P(G)}, \quad \nu_2(B) = \frac{P(\{V \in B\} \cap G)}{P(G)}, \quad B \in \mathcal{E},$$

therefore satisfy $\int f d\nu_1 = \int f d\nu_2$ for every $f \in M$, and since M is separating, $\nu_1 = \nu_2$. Hence

$$P(\{U \in B\} \cap G) = P(\{V \in B\} \cap G) \quad \text{for all } B \in \mathcal{E}, G \in \mathcal{G}, \quad (18)$$

i.e. $P(U \in B \mid \mathcal{G}) = \mathbf{1}_B(V)$ a.s. for each fixed B .

Step 2: one null set, using (E1). By (E1) the σ -field $\mathcal{E}$ is countably generated; let $\mathcal{E}_0$ be a countable algebra generating it. Again by (E1) there is a regular conditional distribution $\mu(\omega, \cdot)$ of U given $\mathcal{G}$. Applying (18) to the countably many $B \in \mathcal{E}_0$ yields a single set of full measure off which $\mu(\omega, B) = \mathbf{1}_B(V(\omega))$ for all $B \in \mathcal{E}_0$ simultaneously. Two probability measures agreeing on a generating algebra agree, so $\mu(\omega, \cdot) = \delta_{V(\omega)}$ a.s.

Step 3. The diagonal $\{(x, \omega) : x = V(\omega)\}$ is $\mathcal{E} \otimes \mathcal{G}$ -measurable, again because $\mathcal{E}$ is countably generated and separates points, so $P\{U = V\} = E[\mu(\cdot, \{V(\cdot)\})] = E[\delta_V(\{V\})] = 1$.

Only (E2) is used, in Step 1, to make sense of “ $M \subset C_b(E)$ separating”; all the measure theory is (E1).

2.8 Where the prerequisites are used

Prerequisite	Used in
Definition 2.10	Proposition 3.13, Fact 2.12
Fact 2.12	Remark 3.14
Fact 2.15	Theorem 5.28(b), Corollary 6.12
Fact 2.17, 2.18	Theorem 4.3
Fact 2.19	Theorem 5.11
Fact 2.20	Remark 7.16 (via Fact 2.40)
Fact 2.22	Remarks 5.30, 7.22
Fact 2.24, 2.25	Lemma 7.15, Theorem 7.21
Fact 2.26, 2.27	Remark 7.16
Fact 2.29	Remark 3.9
Fact 2.31	Remark 4.8
Fact 2.32	Remark 7.16
Fact 2.33	Theorem 5.9, Corollary 5.29, Example 3.4
Fact 2.35	Setting 3.1, Theorem 7.21
Fact 2.36	Fact 2.39
Fact 2.37	Lemma 7.15, Theorem 7.21
Fact 2.38	Remark 7.16
Fact 2.39, 2.40	Remark 7.16
Fact 2.41	Theorem 7.21
Fact 2.42	Proposition 3.7, Example 3.4
Fact 2.43	Theorem 4.3

2.9 Which result needs which bundle

The counterpart of Section 2.8 for Definitions 2.1, 2.2 and 2.6. “Clock” means Definition 2.2 with no further property; “reflective” is as defined there, and ι is the convention of Definition 2.2, shown only where it matters. Bold entries mark the places where the weakest bundle in its column does *not* suffice, for a mathematical reason rather than for convenience; the two ι -entries are the only places in the manuscript where the two conventions part company.

Result	Index	State	Clock
Definition 2.14, Definition 2.16	(T0)	(E0)	clock
Facts 2.15, 2.19, 2.20	(T2b)	(E0)	—
Facts 2.17, 2.18 (regularization)	(T2b)	(E2)	—
Section 2.6 entire (Skorokhod, weak convergence)	(T3)	(E3)	—
Setting 3.1, Definitions 3.2, 3.3	(T0)	(E0)	—
Definition 3.5, Proposition 3.7, Definition 3.10, (4)	(T0)	(E0)	clock
Lemma 3.11, Proposition 3.13	(T3)	(E0)	Lebesgue
Definition 3.15, Example 3.4	(T2b)	(E2)	—
Definition 4.2, Theorem 4.3 (càdlàg)	(T2b)	(E2)	$\iota = \mathbf{o}$
Theorem 4.5 ([3] 4.3.6)	(T2b)	(E2)	clock, $\iota = \mathbf{o}$
Lemma 5.2 (mixtures)	(T0)	(E0)	—
Lemma 5.3 (disintegration)	(T0)	(E1)	—
Definition 5.5, Lemma 5.8 (restart)	(T0) + (T4)	(E0)	clock
Theorem 5.9(a) (Markov)	(T0) + (T4)	(E0)	clock
Theorem 5.9(b) (uniqueness)	(T2a) + (T4)	(E0)	clock
Theorem 5.11 (strong Markov)	(T2b) + (T4)	(E2)	clock
Definition 5.13, Lemmas 5.15, 5.17, 5.19, Theorem 5.20 (local theory)	(T2b) + (T4)	(E0)	clock
Definition 5.24, Lemma 5.25, Theorem 5.26 (local uniqueness)	(T2b) + (T4)	(E0)	clock
Lemma 6.1 (chain identity)	(T0) + (T4)	(E0)	clock
Proposition 6.2, Corollary 6.10	(T2a) + (T4)	(E0)	reflective, $\iota = \mathbf{p}$
Lemma 6.5, Theorem 6.6	(T3)	(E0)	Lebesgue
Corollary 6.14 (uniqueness via duality)	(T3)	(E2)	Lebesgue
Setting 7.2, Theorem 7.5 (jump processes)	(T3)	(E0)	Lebesgue
Proposition 7.6, Remark 7.7	(T3)	(E2)	Lebesgue
Corollary 7.13 (from SDEs)	(T3)	$E = \mathbb{R}^d$	Lebesgue
Theorem 7.18 (abstract convergence)	(T0), or (T2b) for $D \subsetneq \mathbb{T}$	(E3)	—
Lemma 7.15, Theorem 7.21	(T3)	(E3)	Lebesgue

Two readings of this table are worth recording. First, the partially ordered case — and with it the multiparameter index $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+^d$ — survives in Section 3, in the Markov half of Section 5 and in the abstract convergence theorem, and dies everywhere else; the two bold entries are where it dies for a *mathematical* reason rather than for want of a Skorokhod space, and Remarks 5.10 and 6.4 say which. Second, (T1') — the metric lattice of [3], Section 2.8, which the first draft of this manuscript treated as the base assumption — does not occur at all: every statement involving a stopping time already assumes (T2b), under

which the lattice structure is automatic. See Remark 2.5.

3 Martingale problems

3.1 The abstract (local) martingale problem

Setting 3.1 (after [2], Section 3.1; (T0) + (E0)). Let $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{F} = (\mathcal{F}_t)_{t \in \mathbb{T}})$ be a filtered space carrying a family $\mathbb{X}$ of real-valued adapted processes (the *test processes*), right continuous if $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T2b). Let $(E, \mathcal{E})$ be a measurable space and let $F \subset E^{\mathbb{T}}$ be a *path space*: a set of maps $\mathbb{T} \rightarrow E$ equipped with a σ -field $\mathcal{S}$ for which the coordinates $\pi_t : F \rightarrow E$ are measurable and which they generate,

$$\mathcal{S} = \sigma(\pi_t : t \in \mathbb{T}). \quad (19)$$

Let $X = (X_t)_{t \in \mathbb{T}}$ be an E -valued process with $X(\omega) \in F$ for every ω and $\omega \mapsto X(\omega)$ measurable $\mathcal{F}/\mathcal{S}$.

Under (E3) we take F to carry a Polish topology and $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{B}(F)$; (19) is then a theorem rather than an assumption for $F = D_E[0, \infty)$ (Fact 2.33), and it is what makes the finite-dimensional distributions determine the law.

Definition 3.2 ([2], Definition 3.2; (T0) + (E0)). A probability measure P on $(\Omega, \mathcal{F})$ is a *solution of the martingale problem* $\text{MP}(\mathbb{X})$ if every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ is an $(\mathbb{F}, P)$ -martingale, and a *solution of the local martingale problem* if every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ is an $(\mathbb{F}, P)$ -local martingale. The corresponding sets of solutions are denoted $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X})$ and $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X})$.

Definition 3.3 ([2], Definitions 3.3 and 3.5; (T0) + (E0)). $\mathbb{X}$ is *canonical* for X if for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$ there is a set $\mathbb{X}_t^\circ$ of $\mathcal{B}(F)/\mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R})$ -measurable maps $Y_t^\circ : F \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ satisfies $Y_t = Y_t^\circ(X)$ for some $Y_t^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_t^\circ$. A family $\mathbb{Z}^\circ = \{Z_t^\circ : t \in \mathbb{T}\}$ of sets of bounded measurable maps $F \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is *determining* for $\mathbb{X}$ if for every probability measure P , every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ and all $s \leq t$ with $Y_s, Y_t \in L^1(P)$,

$$E^P[Y_t Z_s^\circ(X)] = E^P[Y_s Z_s^\circ(X)] \quad \text{for all } Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ \quad \implies \quad E^P[Y_t | \mathcal{F}_s] = Y_s \quad P\text{-a.s.}$$

Example 3.4 ([2], Example 3.6(i); (T2b) + (E2)). If $\mathcal{F}_t = \sigma(X_s : s \leq t)$, $F = D_E[0, \infty)$ or $F = C_E[0, \infty)$, and $D \subset \mathbb{T}$ is dense, then

$$\mathbb{Z}_t^\circ = \left\{ \prod_{i=1}^n h_i(X_{t_i}) : n \in \mathbb{N}, t_1, \dots, t_n \in D \cap [0, t], h_i \in C_b(E) \right\}$$

is determining. This uses $\mathcal{B}(F) = \sigma(X_t : t \in \mathbb{T})$ (Fact 2.33) and the monotone class theorem.

3.2 The Markovian martingale problem

Definition 3.5 ((T0) + (E0) + clock). Fix a clock q on $\mathbb{T}$ and a convention $\iota \in \{o, p\}$ (Definition 2.2). Let $A \subset M(E) \times M(E)$ and let X be a jointly measurable E -valued process on $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, P)$. Put

$$\mathbb{X}_A^\iota(X) = \left\{ (f(X(t)) - \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_\iota} g(X(s)) q(ds))_{t \in \mathbb{T}} : (f, g) \in A \right\}, \quad (20)$$

and write $\mathbb{X}_A(X)$ when the convention is fixed by the context or immaterial. X is a *solution of the martingale problem for A* if every element of $\mathbb{X}_A(X)$ is a martingale with

respect to $(\mathcal{F}_t^X)_{t \in \mathbb{T}}$ of (4). If $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ is a filtration with $\mathcal{G}_t \supset \mathcal{F}_t^X$ for all t and every element of $\mathbb{X}_A(X)$ is a $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -martingale, X is a *solution of the martingale problem for A with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$* . Given $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$, X solves the martingale problem for (A, μ) if in addition $PX(0)^{-1} = \mu$. Replacing “martingale” by “local martingale” throughout defines the *local martingale problem* for A .

A probability measure $P \in \mathcal{P}(D_E[0, \infty))$ is called a solution of the $D_E[0, \infty)$ *martingale problem* for A , respectively for (A, μ) , if the coordinate process $X(t, \omega) = \omega(t)$ on the space $(D_E[0, \infty), \mathcal{B}(D_E[0, \infty)), P)$ is one.

Definition 3.5 is the special case $\mathbb{X} = \mathbb{X}_A(X)$ of Definition 3.2.

Remark 3.6 (Provenance of Definition 3.2). The abstract formulation is older than [2]. [4], Definition III.1.3 already attaches a martingale problem to a family $\mathcal{X}$ of optional processes on a filtered space carrying no measure, and does so with *local* martingales as the default rather than as a variant. Two features of their formulation are worth importing. First, the initial condition is a measure $P_{\mathcal{H}}$ on an *initial σ -field* $\mathcal{H} \subset \mathcal{F}_0$, not merely an initial distribution $\mu = P\pi_0^{-1}$; everything below goes through with $\sigma(\pi_0)$ replaced by $\mathcal{H}$, and Lemma 5.3 in particular. Second, [4], Remark III.1.6 notes explicitly that the elements of $\mathcal{X}$ need be neither càdlàg nor even adapted — which is the observation that Setting 4.1 needs and that [2]’s standing assumptions exclude.

Proposition 3.7 ([3], (3.4); (T0) + (E0) + clock). *Let X be jointly measurable, fix $\iota \in \{\circ, \mathfrak{p}\}$, and let $(f, g) \in A$ be such that $Y_t^{f,g} = f(X(t)) - \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_\iota} g(X(s)) q(ds)$ is integrable for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$. Then $Y^{f,g}$ is a $(\mathcal{F}_t^X)$ -martingale if and only if*

$$E \left[\left(f(X(t)) - f(X(s)) - \int_{\langle s, t \rangle_\iota} g(X(u)) q(du) \right) \prod_{k=1}^n h_k(X(t_k)) \right] = 0 \quad (21)$$

for all $s \leq t$ in $\mathbb{T}$, all $n \geq 0$, all $t_1, \dots, t_n \in \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$ and all $h_1, \dots, h_n \in B(E)$ (equivalently, $h_k \in C_b(E)$). Consequently X solves the martingale problem for A if and only if (21) holds for every $(f, g) \in A$.

Remark 3.8 (The times need not form a chain). Earlier versions of this manuscript quantified (21) over *chains* $t_1 \leq \dots \leq t_n \leq s$, following [3], (3.4), where $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ is linearly ordered and the two formulations coincide. On a preordered index they do not, and the chain version is too weak: the proof below tests against the generators of $\mathcal{F}_s^X = \sigma(X_u : u \in \mathbb{T}_{\leq s})$, and these are products over *arbitrary* finite subsets of $\mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$. On $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+^2$ the times $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$ lie in $\mathbb{T}_{\leq (1, 1)}$ without being comparable, and no chain reaches the product $h_1(X_{(1, 0)})h_2(X_{(0, 1)})$. This is the same phenomenon as in Remark 5.10, but with the opposite moral: here it is the *hypothesis* that has to be strengthened, and once it is, nothing is lost.

Proof. Throughout, $s \leq t$ are fixed, $Y = Y^{f,g}$, and we abbreviate

$$I_u^h = \int_{\langle 0, u \rangle_\iota} h(X(v)) q(dv), \quad u \in \mathbb{T}, \quad h \in B(E),$$

so that $\mathcal{F}_s^X = \sigma(X(u), I_u^h : u \in \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}, h \in B(E))$ by (4). Note $|I_u^h| \leq \|h\| q(\mathbb{T}_{\leq u}) < \infty$, so each I_u^h is *bounded*, by Definition 2.2. By (3),

$$Y_t - Y_s = f(X(t)) - f(X(s)) - \int_{\langle s, t \rangle_\iota} g(X(u)) q(du), \quad (22)$$

which is the bracket in (21); it lies in L^1 by hypothesis.

Necessity. Each $\prod_k h_k(X(t_k))$ with $t_k \leq s$ is bounded and $\mathcal{F}_s^X \subset {}^*\mathcal{F}_s^X$ -measurable, so the martingale property gives $E[(Y_t - Y_s) \prod_k h_k(X(t_k))] = 0$, which by (22) is (21).

Sufficiency. Assume (21) and put

$$\mathcal{H} = \{W : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \text{ bounded, } {}^*\mathcal{F}_s^X\text{-measurable, } E[(Y_t - Y_s)W] = 0\}.$$

We must show that $\mathcal{H}$ contains *all* such W , for then $E[Y_t | {}^*\mathcal{F}_s^X] = Y_s$.

Step 1: $\mathcal{H}$ is a monotone vector space. It is a vector space because $W \mapsto E[(Y_t - Y_s)W]$ is linear, and it contains the constants by (21) with $n = 0$. If $W_m \in \mathcal{H}$, $0 \leq W_m \uparrow W$ with W bounded, then $(Y_t - Y_s)W_m \rightarrow (Y_t - Y_s)W$ pointwise and $|(Y_t - Y_s)W_m| \leq \|W\| |Y_t - Y_s| \in L^1$, so dominated convergence gives $W \in \mathcal{H}$.

Step 2: a multiplicative generating class. Let $\mathcal{K}$ be the set of finite products

$$Z = \prod_{k=1}^n h_k(X(t_k)) \cdot \prod_{j=1}^m I_{u_j}^{g_j}, \quad n, m \geq 0, \quad t_k, u_j \in \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}, \quad h_k, g_j \in B(E). \quad (23)$$

Every such Z is bounded, $\mathcal{K}$ is closed under multiplication, and $\sigma(\mathcal{K}) = {}^*\mathcal{F}_s^X$ by (4).

Step 3: $\mathcal{K} \subset \mathcal{H}$. This is the only step with content, and it is Fubini rather than an approximation. Fix Z as in (23) and write the product of the m integrals as one integral over the product:

$$\prod_{j=1}^m I_{u_j}^{g_j} = \int_{(0, u_1] \times \cdots \times (0, u_m]} \prod_{j=1}^m g_j(X(v_j)) q^{\otimes m}(dv), \quad v = (v_1, \dots, v_m).$$

The map $(v, \omega) \mapsto (Y_t - Y_s)(\omega) \prod_k h_k(X(t_k, \omega)) \prod_j g_j(X(v_j, \omega))$ is $\mathcal{T}^{\otimes m} \otimes \mathcal{F}$ -measurable, because X is jointly measurable, and it is dominated by $\|h\| \|g\| |Y_t - Y_s|$, which is integrable for $P \otimes q^{\otimes m}$ since $Y_t - Y_s \in L^1(P)$ and $q^{\otimes m}((0, u_1] \times \cdots \times (0, u_m]) \leq \prod_j q(\mathbb{T}_{\leq u_j}) < \infty$. Fubini therefore applies and gives

$$E[(Y_t - Y_s)Z] = \int_{(0, u_1] \times \cdots \times (0, u_m]} E\left[(Y_t - Y_s) \prod_{k=1}^n h_k(X(t_k)) \prod_{j=1}^m g_j(X(v_j))\right] q^{\otimes m}(dv).$$

For each v in the domain of integration the times $t_1, \dots, t_n, v_1, \dots, v_m$ all lie in $\mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$, and the functions $h_1, \dots, h_n, g_1, \dots, g_m$ are bounded; so the inner expectation vanishes by (21), applied with $n + m$ in place of n . Hence $E[(Y_t - Y_s)Z] = 0$. *This is the step for which the times in (21) must be allowed to be an arbitrary finite subset of $\mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$: the v_j are produced by the integration and cannot be ordered into a chain with the t_k .*

Step 4: conclusion. By Steps 1–3 and the functional monotone class theorem (Fact 2.42), $\mathcal{H}$ contains every bounded $\sigma(\mathcal{K})$ -measurable function, i.e. every bounded ${}^*\mathcal{F}_s^X$ -measurable function. Since $s \leq t$ were arbitrary, Y is a $({}^*\mathcal{F}_t^X)$ -martingale.

The variant with $h_k \in C_b(E)$. On a metric space $C_b(E)$ generates $\mathcal{B}(E)$, so the class (23) built from $C_b(E)$ has the same generated σ -field, and Steps 1–4 are unchanged. Passing from $h_k \in C_b(E)$ back to $h_k \in B(E)$ in (21) is again Step 1 applied one coordinate at a time.

What was used. Only the preorder, through $\mathbb{T}_{\leq u} \subset \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$ for $u \leq s$ and through the additivity (3); the finiteness $q(\mathbb{T}_{\leq u}) < \infty$, twice, for the boundedness of I_u^h and for Fubini; and the joint measurability of X . In particular no topology, no linear order, no property of q beyond Definition 2.2, and no choice of ι : the argument uses only that $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_\iota$ is additive, which (3) gives for both conventions. $\square$

Remark 3.9. Proposition 3.7 says that being a solution of the martingale problem for A is a statement about the *finite-dimensional distributions* of X only. Three consequences are used repeatedly:

- (a) any measurable modification of a solution is a solution;
- (b) a solution for A is a solution for the linear span A_S , and for the bounded pointwise closure of A_S ;
- (c) if $A^{(1)} \subset A^{(2)}$, every solution for $A^{(2)}$ is one for $A^{(1)}$. In particular, if the bp-closures of $A_S^{(1)}$ and $A_S^{(2)}$ agree, the two martingale problems have the same solutions ([3], Proposition 4.3.1).

Definition 3.10 ([3], Section 4.4; (T0) + (E0) + clock). *Uniqueness* holds for the martingale problem for (A, μ) if any two solutions have the same finite-dimensional distributions. The martingale problem for (A, μ) is *well-posed* if a solution exists and uniqueness holds; the martingale problem for A is well-posed if it is well-posed for every $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$. It is *well-posed in* $D_E[0, \infty)$ (resp. $C_E[0, \infty)$) if there is a unique $P \in \mathcal{P}(D_E[0, \infty))$ (resp. $\mathcal{P}(C_E[0, \infty))$) solving the $D_E[0, \infty)$ (resp. $C_E[0, \infty)$) martingale problem for (A, μ) . Well-posedness in $D_E[0, \infty)$ does not imply well-posedness; Theorem 4.5 shows that this gap is rare.

The following two results connect Definition 3.5 with the operator-theoretic notions of Section 2.4.

Lemma 3.11 ([3], Lemma 4.3.2; (T3)). *Let X be a measurable process, $\mathcal{G}_t \supset \mathcal{F}_t^X$, and $f, g \in B(E)$. Then for fixed $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ the process $f(X(t)) - \int_0^t g(X(s)) ds$ is a $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -martingale if and only if*

$$e^{-\lambda t} f(X(t)) + \int_0^t e^{-\lambda u} (\lambda f(X(u)) - g(X(u))) du \quad (24)$$

is a $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -martingale. Consequently, if $(f, g) \in A$, $\lambda > 0$ and X solves the martingale problem for A with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$, then

$$f(X(t)) = E \left[\int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda s} (\lambda f(X(t+s)) - g(X(t+s))) ds \mid \mathcal{G}_t \right]. \quad (25)$$

Proof. Write $Y_t = f(X(t)) - \int_0^t g(X(s)) ds$ and let Z_t denote (24).

Step 1: an identity. We claim

$$Z_t = e^{-\lambda t} Y_t + \lambda \int_0^t e^{-\lambda u} Y_u du. \quad (26)$$

Indeed, substituting $Y_u = f(X(u)) - \int_0^u g(X(v)) dv$ into the right-hand side and using Fubini,

$$\lambda \int_0^t e^{-\lambda u} \int_0^u g(X(v)) dv du = \lambda \int_0^t g(X(v)) \int_v^t e^{-\lambda u} du dv = \int_0^t g(X(v)) (e^{-\lambda v} - e^{-\lambda t}) dv,$$

so the two terms involving g combine to $-e^{-\lambda t} \int_0^t g dv - \int_0^t e^{-\lambda v} g dv + e^{-\lambda t} \int_0^t g dv = -\int_0^t e^{-\lambda v} g(X(v)) dv$, and (26) is (24). Solving (26) for Y — put $W_t = \int_0^t e^{-\lambda u} Y_u du$, so that $Z = W' + \lambda W$ and hence $(e^{\lambda t} W)' = e^{\lambda t} Z_t$ — gives the inverse relation

$$Y_t = e^{\lambda t} Z_t - \lambda \int_0^t e^{\lambda u} Z_u du. \quad (27)$$

Step 2: either relation transports the martingale property. Suppose Y is a $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -martingale. For $s \leq t$ we use (26) together with Fubini for conditional expectations, which is legitimate because $\sup_{u \leq t} E|Y_u| < \infty$:

$$\begin{aligned} E[Z_t | \mathcal{G}_s] &= e^{-\lambda t} Y_s + \lambda \int_0^s e^{-\lambda u} Y_u du + \lambda \int_s^t e^{-\lambda u} Y_s du \\ &= e^{-\lambda t} Y_s + \lambda \int_0^s e^{-\lambda u} Y_u du + Y_s (e^{-\lambda s} - e^{-\lambda t}) = Z_s. \end{aligned}$$

The converse is the same computation applied to (27), with $e^{\lambda u}$ in place of $e^{-\lambda u}$ and $-\lambda$ in place of λ . This proves the equivalence.

Step 3: the resolvent representation. Let $(f, g) \in A$ with f, g bounded and $\lambda > 0$, and let X solve the martingale problem for A with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$, so that Z is a martingale by Step 2. For $r > 0$,

$$Z_t = E[Z_{t+r} | \mathcal{G}_t] = E\left[e^{-\lambda(t+r)} f(X(t+r)) + \int_0^{t+r} e^{-\lambda u} (\lambda f - g)(X(u)) du \mid \mathcal{G}_t\right].$$

As $r \rightarrow \infty$ the first term is bounded by $e^{-\lambda(t+r)} \|f\| \rightarrow 0$ and the second increases to an integral dominated by $\lambda^{-1} \|\lambda f - g\|$, so dominated convergence for conditional expectations gives

$$Z_t = E\left[\int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda u} (\lambda f - g)(X(u)) du \mid \mathcal{G}_t\right].$$

Subtracting $\int_0^t e^{-\lambda u} (\lambda f - g)(X(u)) du$, which is $\mathcal{G}_t$ -measurable, from both sides leaves $e^{-\lambda t} f(X(t)) = E[\int_t^\infty e^{-\lambda u} (\lambda f - g)(X(u)) du \mid \mathcal{G}_t]$, and the substitution $u = t + s$ gives (25). $\square$

Remark 3.12. Step 1 is the only place where $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ and $q = \text{Lebesgue measure}$ are used, and they are used twice: for the exponential $e^{-\lambda t}$, which is the solution of $\phi' = -\lambda\phi$, and for the Fubini rearrangement. On $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$ with q counting measure the analogue holds with $e^{-\lambda}$ replaced by $(1 + \lambda)^{-1}$ and the integrals by sums; we do not need it, and record only that Lemma 3.11 is (T3) for a reason of calculus, not of probability.

Proposition 3.13 ([3], Proposition 4.3.5; (T3)). *Let A be a linear subset of $B(E) \times B(E)$. If for each $x \in E$ there exists a solution X_x of the martingale problem for (A, δ_x) , then A is dissipative in the sense of Definition 2.10.*

Proof. Given $(f, g) \in A$ and $\lambda > 0$, (25) with $t = 0$ gives $f(x) = E[\int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda s} (\lambda f(X_x(s)) - g(X_x(s))) ds]$, whence $|f(x)| \leq \int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda s} \|\lambda f - g\| ds = \lambda^{-1} \|\lambda f - g\|$ for every $x \in E$. $\square$

Remark 3.14. Only dissipative operators arise as generators of Markov processes. Indeed, if X is a Markov process with measurable transition semigroup $\{T(t)\}$ on $B(E)$ and full generator $\hat{A}$ as in Definition 2.11, then X solves the martingale problem for $\hat{A}$ ([3], Proposition 4.1.7), and $\hat{A}$ is dissipative by Fact 2.12. Proposition 3.13 is the converse direction.

Definition 3.15 ((T2b) + (E2)). Let $D \subset \mathbb{T}$ be the countable dense set of (T2b). A process X satisfies the *compact containment condition* if for all $\varepsilon > 0$ and $T \in \mathbb{T}$ there is a compact $K_{\varepsilon, T} \subset E$ with

$$P\{X(t) \in K_{\varepsilon, T} \text{ for all } t \in \mathbb{T}_{\leq T} \cap D\} > 1 - \varepsilon. \quad (28)$$

A family $\{X_n\}$ satisfies the compact containment condition if (15) holds.

4 Sample path regularity: existence of a càdlàg modification

4.1 An abstract regularization theorem

[3] state Theorem 4.5 below for the Markovian martingale problem, that is, for the family $\mathbb{X}_A(X)$ of (20). Their proof, however, never uses the operator A , nor the special filtration (4), nor the particular form $\int_0^t g(X_s) ds$ of the compensator. What it uses is only that $f(X)$ splits, for every f in a sufficiently rich class, into a martingale plus a process that is regular in time. Isolating that hypothesis gives a statement in the abstract setting of Definition 3.2, from which [3], Theorem 4.3.6 follows in one line.

[2] contain no counterpart of this result, and cannot: their Setting 3.1 *presupposes* a Polish path space F and right continuous test processes, which is exactly what a regularization theorem has to produce. Theorem 4.3 is therefore the statement that carries a solution *into* the [2] setting, with $F = D_E[0, \infty)$; it is the missing first step of their programme rather than a consequence of it.

Setting 4.1 ((T2b) + (E2) + clock, $\iota = o$). As in Setting 3.1, but with no path space and no path regularity assumed. Let $\mathbb{T}$ satisfy (T2b) with countable dense $D \subset \mathbb{T}$, let $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{F}, P)$ be a filtered probability space, let E satisfy (E2), let $\mathbb{X}$ be a family of real-valued $\mathbb{F}$ -adapted processes with $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X})$, and let X be an E -valued, $\mathbb{F}$ -adapted, jointly measurable process. Neither the elements of $\mathbb{X}$ nor X are assumed to be right continuous.

Definition 4.2 ((T2b) + (E2)). A set $\Phi \subset C_b(E)$ is a *regularizing class* for $(X, \mathbb{X})$ if for every $f \in \Phi$ there exist $Y^f \in \mathbb{X}$ and an adapted real-valued process C^f such that

- (R1) $f(X(t)) = Y^f(t) + C^f(t)$ P -a.s., for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$;
- (R2) P -a.s., $t \mapsto C^f(t)$ has a limit along D from the right at every $t \in \mathbb{T}$ and from the left at every $t > 0$;
- (R3) C^f is right continuous in L^1 , i.e. $E[|C^f(s) - C^f(t)|] \rightarrow 0$ as $s \downarrow t$, for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$.

Theorem 4.3 (Abstract càdlàg modification; (T2b) + (E2)). *In Setting 4.1, let Φ be a regularizing class for $(X, \mathbb{X})$ such that*

- (a) Φ contains a countable subset separating the points of E , and
- (b) Φ is separating (Definition 2.30),

and suppose that X satisfies the compact containment condition (28). Then X has a modification with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$.

Proof. Let $\{f_i\} \subset \Phi$ be countable and separating the points of E , and write $Y^i = Y^{f_i}$, $C^i = C^{f_i}$ for the associated data of Definition 4.2.

Step 1: regularity along the rationals. Each Y^i is an $(\mathbb{F}, P)$ -martingale, so Fact 2.18, applied with the countable dense set D , provides a set of full measure on which the limits of Y^i through the rationals from above (and, for $t > 0$, from below) exist at every t , for every i . Intersecting it with the sets of full measure furnished by (R2) and (R1) yields $\Omega' \subset \Omega$ with $P(\Omega') = 1$ such that for $\omega \in \Omega'$, every i and every $t \in \mathbb{T}$ the one-sided limits of

$$f_i(X(t)) = Y^i(t) + C^i(t) \tag{29}$$

along D exist — as a sum of two summands each of which has them. This is the only place where (R2) is used, and it is weaker than continuity of C^i : the two summands are allowed to jump, as long as each does so in a càdlàg manner.

Step 2: compactness. By (28) there is $\Omega'' \subset \Omega'$ with $P(\Omega'') = 1$ such that $\{X(t, \omega) : t \in \mathbb{T}_{\leq T} \cap D\}$ has compact closure for every T in a countable cofinal subset of $\mathbb{T}$ and every $\omega \in \Omega''$. (Take the intersection over $\varepsilon = 1/m$ and over those T of the events in (28).)

Step 3: existence of one-sided limits. Fix $\omega \in \Omega''$ and $t \in \mathbb{T}$, and let $s_n \in D$ with $s_n \downarrow t$, which exist because $\mathbb{T}$ has no isolated points from the right. By Step 2 the sequence $(X(s_n, \omega))_n$ lies in a compact set, so it has convergent subsequences. If x and x' are limits along two subsequences, then by Step 1 and the continuity of f_i ,

$$f_i(x) = \lim_{s \rightarrow t+, s \in D} f_i(X(s, \omega)) = f_i(x') \quad \text{for all } i,$$

and since $\{f_i\}$ separates points, $x = x'$. Hence

$$Y(t, \omega) := \lim_{s \rightarrow t+, s \in D} X(s, \omega) \quad (30)$$

exists for all $t \in \mathbb{T}$, and similarly $Y^-(t, \omega) = \lim_{s \rightarrow t-, s \in D} X(s, \omega)$ exists for $t > 0$. By Fact 2.17, $Y(\cdot, \omega) \in D_E[0, \infty)$. Set $Y(\cdot, \omega) \equiv x_0$ for $\omega \notin \Omega''$ and some fixed $x_0 \in E$.

Step 4: Y is a modification of X . Let $f \in \Phi$ and $t \in \mathbb{T}$. For $s > t$, (R1) and the martingale property of Y^f give

$$E[f(X(s)) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] = E[Y^f(s) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] + E[C^f(s) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] = Y^f(t) + E[C^f(s) \mid \mathcal{F}_t],$$

and by (R3) and conditional Jensen, $E[C^f(s) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] \rightarrow C^f(t)$ in L^1 as $s \downarrow t$. Hence, using (R1) once more, $E[f(X(s)) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] \rightarrow Y^f(t) + C^f(t) = f(X(t))$ in L^1 . On the other hand $X(s) \rightarrow Y(t)$ a.s. along D by (30), so $f(X(s)) \rightarrow f(Y(t))$ a.s. and boundedly, whence $E[f(X(s)) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] \rightarrow E[f(Y(t)) \mid \mathcal{F}_t]$ in L^1 . Therefore

$$E[f(Y(t)) \mid \mathcal{F}_t] = f(X(t)) \quad \text{for all } f \in \Phi, t \in \mathbb{T}. \quad (31)$$

Since $X(t)$ is $\mathcal{F}_t$ -measurable and Φ is separating, Fact 2.43 yields $P\{Y(t) = X(t)\} = 1$ for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$. $\square$

Remark 4.4 (What the abstract form buys). Three hypotheses of [3], Theorem 4.3.6 disappear, and each of them is one that [2] would want gone.

- (i) *No operator.* The compensator C^f is an arbitrary adapted process subject to (R2) and (R3). In particular it may be *path dependent*: the [2] prototype $C^f(t) = \int_{(0,t]} g(s, L, X) q(ds)$, with a control variable L and a locally finite measure q , satisfies (R2) because it is of finite variation, and (R3) because $E|C^f(s) - C^f(t)| \leq \int_{(t,s]} E|g(u, L, X)| q(du) \rightarrow 0$ under the integrability condition that [2] impose anyway. A statement of this generality cannot be made in the language of an operator $A \subset C_b(E) \times B(E)$.
- (ii) *Atoms are harmless.* Nothing above requires q to be atomless. (R2) asks for one-sided limits, not for continuity; the classical statement “ $t \mapsto \int_0^t g(X_s) ds$ is Lipschitz” is the special case $q = \text{Lebesgue measure}$. In (R3) an atom at t contributes to $(0, t]$ but not to $(t, s]$, and so does not obstruct the limit — which is precisely why the half-open convention $(0, t]$ is the right one here.
- (iii) *No special filtration.* (4) plays no rôle; $\mathbb{F}$ is any filtration making X adapted and the Y^f martingales. The filtration ${}^*\mathcal{F}^X$ is needed for Proposition 3.7, not here.

What is *not* gained is a local version; see Remark 4.7, whose argument is unaffected.

4.2 The Markovian case

Theorem 4.5 ([3], Theorem 4.3.6; (T2b) + (E2) + clock, $\iota = o$). *Assume (E2). Let $A \subset C_b(E) \times B(E)$ and suppose that $\mathcal{D}(A)$ is separating and contains a countable subset that separates points. Let X be a solution of the martingale problem for A satisfying the compact containment condition (28). Then X has a modification with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$.*

Proof. Apply Theorem 4.3 with $\mathbb{X} = \mathbb{X}_A(X)$, $\mathbb{F} = (*\mathcal{F}_t^X)$ and $\Phi = \mathcal{D}(A)$: for $f \in \mathcal{D}(A)$ pick g with $(f, g) \in A$ and put $Y^f = f(X(\cdot)) - \int_{(0, \cdot]} g(X(s)) q(ds) \in \mathbb{X}_A^o(X)$ and $C^f(t) = \int_{(0, t]} g(X(s)) q(ds)$ — here, and only here, the convention must be $\iota = o$. Then (R1) holds by definition. Since g is bounded, C^f is of finite variation with $|C^f(t) - C^f(s)| \leq \|g\| q((s, t])$, so it has one-sided limits, which is (R2); and $q((t, s]) \downarrow q(\emptyset) = 0$ as $s \downarrow t$ by continuity from above, which is (R3). For $q = \text{Lebesgue measure}$ this is the familiar statement that C^f is Lipschitz, but no atomlessness is needed: an atom of q at t lies in $(0, t]$ and not in $(t, s]$, which is exactly why the convention of Remark 2.4 is the right one here. Hypotheses (a) and (b) are the assumptions on $\mathcal{D}(A)$. $\square$

Remark 4.6. The two hypotheses on $\mathcal{D}(A)$ — hypotheses (a) and (b) of Theorem 4.3 — play different rôles and should be kept apart in the formalization: “contains a countable subset separating points” is used in Step 3 of the proof of Theorem 4.3 to identify limit points, “separating” is used in Step 4 to identify $Y(t)$ with $X(t)$. They are independent: neither implies the other.

Remark 4.7. Theorem 4.5 is stated for genuine martingales and this is not an artefact of the proof. For a local martingale problem the localizing sequence consists of stopping times, whose usefulness (via optional stopping) presupposes right continuity of the filtration, and typically of the paths — which is exactly the conclusion being sought. If one *postulates* a localizing sequence of *deterministic* times, or — equivalently for the present purpose — if A is replaced by $A^K = \{(f, g) \in A : f, g \text{ bounded on } K\}$ for the compact sets K of (28), then the proof goes through verbatim. This is the honest local version of Theorem 4.5.

Remark 4.8 (Verifying compact containment). Condition (28) is the price paid for allowing non-locally-compact Polish E . If E is locally compact and separable and $\mathcal{D}(A)$ is dense in $\hat{C}(E)$ (continuous functions vanishing at infinity) in the norm topology, then (28) may be dispensed with (see also Fact 2.31): pass to the one-point compactification E^Δ , apply Theorem 4.5 there (where compact containment is trivial), and conclude that the modification has paths in $D_{E^\Delta}[0, \infty)$; see [3], Corollary 4.3.7.

5 Uniqueness, the Markov property, and the strong Markov property

The theorem of this section is the workhorse of the whole theory: it reduces uniqueness for a martingale problem, which is a statement about all finite-dimensional distributions, to a statement about *one-dimensional* distributions only, and it produces the Markov property for free. No semigroup is assumed to exist, and $\mathcal{D}(A)$ is not assumed to be separating.

As with Theorem 4.5, the operator plays no rôle in the proof. Section 5.1 extracts what does, which turns out to be a single lemma applied four times; Section 5.4 then recovers [3], Theorem 4.4.2. [2] have no counterpart of this result either — they prove no uniqueness theorem at all — but, unlike the situation in Section 4, the obstruction is not structural: the statement fits their setting once one adds the one ingredient a uniqueness theory needs and a convergence theory does not, namely a way of *restarting* the martingale problem.

5.1 The abstract uniqueness and Markov theorem

Throughout this subsection we work on the path space, as in Setting 3.1; $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T0) and E satisfies (E0) unless stated otherwise. Let $F \subset E^{\mathbb{T}}$ be a path space with σ -field $\mathcal{S} = \sigma(\pi_t : t \in \mathbb{T})$, coordinate process $\pi = (\pi_t)_{t \in \mathbb{T}}$ and canonical filtration $\mathcal{F}_t^\circ = \sigma(\pi_u : u \leq t)$, and let $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ be a family of $(\mathcal{F}_t^\circ)$ -adapted real-valued functionals on F . Write

$$\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ) = \{P \in \mathcal{P}(F) : \text{every } Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ \text{ is a } (\mathcal{F}_t^\circ, P)\text{-martingale}\},$$

and $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \mu) = \{P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ) : P\pi_0^{-1} = \mu\}$.

Remark 5.1. Nothing is lost by using the canonical filtration. If X is a process with paths in F solving the martingale problem with respect to *some* filtration $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ to which it is adapted — for instance (4) — then, since each $Y_t^\circ(X)$ is $\sigma(X_u : u \leq t)$ -measurable and $\sigma(X_u : u \leq t) \subset \mathcal{G}_t$, the tower property makes $Y^\circ(X)$ a martingale for the smaller filtration as well. Hence $PX^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$, and $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ is the set of laws of all solutions, for all filtrations at once.

The martingale property is an identity that is *linear* in the measure. This trivial observation is what carries the mixing steps of the classical proof, and it deserves to be recorded once.

Lemma 5.2 (Mixture stability; (T0) + (E0)). *Let $(\Theta, \mathcal{A}, \nu)$ be a probability space and $\vartheta \mapsto P_\vartheta \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ a measurable family, and put $P = \int P_\vartheta \nu(d\vartheta)$. If $\int E^{P_\vartheta} |Y_t^\circ| \nu(d\vartheta) < \infty$ for every $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and $t \in \mathbb{T}$, then $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$. In particular $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ is convex.*

Proof. For $G \in \mathcal{F}_s^\circ$ the identity $E^{P_\vartheta} [Y_t^\circ \mathbf{1}_G] = E^{P_\vartheta} [Y_s^\circ \mathbf{1}_G]$ holds for every ϑ ; integrate it $\nu(d\vartheta)$ and use Fubini, which is licensed by the integrability hypothesis. $\square$

Its converse holds as well, and is what actually extends well-posedness from degenerate to general initial distributions. It is worth separating from Theorem 5.9, because — unlike the argument used in Corollary 6.14 — it does not go through the Markov property.

Lemma 5.3 (Disintegration; (T0) + (E1)). *Suppose $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ admits a determining set $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ and that membership in $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ can be tested along countably many data, i.e. there are a countable $\mathbb{X}_0^\circ \subset \mathbb{X}^\circ$, a countable $D \subset \mathbb{T}$ and countable sets $\mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$ such that $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ if and only if*

$$E^P [(Y_t^\circ - Y_s^\circ) Z_s^\circ] = 0 \quad \text{for all } Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_0^\circ, s \leq t \text{ in } D, Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ. \quad (32)$$

Let $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ with $P\pi_0^{-1} = \mu$. Then $P(\cdot \mid \pi_0 = x) \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \delta_x)$ for μ -a.e. x . In particular, if $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \delta_x) = \{P_x\}$ for μ -a.e. x , then $P = \int P_x \mu(dx)$, and $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \mu)$ is a singleton.

Proof. Fix $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_0^\circ$, $s \leq t$ in D and $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$. For bounded measurable $h : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ the variable $Z_s^\circ h(\pi_0)$ is bounded and $\mathcal{F}_s^\circ$ -measurable, so the martingale property of Y° under P gives $E^P [(Y_t^\circ - Y_s^\circ) Z_s^\circ h(\pi_0)] = 0$. As h is arbitrary, $E^P [(Y_t^\circ - Y_s^\circ) Z_s^\circ \mid \pi_0] = 0$ P -a.s. The data being countable, one null set serves all of them at once; off it, $P(\cdot \mid \pi_0 = x)$ satisfies (32) and has initial law δ_x . $\square$

Remark 5.4. Lemma 5.3 together with Lemma 5.2 is [5], Theorem 32.10, in abstract form; [5] attributes it to Stroock and Varadhan and uses it exactly this way, to pass from P_x to $P_\mu = \int P_x \mu(dx)$ for the local martingale problem of a diffusion. The countability hypothesis is his too: he replaces $\hat{C}^\infty$ by a countable class of truncated coordinate functions and their products. Note that Corollary 6.14 currently justifies the same passage via Theorem 5.9(a); Lemma 5.3 is the better route, since it needs no Markov property.

The second ingredient is the one that a convergence theory does not need and a uniqueness theory cannot do without.

Definition 5.5 (Shift system; (T4) + (E0)). A family of measurable maps $\theta_r : F \rightarrow F$, $r \in \mathbb{T}$, is a *shift* on F if $\pi_t \circ \theta_r = \pi_{r+t}$ for all $r, t \in \mathbb{T}$.

A *shift system* for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ is a family $(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)_{r \in \mathbb{T}}$ of families of $(\mathcal{F}_t^\circ)$ -adapted real-valued processes on F , with $\mathbb{X}_0^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$, such that for every $r \in \mathbb{T}$ and every $\hat{Y}^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ there are $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and an $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable κ with

$$\hat{Y}_t^\circ \circ \theta_r = Y_{r+t}^\circ - Y_r^\circ + \kappa, \quad t \in \mathbb{T}. \quad (33)$$

We call $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ the *problem shifted to r* , and say that $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ is *shift stable* in the narrow sense if $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ for every r is a shift system.

The system is *measurable* if there is a set I and, for each $i \in I$ and $r \in \mathbb{T}$, an element $\hat{Y}^{\circ, r, i} \in \mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ exhausting $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$, such that $(\omega, r) \mapsto \hat{Y}_t^{\circ, r, i}(\omega)$ is $\mathcal{B}(F) \otimes \mathcal{T}$ -measurable for every i and t . For an a.s. finite stopping time τ one then writes $\mathbb{X}_\tau^\circ = \{\hat{Y}^{\circ, \tau(\cdot), i} : i \in I\}$.

Remark 5.6. Requiring $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ — which is what the first version of this manuscript did — is a real restriction and not a normalization: it forces the martingale problem to look the same from every instant, hence forces the clock to be shift invariant and the resulting Markov process to be *homogeneous*. Definition 5.5 follows [4], III.2.39 instead, where a whole family of shifted triplets $(\rho_r B, \rho_r C, \rho_r \nu)$ is carried along and $(\rho_r B)_t(\theta_r \omega) = B_{r+t}(\omega) - B_r(\omega)$; the measurability clause is their III.2.39(i). The cost is nil: the proofs below use only that the *shifted* process is a P -martingale, never that it belongs to the original family. The gain is the time-inhomogeneous case, and with it the removal of shift invariance of the clock from the hypotheses; see Remark 5.12(ii) and Example 5.7.

Example 5.7 (The shifted problem for $\mathbb{X}_A$; (T0) + (T4)). Let q be a clock on $\mathbb{T}$, let $A \subset M(\mathbb{T} \times E) \times M(E)$ allow a time-dependent coefficient, and put

$$\mathbb{X}^\circ = \left\{ \left(f(\pi_t) - \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_\iota} g(s, \pi_s) q(ds) \right)_{t \in \mathbb{T}} : (f, g) \in A \right\}.$$

Define the *pulled-back clock* q_r by $q_r(A) = q(r + A)$, i.e. the image of q restricted to $\{v : v \geq r\}$ under $v \mapsto v - r$, and set

$$\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \left\{ \left(f(\pi_t) - \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_\iota} g(r + u, \pi_u) q_r(du) \right)_{t \in \mathbb{T}} : (f, g) \in A \right\}.$$

Then $(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)$ is a shift system, with $\kappa = f(\pi_r)$: substituting $v = r + u$,

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{Y}_t^\circ(\theta_r \omega) &= f(\omega(r + t)) - \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_\iota} g(r + u, \omega(r + u)) q_r(du) \\ &= f(\omega(r + t)) - \int_{\langle r, r+t \rangle_\iota} g(v, \omega(v)) q(dv), \end{aligned}$$

which is $Y_{r+t}^\circ(\omega) - Y_r^\circ(\omega) + f(\omega(r))$. Note $q_0 = q$ and $\mathbb{X}_0^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$.

The shifted problem always exists. It coincides with the original one, i.e. $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ for all r , precisely when $q_r = q$ and g does not depend on time — that is, when the clock is shift invariant in the sense of Definition 2.2. The system is measurable as soon as $(r, u, x) \mapsto g(r + u, x)$ is, which for $q =$ Lebesgue measure and measurable g is automatic.

Lemma 5.8 (Restart; (T0) + (T4) + (E0)). *Let $(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)$ be a shift system for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ and let $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ be a determining set for every $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ (Definition 3.3). Let $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$, let $r \in \mathbb{T}$ and let $Z \geq 0$ be $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable with $E^P[Z] = 1$. Then, provided all the integrals below exist,*

$$R := (Z \cdot P) \circ \theta_r^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ). \quad (34)$$

Proof. Let $\hat{Y}^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_r^\circ$, let $s < t$ and let $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$. Choose $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and κ as in (33). Since Z_s° is $\mathcal{F}_s^\circ$ -measurable and $\pi_u \circ \theta_r = \pi_{r+u}$, the random variable $Z_s^\circ \circ \theta_r$ is $\mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$ -measurable; so is Z , because $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ \subset \mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$, and so is κ . Hence $W := Z \cdot (Z_s^\circ \circ \theta_r)$ is bounded and $\mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$ -measurable, and the martingale property of Y° under P gives $E^P[(Y_{r+t}^\circ - Y_{r+s}^\circ)W] = 0$. Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} E^R[\hat{Y}_t^\circ Z_s^\circ] &= E^P[Z(\hat{Y}_t^\circ \circ \theta_r)(Z_s^\circ \circ \theta_r)] = E^P[(Y_{r+t}^\circ - Y_r^\circ + \kappa)W] \\ &= E^P[(Y_{r+s}^\circ - Y_r^\circ + \kappa)W] = E^R[\hat{Y}_s^\circ Z_s^\circ]. \end{aligned}$$

As $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$ was arbitrary, part (ii) of Definition 3.3 yields $E^R[\hat{Y}_t^\circ \mid \mathcal{F}_s^\circ] = \hat{Y}_s^\circ$. $\square$

Note where the two hypotheses act. Shift stability is used only to rewrite $\hat{Y}_t^\circ \circ \theta_r$; the determining set is used only in the last step, and it is exactly the rôle that Proposition 3.7 plays in [3]. Everything else is the tower property.

Theorem 5.9 (Abstract uniqueness and Markov property; (T0) + (T4), and (T2a) for (b)). *Let $(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)$ be a shift system for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$, let $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ be determining for every $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$, and suppose that for every $r \in \mathbb{T}$*

$$P, Q \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ), \quad P\pi_0^{-1} = Q\pi_0^{-1} \implies P\pi_t^{-1} = Q\pi_t^{-1} \quad \text{for all } t \in \mathbb{T}. \quad (35)$$

Then, subject to the integrability provisos of Lemmas 5.2 and 5.8:

- (a) *every solution is Markov — in general time inhomogeneously so: if X has paths in F and solves the martingale problem with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$, then for $f \in B(E)$, $r, t \in \mathbb{T}$,*

$$E[f(X(r+t)) \mid \mathcal{G}_r] = E[f(X(r+t)) \mid X(r)];$$

- (b) *if $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T2a), then $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \mu)$ contains at most one element, for every $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$.*

Proof. (a). Fix $r \in \mathbb{T}$ and $F_0 \in \mathcal{G}_r$ with $P(F_0) > 0$, and put

$$Z_1 = \frac{\mathbf{1}_{F_0}}{P(F_0)}, \quad Z_2 = \frac{E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0} \mid X(r)]}{P(F_0)}.$$

Both are nonnegative with mean 1, and both are measurable with respect to $\sigma(X(u) : u \leq r) \subset \mathcal{G}_r$ — for Z_2 because it is even $\sigma(X(r))$ -measurable. Transporting to F by X and applying Lemma 5.8 at r , the two laws $R_i = (Z_i \cdot P) \circ (X(r + \cdot))^{-1}$ lie in $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)$ — the same shifted problem for $i = 1$ and $i = 2$, which is all that (35) needs. A direct computation gives, for $B \in \mathcal{B}(E)$,

$$R_1\pi_0^{-1}(B) = \frac{E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0}\mathbf{1}_B(X(r))]}{P(F_0)} = R_2\pi_0^{-1}(B),$$

the middle expression for $i = 2$ because $E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0}\mathbf{1}_B(X(r))] = E[E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0} \mid X(r)]\mathbf{1}_B(X(r))]$. So (35) applies and yields $E^{R_1}[f(\pi_t)] = E^{R_2}[f(\pi_t)]$, i.e.

$$E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0} E[f(X(r+t)) \mid \mathcal{G}_r]] = E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0} E[f(X(r+t)) \mid X(r)]],$$

where on the right we used the $\sigma(X(r))$ -measurability of Z_2 once more. Since $F_0 \in \mathcal{G}_r$ was arbitrary, the Markov property follows.

(b). Let $P, Q \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \mu)$. We show by induction on m that $E^P[\prod_{k \leq m} f_k(\pi_{t_k})] = E^Q[\prod_{k \leq m} f_k(\pi_{t_k})]$ for $t_1 \leq \dots \leq t_m$ in $\mathbb{T}$ and $f_k \in B(E)$, $f_k > 0$; by (19) this identifies P and Q — no topology and no regularity are involved, only that the coordinates generate $\mathcal{S}$. For $m = 1$ this is (35). Assume it for $m = n$ and put

$$Z = \frac{\prod_{k=1}^n f_k(\pi_{t_k})}{E^P[\prod_{k=1}^n f_k(\pi_{t_k})]},$$

which is nonnegative, $\mathcal{F}_{t_n}^\circ$ -measurable and of P -mean 1; let Z' be its analogue under Q . By Lemma 5.8 at $r = t_n$, $R = (Z \cdot P) \circ \theta_{t_n}^{-1}$ and $R' = (Z' \cdot Q) \circ \theta_{t_n}^{-1}$ lie in $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_{t_n}^\circ)$ — again the same shifted problem for both — and the induction hypothesis applied to the n functions $f_1, \dots, f_{n-1}, f_n f$ gives $R\pi_0^{-1} = R'\pi_0^{-1}$. Hence (35) yields $E^R[f(\pi_t)] = E^{R'}[f(\pi_t)]$ for all t , which after clearing denominators is the assertion for $m = n + 1$ with $t_{n+1} = t_n + t$. $\square$

Remark 5.10 (Why (b) needs a linear order). Part (a) uses nothing about $\mathbb{T}$ beyond (T0) and (T4): the proof needs θ_r , the inclusion $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ \subset \mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$ and the martingale property at $r + s \leq r + t$, all of which hold in a preordered monoid. There is no topology and no linear order in it.

Part (b) is different. The induction restarts at t_n , and for that $\prod_{k \leq n} f_k(\pi_{t_k})$ must be $\mathcal{F}_{t_n}^\circ$ -measurable, i.e. $t_k \leq t_n$ for every $k \leq n$: the times must form a *chain*. On a linearly ordered $\mathbb{T}$ every finite set of times is a chain and nothing is lost. On a merely partially ordered $\mathbb{T}$ the induction proves equality of the finite-dimensional distributions along chains only, and these do not determine the law: on $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+^2$ the times $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$ are incomparable, and no chain sees their joint distribution. Replacing t_n by $t_1 \vee \dots \vee t_n$, which (T1) would allow, does not repair this, since the next time t_{n+1} need not dominate that join.

So the slogan “uniqueness of the one-dimensional distributions implies uniqueness” is *false* for a multiparameter index, and the obstruction is the induction, not the martingale problem. This is the sharpest instance of the general pattern of Section 2.2: the Markov property is algebraic and survives on a poset, uniqueness is order-theoretic and does not.

For the strong Markov property one restarts at a stopping time. The only extra input is optional sampling, which is where path regularity finally enters.

Theorem 5.11 (Abstract strong Markov property; (T2b) + (T4)). *In the situation of Theorem 5.9, assume in addition that $F \subset D_E[0, \infty)$, that (θ_r) extends to a measurable map $(\omega, r) \mapsto \theta_r \omega$, that the shift system is measurable in the sense of Definition 5.5, and that every $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ has right continuous paths and uniformly integrable increments on bounded intervals. Let X have paths in F , solve the martingale problem with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$, and let τ be an a.s. finite $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -stopping time. Then*

$$E[f(X(\tau + t)) \mid \mathcal{G}_\tau] = E[f(X(\tau + t)) \mid X(\tau)], \quad f \in B(E), \quad t \in \mathbb{T}.$$

If moreover there is a measurable family $(P_{x,r})_{x \in E, r \in \mathbb{T}}$ with $P_{x,r} \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ, \delta_x)$, then

$$E[f(X(\tau + t)) \mid \mathcal{G}_\tau] = (T_{\tau, \tau+t} f)(X(\tau)), \quad (T_{r, r+t} f)(x) = \int f(\pi_t) dP_{x,r},$$

a two-parameter family of kernels satisfying the Chapman–Kolmogorov relation $T_{r,s} T_{s,t} = T_{r,t}$ for $r \leq s \leq t$.

Proof. The proof of Lemma 5.8 rests on the single identity $E^P[(Y_{r+t}^\circ - Y_{r+s}^\circ)W] = 0$ for bounded $\mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$ -measurable W . Optional sampling (Fact 2.19) upgrades it to its version at $r = \tau$, with W bounded and $\mathcal{G}_{\tau+s}$ -measurable, and with $\mathbb{X}_\tau^\circ$ in place of $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ — which is meaningful because the shift system is measurable. The remainder of that proof, and the proof of Theorem 5.9(a), is unchanged. For the second assertion write $\mu_{F_0} = P\{X(\tau) \in \cdot \mid F_0\}$ and put

$$R_1 = (Z_1 \cdot P) \circ (X(\tau + \cdot))^{-1} \quad \text{with } Z_1 = \mathbf{1}_{F_0}/P(F_0), \quad R_2 = \int P_{x,\tau} \mu_{F_0}(\mathrm{d}x).$$

Then $R_2 \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_\tau^\circ)$ by Lemma 5.2, and $R_1\pi_0^{-1} = \mu_{F_0} = R_2\pi_0^{-1}$, so (35) applies. The Chapman–Kolmogorov relation follows by applying the first assertion twice. $\square$

Remark 5.12 (What the abstract form buys). (i) *One lemma, four applications.* In [3] the conditioning construction in the proof of the Markov property, its variant in the induction step of the uniqueness proof, and the two constructions in parts (b) and (c) look like four separate arguments. They are one: Lemma 5.8 with, in turn,

$$\begin{aligned} Z &= \mathbf{1}_{F_0}, & Z &= E[\mathbf{1}_{F_0} \mid X(r)], \\ Z &= \prod_k f_k(\pi_{t_k}), & Z &= \mathbf{1}_{F_0} \text{ at a stopping time,} \end{aligned}$$

all normalized to mean 1. The only property of Z that is ever used is that it is nonnegative and $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable.

- (ii) *The shift system is the real hypothesis, and it costs nothing.* Definition 5.5 is where the Markov property comes from, and it is checkable. For $\mathbb{X}_A$ it never fails: whatever the clock q and however g depends on time, the shifted problem exists and is given explicitly by Example 5.7, with the pulled-back clock $q_r = q(r + \cdot)$ and the shifted coefficient $g(r + \cdot, \cdot)$. What *does* depend on q and g is whether the shifted problem is the *same* problem: $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ holds if and only if q is shift invariant and g is time independent, and only then is the Markov process homogeneous. The first version of this manuscript required $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and therefore had to assume shift invariance of the clock; carrying the shifted family instead — as [4], III.2.39 do — removes that hypothesis and yields the inhomogeneous case for free. [3] never have to say any of this because their clock is Lebesgue measure and their A does not depend on time.
- (iii) *No operator, no boundedness, no path regularity.* Parts (a) and (b) use neither $C_b(E)$ nor $D_E[0, \infty)$; F may be any Polish path space, for instance L_{loc}^p . Path regularity enters only in Theorem 5.11, and there only through optional sampling.
- (iv) *Mixtures.* Lemma 5.2 says $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ is convex and stable under measurable mixtures. This is what makes the passage from δ_x to a general μ legitimate — in [3] it is invoked silently in part (c) and in Corollary 6.14.

5.2 The local martingale problem

Everything in Section 5.1 is stated for $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$. The local analogue is not a corollary, and the reason is worth stating plainly: “ Y is a local martingale” is not a condition linear in P , because the localizing sequence may depend on P . Lemma 5.2 and Lemma 5.3 rest on that linearity, and Lemma 5.8 rests on a martingale identity that a local martingale does not supply. All three therefore fail for $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ without a further hypothesis.

The hypothesis that repairs them is due to Stroock and Varadhan and is used in this form by [5], Theorems 32.10 and 32.11: insist that the localization be performed by

stopping times that are *functionals of the path*, hence the same for every P , and that the family of such times be stable under the shift.

Definition 5.13 (Localizing system; (T2b) + (T4)). A *localizing system* for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ is a family Σ of $(\mathcal{F}_t^\circ)$ -stopping times on F — functionals of the path, not of any measure — such that the following hold.

(L1) *Uniform localization.* Σ contains a sequence $\tau_1 \leq \tau_2 \leq \dots$ with $\tau_n \uparrow \infty$ pointwise, and

$$P \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ) \iff Y^{\circ, \tau_n} := Y_{\cdot \wedge \tau_n}^\circ \text{ is a } P\text{-martingale for all } Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ, n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

(L2) *Shift covariance.* $\sigma \in \Sigma$ and $r \in \mathbb{T}$ imply $r + \sigma \circ \theta_r \in \Sigma$.

(L3) *Integrable increments after a restart.* For every $P \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$, $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$, $r \in \mathbb{T}$ and $\sigma \in \Sigma$ with $\sigma \geq r$, the process $t \mapsto Y_{(r+t) \wedge \sigma}^\circ - Y_r^\circ$ is a martingale for the filtration $(\mathcal{F}_{r+t}^\circ)_{t \in \mathbb{T}}$ under P .

Σ is *strongly* shift covariant if (L2) and (L3) hold with r replaced by any a.s. finite $(\mathcal{F}_t^\circ)$ -stopping time τ , the time $\tau + \sigma \circ \theta_\tau$ being required to be a stopping time.

Remark 5.14. Three comments on Definition 5.13.

(L1) *is the whole point.* It turns membership in $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ into a family of identities $E^P[(Y_t^{\circ, \tau_n} - Y_s^{\circ, \tau_n})\mathbf{1}_G] = 0$, each of which is linear in P . The implication “ $\Leftarrow$ ” is automatic because $\tau_n \uparrow \infty$; “ $\Rightarrow$ ” is the assumption, and it says that *one* sequence localizes every test process under every solution.

(L3) *is not implied by (L1).* Stopping a P -local martingale at $\sigma \in \Sigma$ leaves a local martingale, not a martingale: $Y^{\circ, \sigma}$ is unstopped before r , where nothing controls it. What (L3) asks is only that the *increments after r* be integrable, which is the same kind of hypothesis as in Theorem 5.11 and is usually visible at once.

The diffusion case. For $\mathbb{X}^\circ = \{f(\pi) - f(\pi_0) - \int Af(\pi)\}$ on $F = C_{\mathbb{R}_+, \mathbb{R}^d}$ take Σ generated by the exit times $\tau_n = \inf\{t : |\pi_t| \geq n\}$ and their shifts. Then (L1) is [5], Theorem 32.10, (L2) holds because $r + \tau_n \circ \theta_r = \inf\{u \geq r : |\pi_u| \geq n\}$ is again an exit time, and (L3) holds because between r and σ the path stays in $\overline{B}_n$, so that the increments are bounded by $2\|f\|_{\overline{B}_n} + q(\mathbb{T}_{\leq T})\|Af\|_{\overline{B}_n}$. [5] uses $\tau_n^f = \inf\{t : |M_t^f| \geq n\}$ instead, which serves equally well and has the advantage of not referring to the state space.

With Definition 5.13 in hand the three lemmas of Section 5.1 all go through, and their proofs are the earlier ones with Y° replaced by Y°, τ_n} . We give them in full, since the point of the exercise is that nothing is being waved through.

Lemma 5.15 (Local mixtures and disintegration; (T0) + (E1)). *Parts (a) and (b) need only (E0); (E1) is used in (c).*

(a) $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ is *convex*. No hypothesis is needed for this.

(b) If Σ satisfies (L1), then $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ is *stable under measurable mixtures* $P = \int P_\vartheta \nu(d\vartheta)$ subject to $\int E^{P_\vartheta} |Y_t^{\circ, \tau_n}| \nu(d\vartheta) < \infty$.

(c) If in addition membership can be tested along countably many data as in (32), then for $P \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ one has $P(\cdot \mid \pi_0 = x) \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \delta_x)$ for $P\pi_0^{-1}$ -a.e. x .

Proof. (a) Let $P, P' \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$, $Q = \alpha P + (1 - \alpha)P'$, and let $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ be localized by (τ_n) under P and by (τ'_n) under P' . Put $\sigma_n = \tau_n \wedge \tau'_n$. Then Y°, σ_n} is a martingale under P and under P' — stopping a martingale at a further stopping time leaves a martingale — hence under Q , and $\sigma_n \rightarrow \infty$ Q -a.s. because $\tau_n \rightarrow \infty$ P -a.s. and $\tau'_n \rightarrow \infty$ P' -a.s. Here the two localizing sequences are allowed to differ; it is only for (b) that this ceases to be possible.

(b), (c) By (L1), $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ) = \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_\bullet^\circ)$ with $\mathbb{X}_\bullet^\circ = \{Y^{\circ, \tau_n} : Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ, n \in \mathbb{N}\}$, a family of $(\mathcal{F}_t^\circ)$ -adapted processes. Now apply Lemma 5.2 respectively Lemma 5.3 to $\mathbb{X}_\bullet^\circ$; neither proof uses anything about the family beyond adaptedness, and the countability hypothesis for (c) is inherited because n ranges over $\mathbb{N}$. $\square$

Remark 5.16. The contrast between (a) and (b) is the whole point of (L1), and it is easy to get wrong. A *finite* convex combination costs nothing, because two localizing sequences can be combined by $\tau_n \wedge \tau'_n$. A mixture over a continuum cannot: one would need $\inf_\vartheta \tau_n^\vartheta$, which need not tend to infinity and need not even be measurable. That is exactly where a localizing sequence common to all P becomes indispensable, and it is why [5] states his Theorem 32.10 for a *kernel* $x \mapsto P_x$ and takes the trouble to exhibit one.

The hypothesis (L1) is less exotic than it looks: in the two places in the literature where it is used it is not assumed but *constructed*, and always by the same device — localizing along the test process itself rather than along the state space.

Lemma 5.17 (Uniform localization for bounded jumps; (T2b)). *Suppose every $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ is càdlàg with $Y_0^\circ = 0$ and has jumps bounded by a constant c_{Y° . Put*

$$\tau_n^{Y^\circ} = \inf\{t \in \mathbb{T} : |Y_t^\circ| > n\}, \quad n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Then each $\tau_n^{Y^\circ}$ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t^\circ)$ -stopping time, hence a functional of the path, and $\Sigma_0 = \{\tau_n^{Y^\circ} : Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ, n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ satisfies (L1).

Proof. $Y^{\circ, \tau_n^{Y^\circ}}$ is bounded by $n + c_{Y^\circ}$: before the time the process is at most n in absolute value, and it can overshoot only by a single jump. A bounded local martingale is a uniformly integrable martingale, so for every $P \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ the stopped process is a P -martingale. Conversely $\tau_n^{Y^\circ} \uparrow \infty$ because a càdlàg path is locally bounded. Both directions of (L1) follow. $\square$

Remark 5.18. Lemma 5.17 is the argument of [4], III.2.8, where it proves that the set of solutions of a semimartingale martingale problem is convex: they take $T_n = \inf\{t : |Y_t| > n\}$ and observe that $Y_0 = 0$ together with bounded $|\Delta Y|$ makes Y^{T_n} bounded. [5] uses the same device, $\tau_n^f = \inf\{t : |M_t^f| \geq n\}$, in his Theorem 32.10. Both localize along the *test process*, not along the state space; the exit times from balls in Remark 5.14 are the less canonical choice, since they refer to E and presuppose that f and g are bounded on compacts.

Lemma 5.19 (Local restart; (T2b) + (T4)). *Let $(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)$ be a shift system for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ with $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ determining for each $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$, and let Σ be a localizing system. Let $P \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$, let $r \in \mathbb{T}$ and let $Z \geq 0$ be $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable with $E^P[Z] = 1$. Then*

$$R := (Z \cdot P) \circ \theta_r^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ).$$

The same holds with r replaced by an a.s. finite stopping time τ and $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ by $\mathcal{F}_\tau^\circ$, provided Σ is strongly shift covariant.

Proof. By (L1) it suffices to show that $\hat{Y}^{\circ, \tau_n}$ is an R -martingale for every $\hat{Y}^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and by the determining property it suffices to show, for $s \leq t$ and $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$,

$$E^R[(\hat{Y}_t^{\circ, \tau_n} - \hat{Y}_s^{\circ, \tau_n})Z_s^\circ] = 0. \quad (36)$$

Step 1: the shifted stopped process. Let $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and the $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable κ be as in (33), and put $\sigma := r + \tau_n \circ \theta_r$, which lies in Σ by (L2) and satisfies $\sigma \geq r$. For $\omega \in F$ write $u = t \wedge \tau_n(\theta_r \omega)$. Then

$$\hat{Y}_t^{\circ, \tau_n}(\theta_r \omega) = \hat{Y}_u^\circ(\theta_r \omega) = Y_{r+u}^\circ(\omega) - Y_r^\circ(\omega) + \kappa(\omega),$$

and, $r + \cdot$ being order preserving and cancellative,

$$r + u = r + (t \wedge \tau_n(\theta_r \omega)) = (r + t) \wedge (r + \tau_n(\theta_r \omega)) = (r + t) \wedge \sigma(\omega).$$

Hence

$$\hat{Y}_t^{\circ, \tau_n} \circ \theta_r = Y_{(r+t) \wedge \sigma}^\circ - Y_r^\circ + \kappa, \quad t \in \mathbb{T}. \quad (37)$$

This is [5]'s display (17) in the proof of his Theorem 32.11, and it is the only computation in the local theory that is not already in Section 5.1.

Step 2: conclusion. Put $W := Z \cdot (Z_s^\circ \circ \theta_r)$. As in the proof of Lemma 5.8, W is bounded and $\mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$ -measurable: Z_s° is $\mathcal{F}_s^\circ$ -measurable and $\pi_u \circ \theta_r = \pi_{r+u}$, while Z is $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable and $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ \subset \mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$. Using (37) twice, the terms $-Y_r^\circ + \kappa$ cancel, and

$$E^R[(\hat{Y}_t^{\circ, \tau_n} - \hat{Y}_s^{\circ, \tau_n})Z_s^\circ] = E^P[(Y_{(r+t) \wedge \sigma}^\circ - Y_{(r+s) \wedge \sigma}^\circ)W] = 0$$

by (L3), which says exactly that $t \mapsto Y_{(r+t) \wedge \sigma}^\circ - Y_r^\circ$ is a $(\mathcal{F}_{r+t}^\circ)$ -martingale under P . This is (36).

For a stopping time τ the argument is unchanged, with $\mathcal{F}_{\tau+s}^\circ$ in place of $\mathcal{F}_{r+s}^\circ$ and with $\sigma = \tau + \tau_n \circ \theta_\tau$, a stopping time by hypothesis. $\square$

Theorem 5.20 (Local uniqueness, Markov and strong Markov property). *Let $(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ)$ be a shift system for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ with $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ determining for each $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$, let Σ be a localizing system, and suppose that for every $r \in \mathbb{T}$*

$$P, Q \in \mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ), \quad P\pi_0^{-1} = Q\pi_0^{-1} \implies P\pi_t^{-1} = Q\pi_t^{-1} \text{ for all } t \in \mathbb{T}. \quad (38)$$

Then Theorem 5.9 holds verbatim with $\mathcal{M}$ replaced by $\mathcal{M}_{\text{loc}}$ throughout; and if Σ is strongly shift covariant and the Y°, τ_n} are right continuous with uniformly integrable increments on bounded intervals, so does Theorem 5.11.

Proof. The proof of Theorem 5.9 uses exactly three things: Lemma 5.8, applied with the four densities of Remark 5.12(i); the hypothesis (35); and (19). Replace the first by Lemma 5.19 and the second by (38); the third is a statement about F and is untouched. Every density used is nonnegative and $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable — for the induction step, $Z = \prod_{k \leq n} f_k(\pi_{t_k})$ with $t_k \leq t_n$ — so Lemma 5.19 applies to each.

For the strong Markov property, the proof of Theorem 5.11 consists of the stopping time version of Lemma 5.8, which is the second assertion of Lemma 5.19, together with Lemma 5.2 for the mixture $\int P_x \mu_{F_0}(dx)$; the latter is Lemma 5.15(b). Optional sampling (Fact 2.19) is applied to the Y°, τ_n} , which are genuine martingales by (L1). $\square$

Remark 5.21 (What [4] do differently). Three points where [4], Chapter III go beyond the account above.

(i) *The shifted problem — adopted.* [4], III.2.39 carry a whole family of shifted triplets $(\rho_t B, \rho_t C, \rho_t \nu)$ with $(\rho_t B)_s(\theta_t \omega) = B_{t+s}(\omega) - B_t(\omega)$ and likewise for C and ν , rather than demanding that the shifted problem be the original one. Definition 5.5 is that idea in the present notation, and Example 5.7 is the corresponding computation for $\mathbb{X}_A$. The earlier version of this manuscript required $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and consequently had to assume that the clock be shift invariant and g time independent; both hypotheses are now gone, and the conclusion is the Markov property in its time-inhomogeneous form. The change costs nothing, because Lemmas 5.8 and 5.19 use only that the *shifted* process is a P -martingale.

(ii) *Local uniqueness.* [4], Definition III.2.37 isolate a notion strictly stronger than the uniqueness of (38): *local uniqueness* holds if for every strict stopping time T any two solutions of the *stopped* martingale problem agree on $\mathcal{F}_T$. It implies uniqueness ($T \equiv \infty$) and is what absolute-continuity and limit-theorem arguments actually require. Their Theorem III.2.40 shows that uniqueness *does* imply local uniqueness once the problem is of Markovian type in the sense of (i) — precisely, once there is a kernel $P_{x,t}$ solving the shifted problem. This is carried out in Section 5.3; it became available only after (i), which is why it is stated there and not here.

(iii) *Strict stopping times.* The canonical filtration $\mathcal{F}_t^\circ = \sigma(\pi_u : u \leq t)$ is not right continuous, and [4], III.2.35 therefore distinguish *strict* stopping times — those with $\{T \leq t\} \in \mathcal{F}_t^\circ$ for the raw filtration — from stopping times for the completed right continuous filtration, with $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ \subset \mathcal{F}_T$ and $\mathcal{F}_{T-}^\circ \subset \mathcal{F}_T^\circ$ on $\{T > 0\}$. The stopping times of Definition 5.13 are strict, by construction: they must be path functionals, and that is the same requirement seen from the other side. The distinction costs nothing here but should be made explicit in the formalization, where Mathlib’s `IsStoppingTime` is relative to whatever filtration it is given.

Remark 5.22. Two things are worth extracting.

First, the entire local theory rests on the single identity (37), which says that shifting a stopped test process produces a test process stopped at the *shifted* time. That is (L2), and it is the local form of shift stability. Everything else is either the global argument verbatim or the linearity that (L1) restores.

Second, this route localizes the *test processes* and leaves the operator alone. [3], Section 4.6 — and hence Remark 5.30 — instead replaces A by $A^{(m)} = \{(f\mathbf{1}_{K_m}, g\mathbf{1}_{K_m})\}$. In the abstract setting the present route is the right one, because $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ is primitive here and A is not; it is also the one that [5] takes.

What is *not* obtained is a local version of Theorem 4.3: Definition 5.13 presupposes stopping times, which presuppose the path regularity that Theorem 4.3 exists to produce. See Remark 4.7.

5.3 Local uniqueness

Theorem 5.20 concludes that two solutions with the same initial law have the same one-dimensional — hence all — distributions. [4], Definition III.2.37 isolate a strictly stronger property, and it is the one that absolute-continuity and limit arguments actually use.

Definition 5.23 (Local uniqueness; (T2b) + (T4)). Write $\mathbb{X}^{\circ,T} = \{Y^{\circ,T} : Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ\}$ for the family stopped at a stopping time T . *Local uniqueness* holds for $\mathbb{X}^\circ$ if for every strict stopping time T (Remark 5.21(iii)) and any two $P, P' \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^{\circ,T})$ with $P\pi_0^{-1} = P'\pi_0^{-1}$ one has $P = P'$ on $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$.

Taking $T \equiv \infty$ recovers uniqueness, so local uniqueness is at least as strong; [4] note that it is strictly stronger in general. What makes it accessible is that the shift systems of Section 5.1 are exactly the structure [4] presuppose in their Theorem III.2.40. Two further pieces of structure are needed, and both are properties of the path space rather than of the martingale problem.

Definition 5.24 (Stopping and concatenation on F ; (T2b) + (T4)). Let T be a stopping time on F .

- (P1) *T is strict*: F is stable under the stopping operator $a_T : F \rightarrow F$, $\pi_t \circ a_T = \pi_{t \wedge T}$, and $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ = a_T^{-1}(\mathcal{S})$. Equivalently, a set lies in $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$ exactly when membership depends on the path only through a_T . This is [4], Lemma III.2.43 for the canonical space, and it is what “strict” buys.
- (P2) *F admits concatenation at T* : there is a measurable $\gamma : \{(\alpha, \beta) \in F \times F : \beta_0 = \alpha_{T(\alpha)}\} \rightarrow F$ with

$$\gamma(\alpha, \beta)_t = \begin{cases} \alpha_t, & t < T(\alpha), \\ \beta_{t-T(\alpha)}, & t \geq T(\alpha), \end{cases} \quad T(\gamma(\alpha, \beta)) = T(\alpha), \quad \theta_T \gamma(\alpha, \beta) = \beta.$$

- (P3) *The shift system is full*: in addition to Definition 5.5, for every $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ and every r there are $\hat{Y}^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_r^\circ$ and an $\mathcal{F}_r^\circ$ -measurable κ with $\hat{Y}_u^\circ \circ \theta_r = Y_{r+u}^\circ - Y_r^\circ + \kappa$.

For $F = D_E[0, \infty)$ all three hold, with a_T the usual stopping of a path and γ the usual concatenation.

Lemma 5.25 (Pasting; (T2b) + (T4)). Assume (P1)–(P3), let $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ be determining for each $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ$, and let $(P_{x,r})$ be a measurable family with $P_{x,r} \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_r^\circ, \delta_x)$. Let T be a strict stopping time and $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^{\circ,T})$. Let Q be the law of $\gamma(\alpha, \beta)$ where $\alpha \sim P$ and, given α , $\beta \sim P_{\alpha_{T(\alpha)}, T(\alpha)}$. Then, subject to integrability,

$$Q \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ) \quad \text{and} \quad Q = P \quad \text{on } \mathcal{F}_T^\circ.$$

Proof. Agreement on $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$. Let $A \in \mathcal{F}_T^\circ$. By (P1), $\mathbf{1}_A = \mathbf{1}_A \circ a_T$, and by (P2), $a_T \gamma(\alpha, \beta) = a_T \alpha$. Hence $\mathbf{1}_A(\gamma(\alpha, \beta)) = \mathbf{1}_A(\alpha)$ and $Q(A) = P(A)$.

The martingale property. Fix $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$, $s \leq t$, and a bounded $\mathcal{F}_s^\circ$ -measurable W ; we show $E^Q[(Y_t^\circ - Y_s^\circ)W] = 0$, which by Definition 3.3 suffices. Split

$$Y_t^\circ - Y_s^\circ = \underbrace{(Y_t^{\circ,T} - Y_s^{\circ,T})}_{(I)} + \underbrace{(Y_t^\circ - Y_{t \wedge T}^\circ) - (Y_s^\circ - Y_{s \wedge T}^\circ)}_{(II)}.$$

The term (I). It vanishes on $\{T \leq s\}$, so only $\{T > s\}$ contributes. There the concatenated path agrees with α on $\mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$, so $W(\gamma(\alpha, \beta)) = W(\alpha)$, and (I) depends on the path only through a_T , hence equals its value at α . Therefore $E^Q[(I)W] = E^P[(Y_t^{\circ,T} - Y_s^{\circ,T})W] = 0$, because $Y^{\circ,T}$ is a P -martingale by hypothesis.

The term (II). By (P3) choose $\hat{Y}^\circ \in \mathbb{X}_T^\circ$ and κ with $\hat{Y}_u^\circ \circ \theta_T = Y_{T+u}^\circ - Y_T^\circ + \kappa$; taking $u = 0$ gives $\hat{Y}_0^\circ \circ \theta_T = \kappa$, so that

$$(II) = (\hat{Y}_{(t-T)^+}^\circ - \hat{Y}_{(s-T)^+}^\circ) \circ \theta_T, \quad (u - T)^+ := u - T \text{ on } \{T \leq u\}, \text{ } 0 \text{ otherwise,} \quad (39)$$

the constant κ cancelling on $\{T \leq s\}$ and against $\hat{Y}_0^\circ$ on $\{T > s\}$. Under Q , conditionally on $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$, the shifted path θ_T has law $P_{\pi_T, T} \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}_T^\circ)$, so $\hat{Y}^\circ$ is a martingale under it. Now split W :

- On $\{T > s\}$ the variable $W\mathbf{1}_{\{T > s\}}$ is $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$ -measurable, since $\{T > s\} \in \mathcal{F}_s^\circ$ and on that event the path up to s is determined by a_T . There $(s - T)^+ = 0$, and $E[\hat{Y}_{(t-T)^+}^\circ - \hat{Y}_0^\circ \mid \mathcal{F}_T^\circ] = 0$.
- On $\{T \leq s\}$ the variable $W\mathbf{1}_{\{T \leq s\}}$ is measurable with respect to $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ \vee \theta_T^{-1}(\mathcal{F}_{s-T}^\circ)$, because the path up to s is the concatenation of a_T with the shifted path run for time $s - T$. Conditionally on $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$, the martingale property of $\hat{Y}^\circ$ tested against an $\mathcal{F}_{s-T}^\circ$ -measurable variable gives $E[(\hat{Y}_{t-T}^\circ - \hat{Y}_{s-T}^\circ) W \mid \mathcal{F}_T^\circ] = 0$.

In both cases the contribution vanishes, so $E^Q[(\text{II})W] = 0$. $\square$

Theorem 5.26 (Uniqueness implies local uniqueness; [4], Theorem III.2.40). *Assume (P1)–(P3) and the hypotheses of Lemma 5.25, and suppose that $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \mu)$ contains at most one element for every $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$. Then local uniqueness holds in the sense of Definition 5.23.*

Proof. Let T be a strict stopping time and $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^{\circ, T})$ with $P\pi_0^{-1} = \mu$. Lemma 5.25 produces $Q \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ)$ with $Q = P$ on $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$; in particular $Q\pi_0^{-1} = \mu$, since π_0 is $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$ -measurable. By hypothesis Q is the unique element of $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X}^\circ, \mu)$, hence depends on μ alone. Therefore $P|_{\mathcal{F}_T^\circ} = Q|_{\mathcal{F}_T^\circ}$ depends on μ alone, and two solutions of the stopped problem with the same initial law agree on $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$. $\square$

Remark 5.27. Three comments.

Where the new structure sits. Everything before this subsection needs only the shift θ_r ; local uniqueness needs its partial inverse, namely concatenation (P2). That is a genuinely new hypothesis on F and not a consequence of anything above: θ_r forgets the past, and no amount of forgetting reconstructs a pasting operation. (P3) is the mirror image of Definition 5.5 and is free in every example.

Why strict stopping times. (P1) is used exactly once, to know that $\mathcal{F}_T^\circ$ -measurable functions see only a_T . For the raw filtration $\mathcal{F}_t^\circ = \sigma(\pi_u : u \leq t)$ this is [4], Lemma III.2.43; for a completed or right continuous filtration it is false, and the statement of local uniqueness would have to be adjusted. This is the practical reason for [4]’s insistence on the distinction.

What it is for. [4] introduce local uniqueness for questions of absolute continuity and singularity between solutions, and for limit theorems; neither is treated here. Theorem 5.26 is included because it is the natural completion of Section 5.1 and because, after Definition 5.5, it costs one lemma.

5.4 The Markovian case

Theorem 5.28 ([3], Theorem 4.4.2; (T2b) + (T4) + shift invariant clock, for homogeneity). *Assume (E2) and let $A \subset B(E) \times B(E)$. Suppose that for each $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$ any two solutions X, Y of the martingale problem for (A, μ) have the same one-dimensional distributions, that is, for each $t \in \mathbb{T}$,*

$$P\{X(t) \in \Gamma\} = P\{Y(t) \in \Gamma\}, \quad \Gamma \in \mathcal{B}(E). \quad (40)$$

Then the following hold.

- (a) *Any solution of the martingale problem for A with respect to a filtration $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ is a Markov process with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$, and any two solutions of the martingale problem for (A, μ) have the same finite-dimensional distributions. In particular, (40) implies uniqueness.*

- (b) If moreover $A \subset C_b(E) \times B(E)$, X is a solution of the martingale problem for A with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$, and X has sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$, then for every a.s. finite $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -stopping time τ ,

$$E[f(X(\tau+t)) \mid \mathcal{G}_\tau] = E[f(X(\tau+t)) \mid X(\tau)], \quad f \in B(E), t \in \mathbb{T}. \quad (41)$$

- (c) If, in addition to the conditions of (b), for each $x \in E$ there exists a solution $P_x \in \mathcal{P}(D_E[0, \infty))$ of the $D_E[0, \infty)$ martingale problem for (A, δ_x) such that $x \mapsto P_x(B)$ is Borel measurable for each $B \in \mathcal{B}(D_E[0, \infty))$, then, setting $T(t)f(x) = \int f(\omega(t))P_x(d\omega)$,

$$E[f(X(\tau+t)) \mid \mathcal{G}_\tau] = T(t)f(X(\tau)) \quad (42)$$

for all $f \in B(E)$, $t \in \mathbb{T}$ and a.s. finite $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -stopping times τ ; that is, X is strong Markov.

Proof. We check the hypotheses of Theorems 5.9 and 5.11 for $\mathbb{X}^\circ = \mathbb{X}_A$, i.e. for

$$\mathbb{X}^\circ = \left\{ \left(f(\pi_t) - \int_{\langle 0, t \rangle_t} g(\pi_s) q(ds) \right)_{t \in \mathbb{T}} : (f, g) \in A \right\}$$

on the path space $F = E^\mathbb{T}$ (respectively $F = D_E[0, \infty)$ in (b)–(c)).

Determining set. Proposition 3.7 says precisely that the products $\prod_k h_k(\pi_{t_k})$, over arbitrary finite subsets $\{t_k\} \subset \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$, form a determining set for $\mathbb{X}_A$ in the sense of Definition 3.3: (21) for all such products is equivalent to the martingale property. Note that this is stronger than what Definition 3.3 asks — it delivers the martingale property for $^*\mathcal{F}^X$, not merely for the canonical filtration.

Shift system. Example 5.7 exhibits one, with $\theta_r \omega = \omega(r + \cdot)$, the pulled-back clock q_r and $\kappa = f(\pi_r)$. Since $A \subset C_b(E) \times B(E)$ does not depend on time and q is assumed shift invariant, $q_r = q$ and $\mathbb{X}_r^\circ = \mathbb{X}^\circ$ for every r ; the shift system is the constant one, and the Markov process obtained is homogeneous. Dropping either assumption leaves Theorem 5.9 intact and yields a time-inhomogeneous Markov process instead — this is the only point at which [3], Theorem 4.4.2 is genuinely less general than Theorem 5.9.

Integrability. f and g are bounded, so every $Y^\circ \in \mathbb{X}^\circ$ satisfies $|Y_t^\circ| \leq \|f\| + \|g\| q(\mathbb{T}_{\leq t})$, which is finite by Definition 2.2; all the integrability provisos are automatic, and the increments of Y° on $\mathbb{T}_{\leq T}$ are bounded, hence uniformly integrable.

Conclusion. Hypothesis (40) is (35) by Remark 5.1, so Theorem 5.9(a) gives the Markov property and (b) the equality of the finite-dimensional distributions, which is (a). For (b) and (c), $A \subset C_b(E) \times B(E)$ and paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$ make each $Y^\circ(X)$ a right continuous martingale with bounded increments, so Theorem 5.11 applies; its second assertion is (42) with $T(t)f(x) = \int f(\omega(t))P_x(d\omega)$. $\square$

Corollary 5.29 ([3], Corollary 4.4.3; (T3)). *Assume (E3) and let $A \subset B(E) \times B(E)$. Suppose that for each $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$ any two solutions X, Y of the martingale problem for (A, μ) with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$ (respectively $C_E[0, \infty)$) satisfy (40). Then for each $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$ any two such solutions have the same distribution on $D_E[0, \infty)$ (respectively $C_E[0, \infty)$).*

Proof. The processes $\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}$ constructed in the proof of Theorem 5.28 again have sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$ (resp. $C_E[0, \infty)$) whenever X and Y do, so the induction goes through and X, Y have the same finite-dimensional distributions. By Fact 2.33 these determine the law on $D_E[0, \infty)$ (resp. $C_E[0, \infty)$). $\square$

Remark 5.30. For the *local* martingale problem, Theorem 5.28 holds in the following localized form. Suppose $A \subset M(E) \times M(E)$ and let (K_m) be an increasing sequence of compact sets with $\tau_m = \inf\{t : X(t) \notin K_m \text{ or } X(t-) \notin K_m\}$ and $\tau_m \rightarrow \infty$ a.s. for every solution X . If for each μ and each m any two solutions of the local martingale problem for (A, μ) agree in the one-dimensional distributions of the *stopped* processes $X(\cdot \wedge \tau_m)$, then the conclusions (a)–(c) hold. The proof is the above one applied to the stopped martingale problem for $A^{(m)} = \{(f\mathbf{1}_{K_m}, g\mathbf{1}_{K_m}) : (f, g) \in A\}$, followed by $m \rightarrow \infty$. This is the content of [3], Section 4.6. It is worth stating separately in the formalization, since the reduction “local $\rightsquigarrow$ global via stopping” is reused in Section 7.

This route modifies the operator. Section 5.2 gives the alternative, which leaves A alone and stops the test process instead; it is the one that fits the abstract setting, and the one [5] uses.

6 Uniqueness via duality

Duality reduces the computation of $E[f(X(t), y)]$ for a process X to the computation of $E[f(x, Y(t))]$ for a second, typically simpler, process Y . Combined with Theorem 5.28 it is one of the main practical routes to uniqueness.

Here, unlike in Sections 4 and 5, there is nothing to strip away on the probabilistic side: Theorem 6.6 below already assumes only that X and Y are *measurable* processes, uses no path regularity, no Polish structure and no boundedness, and would be stated verbatim in the [2] setting. What can be generalized is the *clock*. Section 6.1 therefore isolates the analytic core as a statement about a function of two time variables, valid for an arbitrary measure q , and reads off exactly which q make the duality relation true. The answer turns out to be sharp, and it is not the answer one gets in Sections 4 and 5.

6.1 The anti-diagonal lemma

Duality is the assertion that a certain function of two time variables is constant on anti-diagonals. The following identity is that assertion stripped of all analysis: it is an exact telescoping, with no hypothesis beyond the two increment representations, and every version of the duality lemma is obtained from it by choosing a chain.

Lemma 6.1 (Chain identity; (T0) + (T4) + (E0) + clock). *Let $(\mathbb{T}, +, \leq)$ be an ordered commutative monoid, let q be a measure on $\mathbb{T}$, and let $\Phi, \gamma_1, \gamma_2 : \mathbb{T} \times \mathbb{T} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ satisfy, for all $s \leq s'$ and $t \leq t'$,*

$$\Phi(s', t) - \Phi(s, t) = \int_{[s, s']} \gamma_1(r, t) q(dr), \quad \Phi(s, t') - \Phi(s, t) = \int_{[t, t']} \gamma_2(s, r) q(dr), \quad (43)$$

all integrals being assumed to exist. Then for every $t \in \mathbb{T}$ and every chain $0 = s_0 \leq s_1 \leq \dots \leq s_m = t$ in $\mathbb{T}$ such that $t - s_k$ is defined,

$$\Phi(t, 0) - \Phi(0, t) = \sum_{k=0}^{m-1} \left[\int_{[s_k, s_{k+1}]} \gamma_1(r, t - s_{k+1}) q(dr) - \int_{[t - s_{k+1}, t - s_k]} \gamma_2(s_k, r) q(dr) \right]. \quad (44)$$

Proof. Telescope along the anti-diagonal: $\Phi(t, 0) - \Phi(0, t) = \sum_k [\Phi(s_{k+1}, t - s_{k+1}) - \Phi(s_k, t - s_k)]$, and split each summand through the corner $(s_k, t - s_{k+1})$:

$$[\Phi(s_{k+1}, t - s_{k+1}) - \Phi(s_k, t - s_{k+1})] - [\Phi(s_k, t - s_k) - \Phi(s_k, t - s_{k+1})].$$

Now apply the first representation in (43) to the first bracket and the second to the second. $\square$

The duality relation is the case in which the two brackets in (44) cancel. Under the balance condition $\gamma_1 = \gamma_2 = \gamma$ the k -th summand is

$$\int_{[s_k, s_{k+1})} \gamma(r, t - s_{k+1}) q(dr) - \int_{[t - s_{k+1}, t - s_k)} \gamma(s_k, r) q(dr), \quad (45)$$

in which the two integrals run over the block $[s_k, s_{k+1})$ and over its reflection $[t - s_{k+1}, t - s_k)$. So the duality relation holds as soon as q gives a block and its reflection the same mass, at every scale — and that is precisely translation invariance.

Proposition 6.2 (Which clocks admit duality; (T2a) + (T4), $\iota = p$). *Assume (43) with $\gamma_1 = \gamma_2 = \gamma$.*

- (a) *If $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$ and q is counting measure, then $\Phi(t, 0) = \Phi(0, t)$ for every t , for every γ whatsoever.*
- (b) *If $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ and q is Lebesgue measure, then $\Phi(t, 0) = \Phi(0, t)$ for almost every t , under the integrability hypothesis (46); this is Lemma 6.5 below.*
- (c) *For a general q the conclusion is false.*

Proof. (a) Take the chain $s_k = k$. Then $[s_k, s_{k+1}) = \{k\}$ and $[t - s_{k+1}, t - s_k) = \{t - k - 1\}$, so (45) reads $\gamma(k, t - k - 1) - \gamma(k, t - k - 1) = 0$. Every summand vanishes identically; no regularity of γ is used.

(b) Refine the chain; see Lemma 6.5.

(c) Let $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ and $q = \delta_a$ for some $a > 0$. Then (43) gives, for $s, t > a$, $\Phi(s, t) = \Phi(0, t) + \gamma(a, t) = \Phi(s, 0) + \gamma(s, a)$, and hence

$$\Phi(t, 0) - \Phi(0, t) = \gamma(a, 0) - \gamma(0, a), \quad t > a,$$

which does not vanish for a general γ . In (45) the first integral is carried by the block containing a in its *first* coordinate and the second by the block containing a in its *second* coordinate; these are different points of the anti-diagonal, and no chain brings them together. $\square$

Remark 6.3 (Two conventions, and they disagree). Proposition 6.2(a) uses the half-open convention $[s, s')$ of (43), i.e. a compensator $C_t = \int_{[0, t)} g dq$, which is the *predictable* one. With $C_t = \int_{(0, t]} g dq$ instead, the k -th summand of (45) becomes $\gamma(k + 1, t - k - 1) - \gamma(k, t - k)$, and the sum telescopes to $\gamma(t, 0) - \gamma(0, t) \neq 0$: *discrete-time duality fails*.

This is the opposite of what Section 4 wants. There the half-open convention must be $(0, t]$, since an atom of q at t must lie *inside* the compensator up to t for $E[C_s - C_t \mid \mathcal{F}_t] \rightarrow 0$ to hold as $s \downarrow t$, and it is that limit which makes the càdlàg process a *modification* rather than merely a regularization (Remark 4.4(ii)).

So Theorem 4.3 wants $\iota = o$ and Proposition 6.2 wants $\iota = p$, and no single convention serves both. The conflict is invisible whenever the clock is atomless — in particular for $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ with q Lebesgue, the only case treated in [3] and [2] — which is why neither source has to choose. A treatment that admits atoms does have to, and this manuscript resolves it by carrying both (Definition 2.2 and Remark 2.4) rather than by choosing.

That this costs almost nothing is itself worth recording, and it is not an accident. Sections 3 and 5 use the compensator only through the additivity (3), which both conventions satisfy; so does Lemma 6.1, which is why the analytic core of Section 6 is convention-agnostic and only its *conclusion*, Proposition 6.2, is not. The two conventions part company at exactly two theorems out of the whole manuscript, and the bundle table of Section 2.9 marks them.

Remark 6.4 (Scope of Section 6). Proposition 6.2 answers, for duality, the question that Definition 5.5 answers for the Markov property. Section 5 needs q *shift invariant*. Section 6 needs more, and it is worth being precise about how much, because translation invariance alone is *not* enough.

What (45) requires is that the reflection $u \mapsto t - u$ carry the block $[s_k, s_{k+1})$ onto the block $[t - s_{k+1}, t - s_k)$ with the same q -mass. Both blocks are differences of *down-sets*, $\mathbb{T}_{\leq s'} \setminus \mathbb{T}_{\leq s}$; but the reflection of a down-set is an *up-set*, so the reflected first block is $\{u \geq t - s_{k+1}\} \setminus \{u \geq t - s_k\}$, which coincides with the second block only when the order is *linear*. Hence Section 6 needs a linearly ordered $\mathbb{T}$ *and* a translation invariant q on it; up to normalization that leaves Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R}_+$ (or $[0, T]$) and counting measure on $h\mathbb{N}_0$, the two cases of Proposition 6.2(a)–(b).

In particular Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+^d$, $d \geq 2$, is translation invariant and yet does *not* admit duality. For $d = 2$, $t = (1, 1)$ and the chain $0 \rightarrow (1, 0) \rightarrow (1, 1)$, the first block $[0, (1, 0))$ is Lebesgue null while its partner $\mathbb{T}_{\leq (1,1)} \setminus \mathbb{T}_{\leq (0,1)}$ has mass 1, so (45) does not cancel. The duality section is thus genuinely narrower than the rest of the manuscript — narrower, in particular, than Sections 3 and 5, which survive on a partially ordered index — and (44) makes visible why.

6.2 The continuous-time theory

Lemma 6.5 ([3], Lemma 4.4.10; (T3)). *Let $f : [0, \infty) \times [0, \infty) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be absolutely continuous in s for each fixed t and absolutely continuous in t for each fixed s , and set $(f_1, f_2) = \nabla f$. Suppose that*

$$\int_0^T \int_0^T |f_i(s, t)| \, ds \, dt < \infty, \quad i = 1, 2, \quad T > 0. \quad (46)$$

Then for almost every $t \geq 0$,

$$f(t, 0) - f(0, t) = \int_0^t (f_1(s, t - s) - f_2(s, t - s)) \, ds. \quad (47)$$

Proof. By (46) and Fubini,

$$\begin{aligned} & \int_0^T \int_0^t (f_1(t - s, s) - f_2(s, t - s)) \, ds \, dt \\ &= \int_0^T \int_0^t f_1(t - s, s) \, ds \, dt - \int_0^T \int_0^t f_2(s, t - s) \, ds \, dt \\ &= \int_0^T \int_s^T f_1(t - s, s) \, dt \, ds - \int_0^T \int_s^T f_2(s, t - s) \, dt \, ds \\ &= \int_0^T (f(T - s, s) - f(0, s)) \, ds - \int_0^T (f(s, T - s) - f(s, 0)) \, ds \\ &= \int_0^T (f(s, 0) - f(0, s)) \, ds, \end{aligned}$$

where the third equality uses absolute continuity in the first resp. second variable, and the fourth is the substitution $s \mapsto T - s$ in the first two integrals. Differentiating with respect to T gives (47) for a.e. T . $\square$

Theorem 6.6 ([3], Theorem 4.4.11; (T3)). *Let X and Y be independent measurable processes with values in E_1 and E_2 respectively. Let $f, g, h \in M(E_1 \times E_2)$, $\alpha \in M(E_1)$ and*

$\beta \in M(E_2)$. Suppose that for each $T > 0$ there exist an integrable random variable Γ_T and a constant C_T such that

$$\begin{aligned} \sup_{r,s,t \leq T} (|\alpha(X(r))| + 1) |f(X(s), Y(t))| &\leq \Gamma_T, \\ \sup_{r,s,t \leq T} (|\beta(Y(r))| + 1) |f(X(s), Y(t))| &\leq \Gamma_T, \\ \sup_{r,s,t \leq T} (|\alpha(X(r))| + 1) |g(X(s), Y(t))| &\leq \Gamma_T, \\ \sup_{r,s,t \leq T} (|\beta(Y(r))| + 1) |h(X(s), Y(t))| &\leq \Gamma_T, \end{aligned} \tag{48}$$

and

$$\int_0^T |\alpha(X(u))| du + \int_0^T |\beta(Y(u))| du \leq C_T. \tag{49}$$

Suppose that

$$f(X(t), y) - \int_0^t g(X(s), y) ds \tag{50}$$

is a $(*\mathcal{F}_t^X)$ -martingale for each $y \in E_2$, and

$$f(x, Y(t)) - \int_0^t h(x, Y(s)) ds \tag{51}$$

is a $(*\mathcal{F}_t^Y)$ -martingale for each $x \in E_1$ (the integrals in (50) and (51) being assumed to exist). Then for almost every $t \geq 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} &E \left[f(X(t), Y(0)) \exp \left\{ \int_0^t \alpha(X(u)) du \right\} \right] - E \left[f(X(0), Y(t)) \exp \left\{ \int_0^t \beta(Y(u)) du \right\} \right] \\ &= E \left[\int_0^t \{ g(X(s), Y(t-s)) - h(X(s), Y(t-s)) + (\alpha(X(s)) - \beta(Y(t-s))) f(X(s), Y(t-s)) \} \right. \\ &\quad \left. \times \exp \left\{ \int_0^s \alpha(X(u)) du + \int_0^{t-s} \beta(Y(u)) du \right\} ds \right]. \end{aligned} \tag{52}$$

Proof. Set

$$F(s, t) = E \left[f(X(s), Y(t)) \exp \left\{ \int_0^s \alpha(X(u)) du \right\} \exp \left\{ \int_0^t \beta(Y(u)) du \right\} \right]. \tag{53}$$

Step 1: freezing Y . Write $e_\alpha(s) = \exp\{\int_0^s \alpha(X(u)) du\}$ and $e_\beta(t) = \exp\{\int_0^t \beta(Y(u)) du\}$, and fix t . Both $e_\beta(t)$ and $Y(t)$ are $\sigma(Y)$ -measurable, and $\sigma(Y)$ is independent of $\sigma(X)$; so every expectation below may be computed by conditioning on $\sigma(Y)$, freezing $Y(t) = y$ and $e_\beta(t)$, and using that $M_r^y = f(X(r), y) - \int_0^r g(X(v), y) dv$ is a $(*\mathcal{F}_r^X)$ -martingale under the conditioned measure — which it is, because conditioning on an independent σ -field leaves the law of X and the filtration $*\mathcal{F}^X$ unchanged. We suppress the conditioning from the notation.

Step 2: the increment identity. For $h > 0$ split

$$\begin{aligned} &f(X(s+h), y) e_\alpha(s+h) - f(X(s), y) e_\alpha(s) \\ &= \underbrace{[f(X(s+h), y) - f(X(s), y)] e_\alpha(s)}_{(A)} + \underbrace{f(X(s+h), y) [e_\alpha(s+h) - e_\alpha(s)]}_{(B)}. \end{aligned} \tag{54}$$

For (A), write $f(X(s+h), y) - f(X(s), y) = M_{s+h}^y - M_s^y + \int_s^{s+h} g(X(v), y) dv$. Since $e_\alpha(s)$ is $^*\mathcal{F}_s^X$ -measurable and bounded by e^{C_T} , the martingale term contributes 0, so

$$\begin{aligned} E[(A)] &= \int_s^{s+h} E[g(X(r), y)e_\alpha(s)] dr \\ &= \int_s^{s+h} E[g(X(r), y)e_\alpha(r)] dr \\ &\quad + \int_s^{s+h} E[g(X(r), y)(e_\alpha(s) - e_\alpha(r))] dr. \end{aligned}$$

For (B), the chain rule gives $e_\alpha(s+h) - e_\alpha(s) = \int_s^{s+h} \alpha(X(r))e_\alpha(r) dr$. For each $r \in [s, s+h]$ write

$$f(X(s+h), y) = f(X(r), y) + (M_{s+h}^y - M_r^y) + \int_r^{s+h} g(X(v), y) dv.$$

The martingale term again contributes 0, since $\alpha(X(r))e_\alpha(r)$ is $^*\mathcal{F}_r^X$ -measurable, and one obtains

$$\begin{aligned} E[(B)] &= \int_s^{s+h} E[f(X(r), y)\alpha(X(r))e_\alpha(r)] dr \\ &\quad + \int_s^{s+h} \int_r^{s+h} E[g(X(v), y)\alpha(X(r))e_\alpha(r)] dv dr. \end{aligned}$$

Multiplying by $e_\beta(t)$, integrating over the law of Y and using Fubini — legitimate because all integrands are dominated by $\Gamma_T e^{C_T}$ by (48)–(49) — we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} F(s+h, t) - F(s, t) &= \underbrace{\int_s^{s+h} E[f\alpha(X(r), Y(t))e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t)] dr}_{T_1} \\ &\quad + \underbrace{\int_s^{s+h} \int_r^{s+h} E[g(X(v), Y(t))\alpha(X(r))e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t)] dv dr}_{T_2} \\ &\quad + \underbrace{\int_s^{s+h} E[g(X(r), Y(t))e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t)] dr}_{T_3} \\ &\quad + \underbrace{\int_s^{s+h} E[g(X(r), Y(t))(e_\alpha(s) - e_\alpha(r))e_\beta(t)] dr}_{T_4}, \quad (55) \end{aligned}$$

where $f\alpha$ abbreviates $(x, y) \mapsto f(x, y)\alpha(x)$.

Step 3: T_2 and T_4 are $O(h^2)$. Let $t, s+h \leq T$. The third line of (48) gives $|\alpha(X(r))||g(X(v), Y(t))| \leq \Gamma_T$, and (49) gives $e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t) \leq e^{C_T}$. Hence

$$|T_2| \leq e^{C_T} E[\Gamma_T] \int_s^{s+h} (s+h-r) dr = \frac{1}{2} h^2 e^{C_T} E[\Gamma_T].$$

For T_4 use $e_\alpha(s) - e_\alpha(r) = -\int_s^r \alpha(X(u))e_\alpha(u) du$ and the same two bounds:

$$|T_4| \leq \int_s^{s+h} \int_s^r E[|g(X(r), Y(t))||\alpha(X(u))|e_\alpha(u)e_\beta(t)] du dr \leq \frac{1}{2} h^2 e^{C_T} E[\Gamma_T].$$

Step 4: passing to the limit. Since $T_1 + T_3 = \int_s^{s+h} E[(f\alpha + g)(X(r), Y(t))e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t)] dr$, summing (55) over a partition $0 = s_0 < \dots < s_m = s$ gives

$$\left| F(s, t) - F(0, t) - \int_0^s E[(f\alpha + g)(X(r), Y(t))e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t)] dr \right| \leq \frac{1}{2} e^{C_T} E[\Gamma_T] \sum_{i=1}^m (s_i - s_{i-1})^2$$

— the main terms telescoping *exactly*, with no limit needed — and the right-hand side is at most $\frac{1}{2} e^{C_T} E[\Gamma_T] s \max_i (s_i - s_{i-1}) \rightarrow 0$. This is

$$F(s, t) - F(0, t) = \int_0^s E[(f(X(r), Y(t))\alpha(X(r)) + g(X(r), Y(t)))e_\alpha(r)e_\beta(t)] dr. \quad (56)$$

Symmetrically, Symmetrically,

$$F(s, t) - F(s, 0) = \int_0^t E[(f(X(s), Y(r))\beta(Y(r)) + h(X(s), Y(r)))e_\alpha(s)e_\beta(r)] dr. \quad (57)$$

Thus F satisfies the hypotheses of Lemma 6.5, with F_1 and F_2 the integrands in (56) and (57); the integrability (46) follows from (48) and (49). Now (47) is exactly (52). $\square$

Remark 6.7 ([3], Remark 4.4.12). Equation (52) can frequently be extended to more general α and β by approximating them by bounded functions.

Corollary 6.8 (Duality relation; [3], Corollary 4.4.13; (T3)). *If, in addition to the conditions of Theorem 6.6,*

$$g(x, y) + \alpha(x)f(x, y) = h(x, y) + \beta(y)f(x, y), \quad (x, y) \in E_1 \times E_2, \quad (58)$$

then for all $t \geq 0$

$$E\left[f(X(t), Y(0)) \exp\left\{\int_0^t \alpha(X(u)) du\right\}\right] = E\left[f(X(0), Y(t)) \exp\left\{\int_0^t \beta(Y(u)) du\right\}\right]. \quad (59)$$

Proof. Under (58) the right-hand side of (52) vanishes, so (59) holds for almost every t . It extends to all t because $t \mapsto F(t, 0)$ and $t \mapsto F(0, t)$ are continuous, which follows from (56) and (57). $\square$

Remark 6.9. Corollary 6.8 is Proposition 6.2(b) applied to $\Phi = F$ of (53), with γ_1 and γ_2 the integrands of (56) and (57); the balance condition (58) is exactly $\gamma_1 = \gamma_2$. The whole of Theorem 6.6 is thus Lemma 6.1 plus the computation (55) that produces the increment representations (43) from the martingale hypotheses. Only the latter uses probability; and it uses no path regularity, no topology on E_1 , E_2 and no boundedness, so it is already stated at the level of generality of [2]. What it does use, and what Remark 6.4 isolates, is the translation invariance of the clock.

The discrete counterpart, which [3] do not state, now costs nothing.

Corollary 6.10 (Duality for Markov chains; $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$, (E0), $\iota = p$). *Let P and Q be transition kernels on measurable spaces E_1 and E_2 , and let $f \in B(E_1 \times E_2)$ satisfy the duality relation*

$$\int f(x', y) P(x, dx') = \int f(x, y') Q(y, dy'), \quad (x, y) \in E_1 \times E_2. \quad (60)$$

Let X and Y be independent Markov chains with kernels P and Q and $X(0) = x$, $Y(0) = y$. Then

$$E[f(X(n), y)] = E[f(x, Y(n))], \quad n \in \mathbb{N}_0. \quad (61)$$

Proof. Put $\Phi(n, m) = E[f(X(n), Y(m))]$. Writing P for the action of the kernel on the first variable and Q for its action on the second, the Markov property and independence give $\Phi(n+1, m) - \Phi(n, m) = E[((P-I)f)(X(n), Y(m))]$ and $\Phi(n, m+1) - \Phi(n, m) = E[((Q-I)f)(X(n), Y(m))]$, which is (43) for $q =$ counting measure with $\gamma_1(n, m) = E[((P-I)f)(X(n), Y(m))]$ and γ_2 its analogue. By (60), $(P-I)f = (Q-I)f$, so $\gamma_1 = \gamma_2$, and Proposition 6.2(a) applies. $\square$

Remark 6.11. In the language of Section 3, (60) says that $(f(\cdot, y), g(\cdot, y)) \in A$ and $(f(x, \cdot), g(x, \cdot)) \in B$ hold with the *same* $g = (P-I)f = (Q-I)f$, where A and B denote the one-step generators; the associated test process is then the Doob decomposition

$$f(X(n), y) - \sum_{k < n} g(X(k), y),$$

i.e. the compensator in the convention $[0, t)$ of Remark 6.3. So Corollary 6.10 is the martingale-problem duality theorem for $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$, and the convention it forces is the predictable one.

Corollary 6.12 (Stopped version; [3], Corollary 4.4.14; (T3)). *Let $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ and $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ be independent filtrations, let X be $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -progressive with $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -stopping time τ , and let Y be $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -progressive with $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -stopping time σ . Suppose (48) and (49) hold with X, Y replaced by $X(\cdot \wedge \tau)$, $Y(\cdot \wedge \sigma)$, and that $f(X(t \wedge \tau), y) - \int_0^{t \wedge \tau} g(X(s), y) ds$ is an $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ -martingale for each y , and $f(x, Y(t \wedge \sigma)) - \int_0^{t \wedge \sigma} h(x, Y(s)) ds$ is a $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -martingale for each x . Then the analogue of (52) holds with X, Y replaced by the stopped processes and the integrand multiplied by the indicators $\mathbf{1}_{\{s \leq \tau\}}$ resp. $\mathbf{1}_{\{t-s \leq \sigma\}}$.*

Proof. Rewrite the martingale in the hypothesis as $f(X(t \wedge \tau), y) - \int_0^t \mathbf{1}_{\{s \leq \tau\}} g(X(s), y) ds$ and repeat the proof of Theorem 6.6. $\square$

Remark 6.13. Corollary 6.12 is the practically relevant form: the estimates (48) are often unavailable globally but easy on the exit times τ from compact sets. One then lets $\tau, \sigma \rightarrow \infty$ along an exhausting sequence; the integrand on the right of the stopped version of (52) tends to zero, and the only difficulty is to justify the interchange of limits and expectations ([3], Remark 4.4.16). This is also the route by which duality is applied to *local* martingale problems.

We can now close the circle with Section 5.

Corollary 6.14 (Uniqueness via duality; (T3)). *Assume (E2), let $A \subset B(E) \times B(E)$, let $(E_2, \mathcal{E}_2)$ be a measurable space, and let $B \subset M(E_2) \times M(E_2)$. Suppose there is $f \in M(E \times E_2)$ such that:*

- (i) $\{f(\cdot, y) : y \in E_2\} \subset B(E)$ is separating for $\mathcal{P}(E)$;
- (ii) $(f(\cdot, y), g(\cdot, y)) \in A$ for every $y \in E_2$, and $(f(x, \cdot), h(x, \cdot)) \in B$ for every $x \in E$, with $g = h$;
- (iii) for every $y \in E_2$ there is a solution Y^y of the martingale problem for (B, δ_y) , and for every solution X of the martingale problem for A with X independent of Y^y the hypotheses (48)–(49) hold with $\alpha = \beta = 0$.

Then for every $\mu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$ the martingale problem for (A, μ) has at most one solution, every solution is Markov, and under the additional hypotheses of Theorem 5.28(b)–(c) it is strong Markov.

Proof. Let X solve the martingale problem for (A, δ_x) and let Y^y be as in (iii), independent of X . By (ii), (58) holds with $\alpha = \beta = 0$, so Corollary 6.8 gives

$$E[f(X(t), y)] = E[f(x, Y^y(t))], \quad t \geq 0. \quad (62)$$

The right-hand side does not depend on X . Hence $\int f(\cdot, y) d\nu_t$ is the same for the one-dimensional distributions $\nu_t = PX(t)^{-1}$ of any two solutions, and by (i) these coincide. For general μ , integrate (62) over $\mu(dx)$, which is legitimate because the one-dimensional distributions of a solution for (A, μ) are mixtures of those for (A, δ_x) by Theorem 5.28(a). Now apply Theorem 5.28. $\square$

7 Existence

Sections 5 and 6 are a uniqueness theory, and by themselves they are vacuous: nothing so far exhibits a single solution of a single martingale problem. This section collects the four routes to existence, in increasing order of cost.

- (a) *From a transition semigroup* (Section 7.1). Immediate, and correspondingly weak: it presupposes the object one usually wants to construct.
- (b) *Explicit construction* (Section 7.2). Jump processes are built by hand out of a Markov chain and exponential holding times, and the martingale property is verified by a two-line computation with the exponential distribution. This is the only place in the manuscript where a solution is written down.
- (c) *From stochastic differential equations* (Section 7.3). The most important route in practice and the most expensive here, since it presupposes stochastic integration; we state the chain of results and prove none of it.
- (d) *By convergence* (Sections 7.4–7.6). Weak limits of solutions of approximating problems. Conditional, like (a), but on much less.

Routes (b) and (c) are the two that produce a solution out of nothing, and it is worth noticing before we start that they are the same argument at two levels of difficulty: both are Picard–Lindelöf. In (b) it is a Gronwall estimate on the first-jump equation (67); in (c) it is the Picard iteration for a Lipschitz stochastic differential equation. What differs is the space on which the contraction acts.

7.1 From a transition semigroup

Proposition 7.1 ([3], Proposition 4.1.7; (T3) + (E0)). *Let X be a Markov process with measurable transition semigroup $\{T(t)\}$ on $B(E)$ and full generator $\hat{A}$ in the sense of Definition 2.11. Then X solves the martingale problem for $\hat{A}$.*

This is Remark 3.14, restated as an existence statement, and it is recorded only for completeness: it turns a Markov process into a solution, and producing the Markov process is the whole difficulty. The remaining three routes do not presuppose one.

7.2 Jump processes

Throughout this subsection $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_+$ with q Lebesgue measure, so that the two conventions of Definition 2.2 agree and ι plays no rôle. The state space needs only (E0) for the construction and the martingale property; (E2) enters only when one wants to say that the paths lie in $D_E[0, \infty)$.

Setting 7.2 (Jump data; (T3) + (E0)). Let $\lambda : E \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ be measurable (the *rate*) and let μ be a transition kernel on E (the *jump distribution*). Define

$$Af(x) = \lambda(x) \int_E (f(y) - f(x)) \mu(x, dy), \quad f \in B(E), \quad (63)$$

and $A = \{(f, Af) : f \in B(E)\}$. If $\bar{\lambda} := \sup_x \lambda(x) < \infty$ then A maps $B(E)$ into itself with $\|Af\| \leq 2\bar{\lambda}\|f\|$; in general Af need not be bounded.

Definition 7.3 (The construction; (T3) + (E0)). Let $\nu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$. On some probability space let $(Y_n)_{n \geq 0}$ be a Markov chain with initial distribution ν and transition kernel μ , and let $\varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2, \dots$ be i.i.d. exponential random variables of parameter 1, independent of (Y_n) . Put

$$\tau_0 = 0, \quad \tau_{n+1} = \tau_n + \frac{\varepsilon_{n+1}}{\lambda(Y_n)}, \quad \zeta = \lim_n \tau_n, \quad (64)$$

with the convention $1/0 = \infty$, and

$$X_t = Y_n \quad \text{for } \tau_n \leq t < \tau_{n+1}, \quad t < \zeta. \quad (65)$$

We call ζ the *explosion time* and (τ_n) the *jump times*.

Three observations before the theorem. The paths of X are piecewise constant and right continuous by construction, hence lie in $D_E[0, \infty)$ as soon as E carries a topology, i.e. under (E2). If $\lambda(Y_n) = 0$ then $\tau_{n+1} = \infty$ and X is absorbed at Y_n . And each τ_n is a functional of the path — the time of its n -th jump — which is what will make it a legitimate localizing sequence in the sense of (L1).

Lemma 7.4 (No explosion for bounded rates; (T3) + (E0)). *If $\bar{\lambda} < \infty$ then $\zeta = \infty$ almost surely.*

Proof. $\tau_{n+1} - \tau_n \geq \varepsilon_{n+1}/\bar{\lambda}$, and $\sum_n \varepsilon_{n+1}/\bar{\lambda} = \infty$ a.s. by the strong law of large numbers, the ε_n being i.i.d. with mean 1. $\square$

Theorem 7.5 (Jump processes solve their martingale problem; (T3) + (E0)). *Let $\bar{\lambda} < \infty$ and let X be as in Definition 7.3. Then X solves the martingale problem for (A, ν) of (63).*

Proof. Fix $f \in B(E)$ and write $\mu f(x) = \int f(y) \mu(x, dy)$, so that $Af = \lambda \cdot (\mu f - f)$. Let $\mathcal{G}_t = \sigma(X_u : u \leq t)$ and

$$M_t = f(X_t) - f(X_0) - \int_0^t Af(X_r) dr.$$

Step 1: the paths make both terms explicit. Since X is constant on $[\tau_n, \tau_{n+1})$,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^t Af(X_r) dr &= \sum_{n \geq 0} Af(Y_n) ((\tau_{n+1} \wedge t) - (\tau_n \wedge t)), \\ f(X_t) - f(X_0) &= \sum_{n \geq 1} (f(Y_n) - f(Y_{n-1})) \mathbf{1}_{\{\tau_n \leq t\}}, \end{aligned}$$

both sums being finite a.s. by Lemma 7.4. Hence

$$M_t = \sum_{n \geq 0} D_n, \quad D_n = (f(Y_{n+1}) - f(Y_n)) \mathbf{1}_{\{\tau_{n+1} \leq t\}} - Af(Y_n)((\tau_{n+1} \wedge t) - (\tau_n \wedge t)). \quad (66)$$

Step 2: each bracket is a martingale difference. Let $\mathcal{H}_n = \sigma(Y_0, \dots, Y_n, \tau_1, \dots, \tau_n)$. Conditionally on $\mathcal{H}_n$, and on the event $\{\tau_n \leq t\}$, put $x = Y_n$, $\lambda = \lambda(x)$ and $a = t - \tau_n \geq 0$. By construction $\tau_{n+1} - \tau_n$ is exponential with parameter λ and independent of $Y_{n+1} \sim \mu(x, \cdot)$, so

$$\begin{aligned} E[(f(Y_{n+1}) - f(Y_n)) \mathbf{1}_{\{\tau_{n+1} \leq t\}} \mid \mathcal{H}_n] &= (\mu f(x) - f(x))(1 - e^{-\lambda a}), \\ E[(\tau_{n+1} \wedge t) - \tau_n \mid \mathcal{H}_n] &= E[\text{Exp}(\lambda) \wedge a] = \frac{1 - e^{-\lambda a}}{\lambda}. \end{aligned}$$

Multiplying the second identity by $Af(x) = \lambda(\mu f(x) - f(x))$ gives exactly the first. Hence $E[D_n \mid \mathcal{H}_n] = 0$ on $\{\tau_n \leq t\}$, and $D_n = 0$ on $\{\tau_n > t\}$. *This cancellation — the factor λ in (63) against the mean $1/\lambda$ of the holding time — is the whole content of the theorem.*

Step 3: from 0 to s. For $s \leq t$ the same computation applies with τ_n replaced by s on the interval straddling s : by the memorylessness of the exponential distribution, conditionally on $\mathcal{G}_s$ the residual holding time $\tau_{N_s+1} - s$ is again exponential with parameter $\lambda(X_s)$ and the subsequent chain starts afresh at X_s , where N_s is the number of jumps in $[0, s]$. Summing (66) from that interval onwards and applying Step 2 to each term gives $E[M_t - M_s \mid \mathcal{G}_s] = 0$. As $|M_t| \leq 2\|f\| + 2\bar{\lambda}\|f\|t$ is bounded on bounded intervals, M is a $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ -martingale, and since ${}^*\mathcal{F}_t^X = \mathcal{F}_t^X \subset \mathcal{G}_t$ for the right continuous X , the same holds for the filtration of Definition 3.5. $\square$

The construction gives existence. Uniqueness comes from Section 5, and the input it needs is a Gronwall estimate.

Proposition 7.6 (Well-posedness for bounded rates; (T3) + (E2)). *Let $\bar{\lambda} < \infty$. Then the martingale problem for (A, ν) is well posed for every $\nu \in \mathcal{P}(E)$, every solution is a Markov process, and if E satisfies (E2) it is strong Markov.*

Proof. Existence is Theorem 7.5. For uniqueness it suffices, by Theorem 5.9, to show that the one-dimensional distributions are determined by ν ; and since $B(E)$ is separating it suffices to determine $v(t, x) = E_x[f(X_t)]$ for $f \in B(E)$. Conditioning on the first jump — which under any solution has the law prescribed by (63), by Proposition 3.7 — gives the *first-jump equation*

$$v(t, x) = e^{-\lambda(x)t} f(x) + \int_0^t \lambda(x) e^{-\lambda(x)s} (\mu v(t-s, \cdot))(x) ds. \quad (67)$$

If v_1, v_2 are two bounded measurable solutions and $w = v_1 - v_2$, then

$$|w(t, x)| \leq \int_0^t \lambda(x) e^{-\lambda(x)s} \|w(t-s, \cdot)\| ds \leq \bar{\lambda} \int_0^t \|w(r, \cdot)\| dr,$$

so $\rho(t) = \|w(t, \cdot)\|$ satisfies $\rho(t) \leq \bar{\lambda} \int_0^t \rho$, and Gronwall gives $\rho \equiv 0$. Hence the one-dimensional distributions are unique, and Theorem 5.9 applies. The strong Markov property is Theorem 5.11, whose hypotheses hold because the paths are piecewise constant and M has increments bounded on bounded intervals. $\square$

Remark 7.7 (Explosion, and why localization is not academic). Drop the assumption $\bar{\lambda} < \infty$. Then ζ may be finite with positive probability — take $E = \mathbb{N}$, $\mu(n, \cdot) = \delta_{n+1}$ and $\lambda(n) = 2^n$, so that $E[\zeta] = \sum_n 2^{-n} < \infty$ — and (65) defines X only on $[0, \zeta)$. There is then no solution of the *global* martingale problem for A on $\mathbb{R}_+$, and the honest statement is the local one:

- Step 2 of the proof of Theorem 7.5 is a finite computation and is unaffected, so M^{τ_n} is a martingale for every n ;
- τ_n is a functional of the path, the same for every solution, and $\tau_n \uparrow \zeta$;
- hence (τ_n) is a localizing system in the sense of Definition 5.13, and (L1) holds by construction rather than by assumption — exactly as Lemma 5.17 predicts, since the stopped test processes are bounded.

So X solves the local martingale problem for A on $[0, \zeta)$, and Section 5.2 applies verbatim. This is the example that Definition 5.13 was written for; up to this point it had none.

Remark 7.8 (Discrete time, and the two conventions). Deleting the holding times from Definition 7.3 leaves the chain (Y_n) itself, which is the case $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$ with q counting measure. There $A = \mu - I$ under the predictable convention $\iota = p$, so that $M_n = f(Y_n) - f(Y_0) - \sum_{k < n} (\mu f - f)(Y_k)$ is the Doob decomposition; under $\iota = o$ one would obtain the condition $\mu f - f = \mu(\mu f - f)$ instead, which is not what one wants. This is the concrete form of Remark 2.4, and it is also the case in which Corollary 6.10 lives.

Remark 7.9 (What this example is for). Besides being the only explicit solution in the manuscript, the construction exercises three of its abstractions and is the reason they were made. The state space needs only (E0): λ measurable and μ a kernel, no topology, no metric, no Polish structure — so jump processes on a standard Borel E , for instance on a space of measures or of distributions, are covered by Theorem 7.5 as it stands. The localizing system of Remark 7.7 is a genuine instance of (L1)–(L3). And the discrete case of Remark 7.8 is a genuine instance of a clock with atoms.

7.3 From stochastic differential equations

For $E = \mathbb{R}^d$ and continuous paths there is a route that is more important than all the others put together, and we state it without proofs. Let $\sigma : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d \times m}$ and $b : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$ be measurable, put $a = \sigma \sigma^\top$, and let

$$Af(x) = \frac{1}{2} a^{ij}(x) \partial_{ij} f(x) + b^i(x) \partial_i f(x), \quad f \in C_c^\infty(\mathbb{R}^d). \quad (68)$$

A *weak solution* of the equation (σ, b) is a pair (X, B) on some filtered probability space with B an m -dimensional Brownian motion and $X_t = X_0 + \int_0^t \sigma(X_s) dB_s + \int_0^t b(X_s) ds$.

Fact 7.10 (Picard–Lindelöf for SDEs). If σ and b are Lipschitz, then for every x the equation (σ, b) has a strong solution with $X_0 = x$, and pathwise uniqueness holds. The proof is Picard iteration in L^2 , with the Itô isometry in place of the triangle inequality.

Fact 7.11 (Yamada–Watanabe). Pathwise uniqueness together with weak existence implies uniqueness in law.

Fact 7.12 (Stroock–Varadhan; [5], Theorem 32.7). For progressive σ, b and $P \in \mathcal{P}(C_{\mathbb{R}_+, \mathbb{R}^d})$ the following are equivalent: P is the law of a weak solution of (σ, b) ; and P solves the local martingale problem for A of (68).

Corollary 7.13 (Well-posedness for Lipschitz coefficients; (T3), $E = \mathbb{R}^d$). *If σ and b are Lipschitz, the local martingale problem for A of (68) is well posed for every initial distribution, and its solution is a strong Markov process.*

Proof. Facts 7.10 and 7.11 give weak existence and uniqueness in law; Fact 7.12 transfers both to the local martingale problem. The Markov properties are Theorems 5.20 and 5.11, or directly [5], Theorem 32.11. $\square$

Remark 7.14 (What a proof would cost). Section 2.5 contains nothing about stochastic integration, and this is the only place in the manuscript that reaches outside [3], Chapters 1–3. A self-contained treatment of Corollary 7.13 would need the Itô integral against a continuous local martingale, quadratic variation and the Kunita–Watanabe inequality, Itô’s formula, and Lévy’s characterization of Brownian motion — the last being what turns a solution of the martingale problem back into a solution of the equation in Fact 7.12. That is a chapter, not a section, and it is deliberately not attempted here.

For the formalization the situation is less bad than it looks: the `brownian-motion` development of Remark 8.1 is building stochastic integration in Lean, so the dependency may become available rather than having to be created. Until then, Section 7.2 is the route that can actually be carried out.

7.4 By convergence: the Ethier–Kurtz version

The remaining route obtains solutions as weak limits of solutions of approximating martingale problems. We first state the classical result and then its generalization.

Lemma 7.15 ([3], Lemma 4.5.1; (T3)). *Assume (E3), let $A \subset C_b(E) \times C_b(E)$ and $A_n \subset B(E) \times B(E)$ for $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Suppose that for each $(f, g) \in A$ there exist $(f_n, g_n) \in A_n$ with*

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|f_n - f\| = 0, \quad \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|g_n - g\| = 0. \quad (69)$$

If for each n the process X_n is a solution of the martingale problem for A_n with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$, and if $X_n \Rightarrow X$ in $D_E[0, \infty)$, then X is a solution of the martingale problem for A .

Proof. Let $D(X) = \{u \geq 0 : P\{X(u) = X(u-)\} = 1\}$; by Fact 2.37 its complement is countable, so $D(X)$ is dense. Let $0 \leq t_1 \leq \dots \leq t_k \leq t < s$ with $t_i, t, s \in D(X)$, and $h_i \in C_b(E)$. For $u \in D(X)$ the evaluation map $\omega \mapsto \omega(u)$ is continuous at ω for PX^{-1} -almost every $\omega \in D_E[0, \infty)$, hence the functional

$$\omega \mapsto \left(f(\omega(s)) - f(\omega(t)) - \int_t^s g(\omega(u)) du \right) \prod_{i=1}^k h_i(\omega(t_i))$$

is bounded and PX^{-1} -a.s. continuous on $D_E[0, \infty)$. By the continuous mapping theorem (Fact 2.25) and (69),

$$\begin{aligned} & E \left[\left(f(X(s)) - f(X(t)) - \int_t^s g(X(u)) du \right) \prod_{i=1}^k h_i(X(t_i)) \right] \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E \left[\left(f_n(X_n(s)) - f_n(X_n(t)) - \int_t^s g_n(X_n(u)) du \right) \prod_{i=1}^k h_i(X_n(t_i)) \right] = 0, \end{aligned} \quad (70)$$

the last equality because X_n solves the martingale problem for A_n . By right continuity of X and density of $D(X)$, (70) extends to all $0 \leq t_1 \leq \dots \leq t_k \leq t < s$. By Proposition 3.7, X solves the martingale problem for A . $\square$

Remark 7.16 ([3], Remark 4.5.2). Lemma 7.15 presupposes convergence. Suppose (E, r) is Polish and $\mathcal{D}(A)$ contains an algebra that separates points and vanishes nowhere; by Fact 2.32 such an algebra is separating, and it is dense in $C_b(E)$ in the topology of uniform convergence on compact sets. Then $\{X_n\}$ is relatively compact provided (69) holds for each $(f, g) \in A$ and the compact containment condition (15) holds. This is Facts 2.39, 2.40, 2.38 and 2.27. Combining with Lemma 7.15: every limit point of $\{X_n\}$ solves the martingale problem for A ; in particular the martingale problem for A has a solution with sample paths in $D_E[0, \infty)$. If in addition uniqueness holds (e.g. by Theorem 5.28 or Corollary 6.14), then $X_n \Rightarrow X$ for the unique solution X .

7.5 By convergence: the abstract theorem

Theorem 7.21 below is an instance of one statement, which uses neither an operator, nor càdlàg paths, nor the Skorokhod topology, nor any structure on the time index beyond a dense subset — and none at all if that subset is all of $\mathbb{T}$. It is [2], Theorem 3.14 and Corollary 3.17, and it is the cheapest genuine theorem in this manuscript; we give it with its proof, since it is what the formalization should target (step (F5) of Section 8). Lemma 7.15 is in turn a special case of Theorem 7.21, so all of Section 7 rests on Theorem 7.18.

Definition 7.17 (P -continuity at X ; (T0) + (E3)). A Borel map $\psi : F \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is P -continuous at X if there is $C \in \mathcal{B}(F)$ with $P\{X \in C\} = 1$ such that $\psi(\alpha_m) \rightarrow \psi(\alpha)$ whenever $\alpha_m \rightarrow \alpha$ in F with $\alpha \in C$.

Theorem 7.18 (Abstract convergence; [2], Theorem 3.14 and Corollary 3.17; (T0) + (E3)). *In Setting 3.1, let $\mathbb{X}$ be canonical for X , let $D \subset \mathbb{T}$, and for each n let $B^n = (\Omega^n, \mathcal{F}^n, \mathbb{P}^n, P^n)$ be a filtered probability space carrying a process X^n with paths in F . Assume:*

- (C1) $X^n \Rightarrow X$ weakly on F ;
- (C2) $\mathbb{X}$ admits a determining set $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ (Definition 3.3);
- (C3) for every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ there is a canonical version (Y_t°) such that for all $t \in D$, $s \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ and $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$:
 - (a) Y_t° and $Y_t^\circ Z_s^\circ$ are P -continuous at X ;
 - (b) $\{Y_r^\circ(X^n) : r \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}, n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is uniformly integrable;
 - (c) $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E^{P^n}[(Y_t^\circ(X^n) - Y_s^\circ(X^n))Z_s^\circ(X^n)] = 0$.

Then $E^P[Y_t \mid \mathcal{F}_s] = Y_s$ for all $s \leq t$ in D and all $Y \in \mathbb{X}$. If moreover $D = \mathbb{T}$, then $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X})$. The same conclusion holds for a proper $D \subsetneq \mathbb{T}$ provided $\mathbb{T}$ satisfies (T2b) with D its countable dense subset and every $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ is right continuous.

Proof. Fix $Y \in \mathbb{X}$ with canonical version Y° , and $t \in D$.

Step 0: integrability. For $r \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ the map $|Y_r^\circ|$ is P -continuous at X by (a), so $|Y_r^\circ(X^n)| \Rightarrow |Y_r^\circ(X)|$ by (C1) and Fact 2.25; the family is uniformly integrable by (b), so Fact 2.41 gives $E^{P^n}|Y_r^\circ(X^n)| \rightarrow E^P|Y_r^\circ(X)| < \infty$. In particular $Y_r = Y_r^\circ(X) \in L^1(P)$.

Step 1: the martingale identity on D . Let $s \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ and $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$, and put $\psi = (Y_t^\circ - Y_s^\circ)Z_s^\circ : F \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. By (a) and Definition 7.17 — which is stable under differences and products, the exceptional sets being intersected — ψ is P -continuous at X . Hence $\psi(X^n) \Rightarrow \psi(X)$ by (C1) and Fact 2.25. The family $\{\psi(X^n)\}_n$ is uniformly integrable,

being dominated by $\|Z_s^\circ\|(|Y_t^\circ(X^n)| + |Y_s^\circ(X^n)|)$ and Z_s° bounded by Definition 3.3(i). So Fact 2.41 applies and, with (c),

$$E^P[(Y_t - Y_s)Z_s^\circ(X)] = E^P[\psi(X)] = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E^{P^n}[\psi(X^n)] = 0,$$

the first equality because $\mathbb{X}$ is canonical. As $Z_s^\circ \in \mathbb{Z}_s^\circ$ was arbitrary and $Y_s, Y_t \in L^1(P)$ by Step 0, part (ii) of Definition 3.3 yields $E^P[Y_t | \mathcal{F}_s] = Y_s$. If $D = \mathbb{T}$ this is already the assertion.

Step 2: uniform integrability under P . Let $\varphi_N(x) = |x| - |x| \wedge N$. For $r \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ the map $\varphi_N \circ Y_r^\circ$ is P -continuous at X , and $\{\varphi_N(Y_r^\circ(X^n))\}_n$ is uniformly integrable because it is dominated by $|Y_r^\circ(X^n)|$. So Fact 2.41 applies twice and gives

$$E^P[\varphi_N(Y_r)] = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E^{P^n}[\varphi_N(Y_r^\circ(X^n))] \leq \sup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} E^{P^n}[\varphi_N(Y_r^\circ(X^n))].$$

Taking the supremum over $r \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ and letting $N \rightarrow \infty$, the right-hand side tends to 0 by (b) and the second characterization of uniform integrability in Fact 2.41. Hence $\{Y_r : r \in D \cap \mathbb{T}_{\leq t}\}$ is uniformly integrable under P .

Step 3: from D to $\mathbb{T}$. Assume (T2b) and Y right continuous, and let $s < t$ in $\mathbb{T}$ be arbitrary. Since D is dense and $\mathbb{T}$ has no isolated points from the right, there are $s_m \downarrow s$ and $t_m \downarrow t$ in D with $s_m < t_m$. Let $G \in \mathcal{F}_s$. Then $G \in \mathcal{F}_{s_m}$ because $s \leq s_m$, so Step 1 gives $E^P[Y_{t_m} \mathbf{1}_G] = E^P[Y_{s_m} \mathbf{1}_G]$. By right continuity $Y_{t_m} \rightarrow Y_t$ and $Y_{s_m} \rightarrow Y_s$ P -a.s., and both families are uniformly integrable by Step 2, so Fact 2.41 applied to $Y_{t_m} \mathbf{1}_G$ and $Y_{s_m} \mathbf{1}_G$ yields $E^P[Y_t \mathbf{1}_G] = E^P[Y_s \mathbf{1}_G]$. As $G \in \mathcal{F}_s$ was arbitrary, $E^P[Y_t | \mathcal{F}_s] = Y_s$, and $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X})$. $\square$

Remark 7.19 (Where the index enters). Steps 0–2 use no structure on $\mathbb{T}$ whatsoever beyond the preorder: D is any subset, and $\mathbb{T}_{\leq t}$ is a down-set. The only place where more is needed is Step 3, and it is needed only to pass from D to its complement. With $D = \mathbb{T}$ — in particular for $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$, where every point is isolated from the right and no approximation is available or necessary — Step 3 is empty and the theorem holds under (T0). This is why step (F5) of Section 8 can be done immediately after (F2), before any of the Skorokhod theory.

Remark 7.20 (What has to be checked, and what does not). Of the three hypotheses, (C1) is the input, (C2) is a property of the path space and is supplied once and for all by Example 3.4 or by Proposition 3.7, and (C3) is the work. Within (C3), (a) is where the topology of F enters — and it is the only place; for $F = D_E[0, \infty)$ it is the reason for the “countable complement” hypothesis of Theorem 7.21, since $\alpha \mapsto \alpha(t)$ is J_1 -continuous exactly at paths not jumping at t . Condition (c) is where the approximating martingales are used, and (b) is what makes the two limits interchangeable.

7.6 By convergence: the general version

The following theorem is [2], Theorem 4.1; it is the specialization of the abstract convergence theorem [2], Corollary 3.17, to the Markovian martingale problem, and it generalizes Lemma 7.15 in three independent directions:

- (1) the approximating objects are *not* required to solve a martingale problem for an operator; they are arbitrary pairs (ξ^n, φ^n) of progressively measurable processes such that $\xi^n - \int_0^\cdot \varphi_s^n ds$ is a martingale;
- (2) the approximation (69) in the uniform norm is replaced by the much weaker *asymptotic* conditions (72) and (73), which are conditions on the laws only;

(3) uniform boundedness is replaced by uniform integrability (71).

Theorem 7.21 ([2], Theorem 4.1; (T3)). Assume (E3). Let $B = (\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{F}, P)$ and $B^n = (\Omega^n, \mathcal{F}^n, \mathbb{F}^n, P^n)$ be filtered probability spaces carrying E -valued càdlàg adapted processes X and X^n , and assume that $\mathbb{F}$ is generated by X . Let $A \subset C_b(E) \times C_b(E)$ and let $\mathbb{X} = \mathbb{X}_A(X)$ be as in (20). For each n , let $\mathbb{X}^n$ be a set of pairs (ξ, φ) of real-valued progressively measurable processes on B^n such that $\sup_{s \leq T} E^{P^n}[|\xi_s| + |\varphi_s|] < \infty$ for all $T > 0$ and such that $\xi - \int_0^\cdot \varphi_s ds$ is a martingale on B^n .

Suppose that $X^n \Rightarrow X$ weakly on $D_E[0, \infty)$ with the Skorokhod J_1 topology, and that there is a set $\Gamma \subset \mathbb{R}_+$ with countable complement such that for each $(f, g) \in A$ and $T > 0$ there is a sequence $(\xi^n, \varphi^n) \in \mathbb{X}^n$ with

$$\sup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \sup_{s \leq T} E^{P^n}[|\xi_s^n| + |\varphi_s^n|] < \infty, \quad (71)$$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E^{P^n} \left[(\xi_t^n - f(X_t^n)) \prod_{i=1}^k h_i(X_{t_i}^n) \right] = 0, \quad (72)$$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E^{P^n} \left[\int_s^t (\varphi_u^n - g(X_u^n)) du \prod_{i=1}^k h_i(X_{t_i}^n) \right] = 0, \quad (73)$$

for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$, $t_1, \dots, t_k \in \Gamma \cap [0, t]$, $t \in \Gamma \cap [0, T]$, $h_1, \dots, h_k \in C_b(E)$. Then $P \in \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{X})$, i.e. X solves the martingale problem for A .

Proof. We verify (C1)–(C3) of Theorem 7.18.

The set D , and (C2). Set $D = \{t \in \Gamma : P\{X_t \neq X_{t-}\} = 0\}$. By Fact 2.37 and the hypothesis on Γ , D^c is countable, so D is dense. Let $\mathbb{Z}^\circ$ be the determining set of Example 3.4 built from D ; this is (C2). Hypothesis (C1) is the assumed weak convergence $X^n \Rightarrow X$ on $D_E[0, \infty)$.

(b). Let $Y = f(X) - \int_0^\cdot g(X_s) ds \in \mathbb{X}$ with canonical version $Y_t^\circ(\omega) = f(\omega(t)) - \int_0^t g(\omega(s)) ds$. Since f, g are bounded, Y_r° is bounded on $r \in [0, t]$, so $\{Y_r^\circ(X^n) : r \in D \cap [0, t], n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is uniformly integrable.

(a). The evaluation $\omega \mapsto \omega(t)$ is J_1 -continuous at every ω with $\omega(t) = \omega(t-)$, so the definition of D makes Y_t° and $Y_t^\circ Z_s^\circ$ P -continuous at X in the sense of Definition 7.17, for $s, t \in D$. This is the only point at which the Skorokhod topology is used, and it is what the hypothesis on Γ is for.

(c). It remains to verify, for $s, t \in D$ with $s \leq t$ and $Z_s^\circ = \prod_i h_i(\cdot(t_i))$,

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} E^{P^n} [(Y_t^\circ(X^n) - Y_s^\circ(X^n)) Z_s^\circ(X^n)] = 0. \quad (74)$$

Put $Y^n = \xi^n - \int_0^\cdot \varphi_u^n du$, a martingale on B^n . Because $Z_s^\circ(X^n)$ is $\mathcal{F}_s^n$ -measurable, $E^{P^n}[(Y_t^n - Y_s^n) Z_s^\circ(X^n)] = 0$, so

$$E^{P^n} [(Y_t^\circ(X^n) - Y_s^\circ(X^n)) Z_s^\circ(X^n)] = E^{P^n} [(Y_t^\circ(X^n) - Y_t^n + Y_s^n - Y_s^\circ(X^n)) Z_s^\circ(X^n)],$$

and the right-hand side tends to 0 by (72) and (73), since $Y_t^\circ(X^n) - Y_t^n = (f(X_t^n) - \xi_t^n) + \int_0^t (\varphi_u^n - g(X_u^n)) du$. Thus (74) holds, which is (c).

Theorem 7.18 now gives $E^P[Y_t | \mathcal{F}_s] = Y_s$ for $s \leq t$ in D , and its Step 3 — which uses exactly the uniform integrability (71) and the right continuity of Y — extends this to arbitrary $s < t$. $\square$

Remark 7.22. Theorem 7.21 concludes that P solves the *global* martingale problem. To obtain a solution of a *local* martingale problem in the limit, apply the theorem to a localized

family of test processes, i.e. to $\mathbb{X}^{(m)} = \{Y^{\tau_m} : Y \in \mathbb{X}\}$ for a suitable exhausting sequence of stopping times τ_m , and let $m \rightarrow \infty$. This is how [2] obtain their semimartingale results (their Section 4.3), and it is the same reduction as in Remark 5.30.

Remark 7.23 (Path spaces other than $D_E[0, \infty)$). Theorem 7.18 is stated for an arbitrary Polish path space $F \subset E^{\mathbb{T}}$, and Theorem 7.21 is the instance $F = D_E[0, \infty)$. Nothing in the abstract theorem refers to càdlàg paths, to a Markov structure, or to the Skorokhod topology; F may for instance be $L_{\text{loc}}^p(\mathbb{R}_+, \mathbb{R}^d)$, which is the state space [2] use for solutions of Volterra equations (their Example 3.13), or a product of such spaces. What changes from one F to another is only which maps are P -continuous at X , i.e. hypothesis (a) — see Remark 7.20. [2] also give a version in which the uniform integrability of (b) is dropped (their Corollary 3.21) and one with control variables and weak-strong convergence (their Theorem 3.14); the latter is what their Section 5.3 needs for processes with fixed times of discontinuity.

8 Notes for the formalization

8.1 What is available and what has to be built

Section 2 lists the prerequisites; the following is a stocktaking of which of them Mathlib already supplies.

Available. Filtrations, adapted and progressively measurable processes, stopping times and $\mathcal{F}_\tau$ (Definition 2.14, Fact 2.15); martingales and the optional stopping theorem (Definition 2.16, Fact 2.19); Doob’s inequalities (Fact 2.20); Polish spaces; weak convergence of measures with the portmanteau theorem, the Lévy–Prokhorov metric and Prohorov’s theorem (Facts 2.24, 2.26, 2.27); uniform integrability (Fact 2.41); monotone class theorems (Fact 2.42).

To be built.

- the Skorokhod space $D_E[0, \infty)$ with the J_1 metric, and the facts that it is Polish, that its Borel field is generated by the coordinates, and the characterization of its compact sets (Definition 2.34, Facts 2.35, 2.36, 2.33);
- regularization of submartingales along a dense set (Facts 2.17, 2.18) — but see Remark 8.1: this exists already, outside Mathlib;
- local martingales in the [3] sense (Definition 2.21, Fact 2.22);
- separating and convergence determining classes and their Stone–Weierstrass theory (Definition 2.30, Facts 2.31, 2.32, 2.33, 2.43);
- bounded pointwise convergence and bp-closures (Definition 2.28, Fact 2.29);
- the continuous mapping theorem in the form of Fact 2.25 and the Skorokhod representation (Fact 2.26);
- convergence of finite-dimensional distributions in $D_E[0, \infty)$ and the relative compactness criteria (Facts 2.38, 2.39, 2.40);
- dissipative operators and the full generator of a measurable contraction semigroup (Definitions 2.10, 2.11, Fact 2.12); these are needed only for Proposition 3.13 and Remark 3.14, which are themselves optional context.

Remark 8.1 (Prior art: the `brownian-motion` project). The càdlàg half of **(F4)** is already formalized, not in Mathlib but in the Lean development accompanying [1], in the repository `RemyDegenne/brownian-motion` on GitHub. Its file `Cadlag.lean` defines `IsRightContinuous` for a preorder and `IsCadlag` as a structure, and develops jump sets, the discreteness of large jumps, local boundedness and the usual closure properties, with no remaining gaps. Its `CadlagModification.lean` then constructs the càdlàg modification; the blueprint chapter proves that a submartingale has a càdlàg modification if and only if $t \mapsto E[X_t]$ is right continuous, and that a martingale always has one. These are precisely Facts 2.17 and 2.18, and they are proved for *quasimartingales*, which is more general than what Theorem 4.3 needs.

Three consequences for the present plan. First, **(F4)** loses its most expensive prerequisite. Second, the index there is a preorder with an order topology, which agrees with the bundle (T2b) of Definition 2.1 — the two developments make the same choice independently. Third, what is *not* there is the Skorokhod space: no J_1 metric, no $\mathcal{B}(D_E[0, \infty)) = \sigma(\pi_t)$, no compactness criterion. So **(F7)** is untouched, and Fact 2.35 and Fact 2.36 remain to be built.

This dictates a natural order of work. Each item names the bundle of Definition 2.1 it targets; the point of doing so is that **(F1)**, **(F5)** and half of **(F2)** live under `[Preorder  $\iota$ ]`, which is how Mathlib already indexes `Filtration` and `Martingale`, and can therefore be stated without any bespoke index theory.

- (F1)** *Targets (T0) + (E0) + clock.* Definitions only: Definition 3.2, Definition 3.5, the filtration (4), Definition 3.15 (which needs (T2b)), and Proposition 3.7. The clock is a `MeasureTheory.Measure` on $\mathbb{T}$ together with the hypothesis that every down-set is measurable and of finite mass; the interval algebra (2) is then definitional. These need nothing beyond what Mathlib has and should be done first; note that Proposition 3.7 is what turns every subsequent statement into a statement about finite-dimensional distributions.
- (F2)** *Targets (T0) + (T4) + (E0); (T2a) for the uniqueness half, (E1) for Lemma 5.3.* Lemma 5.2, Lemma 5.8 and Theorem 5.9, then Theorem 5.28 and Corollary 5.29 as corollaries. Modulo (19) this is pure measure theory, and Theorem 5.9 needs no path regularity at all, so it is the best entry point after **(F1)**. Almost all of the work sits in Lemma 5.8, which is four lines; the two theorems that follow are bookkeeping. Theorem 5.11 additionally needs Fact 2.19 and càdlàg paths and should be deferred until after **(F4)**, and so should the local theory of Section 5.2 — Definition 5.13 is about stopping times. Note that Lemma 5.15(a) and Lemma 5.17 are the only genuinely new proofs there; Lemma 5.19 is Lemma 5.8 plus the one identity (37), and Theorem 5.20 is bookkeeping.
- (F3)** *Targets (T0) + (T4) + (E0) for Lemma 6.1, (T2a) + a reflective clock with $\iota = p$ for Proposition 6.2, (T3) + (E2) for the rest.* Lemma 6.1 — an exact telescoping identity, and the cheapest item in this list — then Proposition 6.2, Corollary 6.10, and finally Lemma 6.5, Theorem 6.6 and their corollaries. Self-contained: Fubini, absolute continuity, dominated convergence. No Skorokhod space is needed. Note that Corollary 6.10 needs none of the analysis and can be formalized directly after Lemma 6.1. Together with **(F2)** this already yields Corollary 6.14, a complete uniqueness theory.
- (F4)** *Targets (T2b) + (E2), $\iota = o$.* Fact 2.17 and Fact 2.18, then Theorem 4.3 and, as a one-line corollary, Theorem 4.5. This requires the notion of a càdlàg path but *not*

the Skorokhod topology. Formalize the abstract theorem, not the Markovian one: Definition 4.2 is three hypotheses on a pair of processes, whereas $\mathcal{D}(A)$ drags in the operator, its domain and the filtration (4), none of which the proof uses.

- (F5) *Targets (T0) + (E3), with $D = \mathbb{T}$.* Theorem 7.18, the abstract convergence theorem. It needs an abstract Polish path space, a determining set, P -continuity at X , uniform integrability and Vitali's theorem — and *no* Skorokhod topology, no càdlàg paths and no Markov structure. It can therefore be done immediately after (F2), and it is the cheapest genuine theorem in this list rather than, as the ordering suggests, part of the most expensive one.
- (F6) *Targets (T3) + (E0).* Out of order, and deliberately: the jump processes of Section 7.2. Theorem 7.5 needs a Markov chain, i.i.d. exponential variables and the computation of Step 2, and nothing else; Proposition 7.6 adds a Gronwall estimate. It is by a wide margin the cheapest theorem with real content in this manuscript, it is the only one that exhibits a solution, and it supplies the missing example for Definition 5.13. It could be done before (F1), as a way of testing the definitions against something concrete.
- (F7) *Targets (T3) + (E3).* The Skorokhod space and its topology, then Lemma 7.15, Remark 7.16 and Theorem 7.21 as instances of (F5). This is by far the largest item.

8.2 Design decisions

- (a) *Operators as relations.* A is a subset of $M(E) \times M(E)$, not a function. In Lean this is $\mathbf{A} : \mathbf{Set} ((\mathbf{E} \rightarrow \mathbf{R}) \times (\mathbf{E} \rightarrow \mathbf{R}))$ together with measurability side conditions, or a structure bundling the pair with its measurability. Keeping A multivalued costs nothing and is needed for Remark 3.9(b).
- (b) *Two notions of solution.* Definition 3.5 defines “solution with respect to $(\mathcal{G}_t)$ ” as the primitive and “solution” as the special case $\mathcal{G}_t = \mathcal{F}_t^X$. Doing it the other way round duplicates every statement.
- (c) *Compact containment as a predicate.* Definition 3.15 occurs in Theorem 4.5, in Remark 7.16 and implicitly in Remarks 5.30 and 7.22. It should be one definition with the two variants (28) (over D , single process) and (15) (over $[0, T]$, family) related by a lemma for right continuous processes.
- (d) *Local martingale problems.* Following Section 1.2, define the local martingale problem at the level of Definition 3.2 and derive the localized statements (Remarks 5.30, 7.22) by a single reusable lemma of the form: *if X solves the local martingale problem for A with localizing sequence (τ_m) , then $X(\cdot \wedge \tau_m)$ solves the (global) martingale problem for the stopped operator $A^{(m)}$.*
- (e) *Separating classes.* Facts 2.43 and 2.33 should be developed independently of martingale problems; they are of general interest and are the only place where Polishness of E is really used.
- (f) *No semigroup theory.* The manuscript rests on Chapters 2 and 3 of [3] alone, as envisaged in the project plan; of Chapter 1 only the notions of a dissipative operator and of the full generator are borrowed, and only for the optional Proposition 3.13 and Remark 3.14. See Remark 2.13.

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